

Political Science — Master Notes

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One running document for the whole course, organised by **Part → Lecture → readings**. Format per reading:
Résumé → ★ Heart of it → Key concepts → Section-by-section → Cases → Key terms → Exam pointers.

Overview — where everything is

(Everything below is clickable — jump straight to a lecture, reading, case, or fun-facts box.)

Part I • Political Systems & Institutions

- **Lecture 1: Introduction — Power, Politics & Political Science (MDJ)** — [OD Ch. 1: Introduction](#) · [Ansell Ch. 1](#) · [the chain, worked](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **Lecture 2: The State (AUW)** — [OD Ch. 2: The Modern State](#) · [OD Ch. 4: States & Identity](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **Lecture 3: Political Regimes (FK)** — [OD Ch. 3: States, Citizens & Regimes](#) · [regime taxonomy](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **Lecture 4: Systems of Government** — [OD Ch. 5: Governing Institutions](#) · [parliamentary vs presidential vs semi-presidential](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **Lecture 5: Participation and Representation (FK)** — [OD Ch. 6: Participation & Representation](#) · [what is representation? \(Pitkin\)](#) · [electoral systems compared](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **Lecture 6: Institutions and Institutionalisms (AUW)** — [Hall & Taylor: the 3 institutionalisms](#) · [RCI / HI / SI compared](#) · [Bussemeyer & Thelen \(HI example\)](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)

Part II • International Relations

- **IR I: Realism (AUW)** — [what is IR + collective-goods problem](#) · [levels of analysis](#) · [what realism is](#) · ★ [the realist causal chain](#) · [power & the security dilemma](#) · [balance of power & polarity](#) · [the realism family](#) · [Prisoner's Dilemma](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **IR II: Liberalism (AUW)** — [how liberalism sees the world](#) · [the two branches](#) · ★ [liberal institutionalism & its mechanisms](#) · [regimes & collective security](#) · ★ [liberal internationalism & the Kantian triangle](#) · [the democratic peace](#) · [ch.7: IOs, the UN, international law & human rights](#) · [realism vs liberalism](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **IR III: Constructivism / Other Approaches (AUW)** — [the puzzle: material fact → social meaning](#) · ★ [what constructivism is](#) · ["anarchy is what states make of it"](#) · [norms & the apartheid case](#) · [postmodernism](#) · ★ [critical theory: power & hierarchy](#) · [Marxism \(Marx vs Lenin\)](#) · [Gramsci](#) · [Wallerstein](#) · [postcolonialism/Said](#) · [feminist & queer IR](#) · [peace studies](#) · ★ [the four theories compared](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **IR IV: International Security (AUW)** — ★ [security is a contested concept](#) · [whose security? the referent object](#) · [types of threat](#) · [the state: protector or war-maker?](#) · [national → international → human security](#) · [IR theories & security](#) · ★ [securitisation](#) · [critical security studies](#) · ★ [causes of war: levels of analysis](#) · [types of war](#) · [conflicts of ideas & interest](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)
- **Foreign Policymaking (EA)** — [opening the "black box" \(FPA\)](#) · ★ [domestic variables](#) · [neoclassical realism](#) · ★ [US foreign policy since 2017 \(Trump\)](#) · [transformational change \(Ashbee & Hurst\)](#) · [embeddedness](#) · ★ [two-level games \(Putnam\)](#) · [does the balance vary?](#) · ★ [Fun facts](#)

Part III • The European Union as a Political System

- **EU I: The Evolution of the EU (AUW)** — what is European integration? · the EU: neither IO nor state · ★ deepening & widening · why integration began (post-WWII) · ★ the evolution timeline · ECSC → Rome · the enlargements · Maastricht & the euro · politicization & the era of crisis · Brexit: integration in reverse · ★ why integration? two theories · neofunctionalism & spillover · liberal intergovernmentalism · ★ the eurozone-crisis case · theories compared · ★ Fun facts
- **EU II: Institutions of the EU (AUW)** — where is EU authority? · the five bodies & their interests · ★ the basic architecture · European Council · Commission · Council of the EU · Parliament · CJEU · competences (exclusive/shared/supporting) · conferral · subsidiarity · proportionality · how a law is made / ★ OLP · ★ QMV · implementation · regulations · directives · decisions · positive/negative integration & Cassis · enforcement · why the architecture matters · differentiated integration · ★ LI vs neofunctionalism · ★ Fun facts

PART I · POLITICAL SYSTEMS & INSTITUTIONS

Lecture 1: Introduction — Power, Politics, and Political Science (MDJ)

Required reading: OD ch. 1 · Ansell (2023) ch. 1

Core theme: *What is politics, and how do we study it?* Two complementary lenses — OD gives you the **discipline's toolkit** (what comparative politics is + the main theory families), Ansell gives you a **single analytical engine** (political economy: self-interest → collective-action problems → the need for political "promises").

OD Ch. 1 — Introduction

Book: Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics: Concepts and Cases in Context*, 5th ed. (CQ Press/SAGE, 2021)

Chapter résumé

The opening chapter defines the field and hands you the analytical vocabulary used for the rest of the book. It answers three "meta" questions — *what* comparative politics is, *why* to study it, and *how* comparativists do research — and then lays out the **three key questions** that organize the whole discipline: **What explains political behavior? Who rules? Where and why?** Most of the chapter is a guided tour of the competing **theory families** used to answer the first two questions. It closes with the book's plan (three parts) and its method of teaching through **eleven recurring country case studies**.

★ **The heart of the chapter:** the whole field collapses into **three questions** — *what explains behaviour?* · *who rules?* · *where & why?* — answered with the **Interests / Beliefs / Structures** and **Pluralist / Elite** frameworks, all read through **Lukes' three dimensions of power**. Master those and you can attack any comparative-politics question.

Key concepts / "modes" to use

These are the analytical toolkits you're expected to *apply* to cases later:

- **Three dimensions of power** (Lukes) — the lens for spotting *where* power operates.
- **Empirical vs. normative theory** — always separate "what is" from "what *ought to be*."
- **Research methods** — single-case study • comparative method (most-similar / most-different systems) • quantitative statistics.
- **Explaining behavior** → 3 families: Interests • Beliefs • Structures.
- **Who rules** → 2 families: Pluralist vs. Elite theory.

Section-by-section main points

Comparative Politics: What Is It? / How to Study It?

What is politics? (expanded with the lecture — MDJ)

- **OD's definition:** politics = "*the process by which human communities make collective decisions*" (any scale, village → international body). This is a **procedural** definition — it's about *how* decisions get made, not their content. Four implications:
 - **Group, not private, decisions** — it concerns the group.
 - **The whole community** — decisions normally bind everyone.
 - **The process** — focus is on the decision-making *process*.
 - **≠ polity / policy** — distinguish **politics** (the process) from **polity** (the rules/institutions) and **policy** (the outcomes).
- Also: the process applies **across regime types**, needn't involve **large groups**, and is **not necessarily inclusive** (decisions are often made by small, unelected groups).
- **The distributional definitions** (what OD's definition leaves out — *the distribution of resources*):
 - **Lasswell (1936):** politics = "*who gets what, when, how.*"
 - **Easton (1953):** politics = "*the authoritative allocation of values for a society.*"
 - → politics as a distributional game: the capacity to distribute **material and non-material resources** (who wins, who loses).
 - Two key **assumptions** behind this view: ① **scarcity** of resources (no scarcity → no distributional battle) and ② **preference heterogeneity** (people want different, often conflicting, things).
- Comparative politics = the subfield comparing power & decision-making *within* countries (contrast: **international relations** studies *between/beyond* states).
- **Power — the three faces / dimensions.** *This is the chapter's master concept — it recurs as the lens for every theory later, so know it cold.* The lecture runs **one example** (a parliamentary **tax increase**) through all three so the differences are clear:

Face	Who (attribution)	Core idea	The tax example	Power =
1st · Decision-making	Dahl (1957)	A gets B to do something B would not otherwise do — observable conflict & decisions	A majority in Parliament passes the tax increase despite strong opposition	winning an observable decision
2nd · Agenda-setting	Bachrach & Baratz (1962)	Power through non-decision-making — keeping threatening issues off the agenda via rules/values	Powerful actors keep the tax increase off Parliament's agenda, so no debate or vote ever happens	controlling what gets decided
3rd · Ideological	Lukes (1974)	Shaping people's wants, perceptions & preferences — even with <i>no observable conflict</i>	People come to see taxing the wealthy as harmful/illegitimate, so the demand never even arises	shaping wants & preferences

- **The difference in one line:** the 1st face is about *winning* a visible fight; the 2nd is about *stopping the fight from happening*; the 3rd is about *making sure no one wants to fight in the first place*. Power gets **less visible** as you go down.
- **Why it's central — the recurring pay-off:** each later theory is graded by *which dimension it can see*. Rational choice & pluralists see essentially only the **1st**; rational-choice institutionalists add the **2nd**; psychological theories, postmodern discourse, historical institutionalism and elite theory reach into the **2nd & 3rd**. Being able to say "this theory only captures the first dimension" is a core analytical move.
- **Worked example of the move (straight from the book):** *Rational choice* accepts people's preferences as **given** and only asks how they rationally pursue them — so it lives purely in the **1st dimension**, ignoring how preferences are *formed*. That is exactly why it "can't explain preferences in advance" and stumbles on the cross-national union puzzle (why French unions went communist while US unions chased only wages): it has no way to see the **3rd-dimensional** forces that *shaped* those preferences. **Psychological theories** and **historical institutionalists**, which do reach the 3rd dimension, are what step in to explain it. → *This is the template: name the theory, name the dimension(s) it can't see, then name a rival theory that reaches further.*

Why Study Comparative Politics? — three benefits

1. Understand political events in specific countries (and inform foreign policy).
2. Draw **lessons** transferable from one place to another (e.g. presidential systems may worsen post-civil-war conflict — invisible if you only study the US).
3. Build **broad theories** of how politics works.

How Do Comparativists Study Politics? — methods

- No lab: political actors *react* to being studied, so no perfect control.
- **Empirical theory** = explains what *does* occur (describe pattern → explain cause → predict). **Normative theory** = what *ought* to occur. The discipline is mostly empirical, but normative concerns shape which questions get asked (and that's legitimate).
- **Three research methods:**

- Single-case study — deep dive into one case; generates/tests theory; *process tracing* links causes→effects; **deviant cases** expose theory limits. Never definitive beyond itself.
- Comparative method — mimic the lab via careful case selection:
 - **Most-similar systems** — cases alike in many ways, differ on the key variable.
 - **Most-different systems** — cases differing in many ways but sharing the outcome (e.g. revolutions: France, Russia, China, Iran...).
- Quantitative statistical techniques — reduce evidence to numbers, compare hundreds of cases (e.g. the civil-war & diamonds study: civil war driven more by *lootable resources* than ethnicity).
- **Scientific-method vocabulary**: theory · hypothesis · variable · **dependent** vs **independent** variable · **control**.
- Best modern scholarship *combines* methods (quant for patterns + case studies for causal depth).

Three Key Questions in Comparative Politics

1. **What explains political behavior?** (core of all political science)
2. **Who rules?**
3. **Where and why?** (comparativists' distinctive contribution — the same explanation across different times/places?)

Q1 — What Explains Political Behavior? → three answer-families

The chapter's (and the exam's) core. Each family splits into competing theories — below, each with its **core idea**, its **critique**, and which **face of power** it "sees." Learn the theory names + one line each.

① Interests — behaviour = actors pursuing their own preferences

Theory	Core idea	Critique	Sees face
Rational choice	Rational individuals pursue self-defined preferences instrumentally (borrowed from economics; starts at the individual).	Can't know preferences in advance → weak predictive power; struggles with cross-country variation. Group-behaviour critics: Achen & Bartels .	1st
Psychological	Non-rational factors — personal experience, emotions , personality — shape behaviour (Petersen on fear; Hetherington & Weiler on personality).	Its focus on the individual makes group behaviour hard to explain.	3rd

② Beliefs — behaviour = values & ideas

Theory	Core idea	Critique	Sees face
Political culture	Shared attitudes, values, symbols shape behaviour. <i>Modernist</i> : clear, identifiable civic values (Almond & Verba's civic culture ; postmaterialist shift, Inglehart). <i>Postmodernist</i> : culture = symbols open to interpretation in discourse (Foucault).	Do countries really have <i>one</i> culture? Culture may be an effect , not a cause; postmodernism accused of explaining nothing.	2nd–3rd
Political ideology	A systematic, conscious belief-set guides action (liberalism, communism, fascism).	May just justify actions really driven by <u>self-interest</u> or culture.	3rd

③ Structures — behaviour = shaped & limited by broad structures

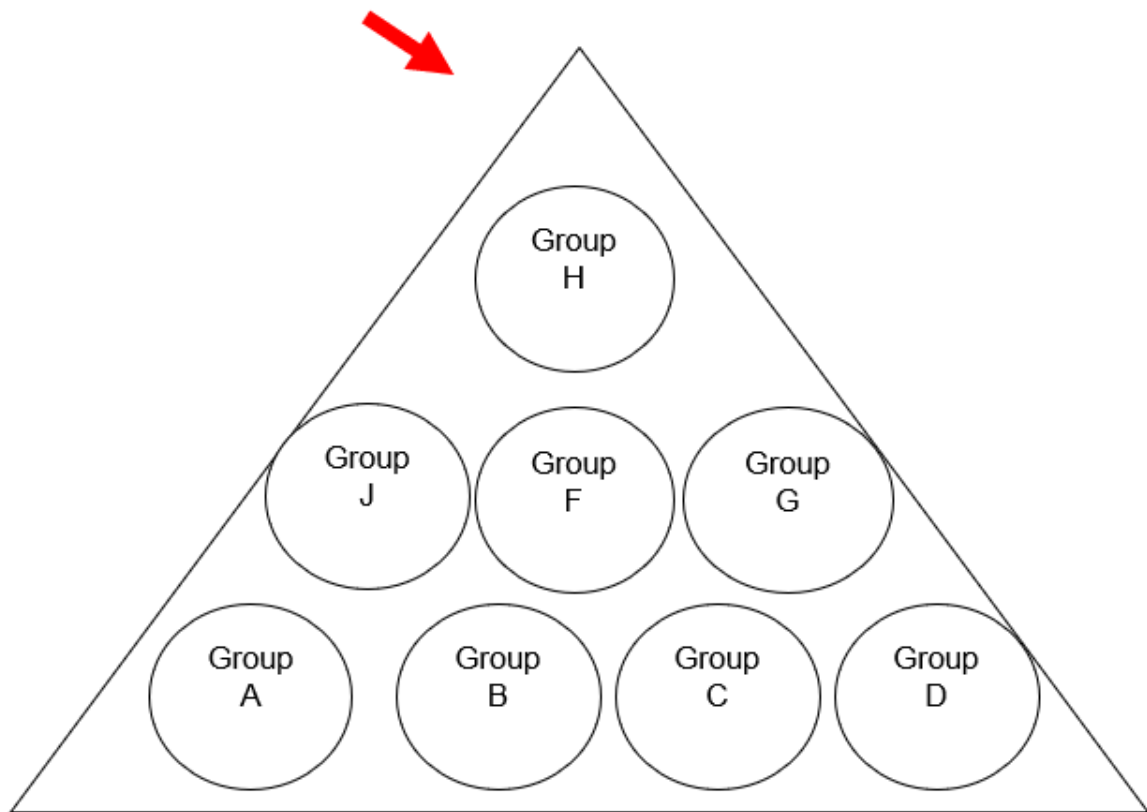
Theory	Core idea	Critique	Sees face
Marxism	Behaviour explained by class conflict rooted in the economic system (bourgeoisie vs proletariat — Marx).	Overlooks non-economic motives (religion, nationalism) and other sources of power.	2nd–3rd
Institutionalism	Institutions — the "rules of the game" — shape behaviour (<i>rational-choice institutionalist</i> , Weingast ; <i>historical institutionalist</i> , Haggard & Kaufman ; e.g. the <u>US two-term tradition</u>).	Institutions may reflect <u>self-interest</u> or culture rather than <i>cause</i> behaviour.	2nd (RC) / all 3 (historical)

Q2 — Who Rules? → two answer-families

- **Pluralist theories** (classic statement: **Robert Dahl**, *Who Governs?* 1961) — society = many competing groups; power *dispersed*; no group wins permanently; policy = compromise. (Thinks mostly in the **1st dimension** of power.) Claims to apply even to authoritarian states (Soviet factions; African patron–client networks).
- **Elite theories** — every society ruled by a small elite controlling ~all power (uses **2nd & 3rd dimensions**). Variants:
 - **Marxism** — ruling class = owners of the economy (bourgeoisie); state = "executive committee of the bourgeoisie."
 - **Power elite** (C. Wright Mills) — interlocking economic + political + military elites.
 - **Oligarchy** (Winters) — extreme wealth as power, used to protect wealth.
 - **Patriarchy** (feminist) — rule by men; politics/military tied to masculinity.
 - **Racial elite** / "**new Jim Crow**" (Alexander) — one race maintains dominance via law, wealth, discourse.
- **Test for who rules:** Who holds formal power? Who influences decisions? Who benefits? → few = elite; many = pluralist.

Visualising it (from the lecture):

Multiple groups hold and compete over power:
No singular center of power



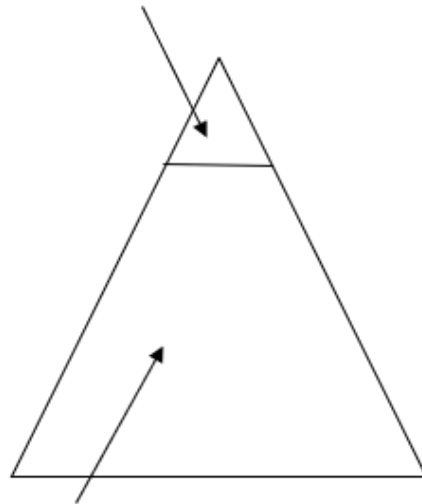
- Multiple groups, but few (elites) hold power

Elite:

Government,
corporations.

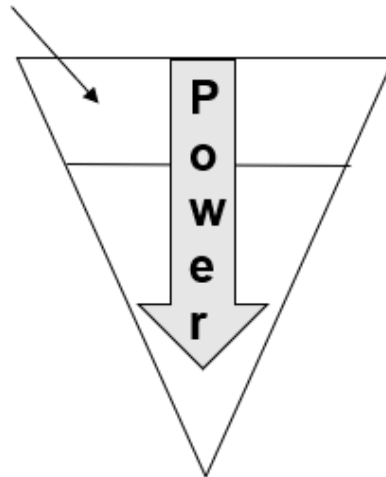
Elite power:

- Disproportional to size
- Governs society



Society: Public, organisations

- Largest group(s) with little power



How to read them. *Pluralist* (first diagram): power is **dispersed** among many competing groups — *no single centre*. *Elitist* (second): a **small elite** (government, corporations) sits at the top and holds power **disproportionate** to its size, while the **largest group** — **the public/society** — **has little power**; the inverted triangle shows **power flowing down** onto them. Same society, opposite claim about where power really sits.

Q3 — Where and Why?

- Add the **comparative dimension** to Q1 & Q2: why do welfare states differ (see the [Sweden vs US welfare state case](#))? Explanations compete — rational choice / ideology / institutions. Comparison across cases reveals patterns a single case hides.

Plan of the Book

- **Part I** — the state (what it is, strong/weak; state–citizen–regime; state–identity).
- **Part II** — how political systems work (democratic & authoritarian institutions; participation; regime change).
- **Part III** — [political economy & policy](#).
- **11 recurring country cases**: 4 wealthy democracies (Britain, Germany, Japan, US); 2 post-communist (China, Russia); largest enduring democracy (India); the one theocracy (Iran); 3 post-authoritarian democracies (Brazil, Mexico, Nigeria).

Cases & examples

The concrete cases the chapter uses. Each one: *what actually happened* → *what it illustrates*.

- **Tunisia vs Syria (2011)**. Both were swept up in the Arab Spring protests, yet the outcomes split completely: Tunisia negotiated a relatively **peaceful transition to democracy**, while Syria collapsed into a long, brutal **civil war**. → *Illustrates*: why comparison matters — understanding a country's internal dynamics has real foreign-policy stakes; it also undercuts the lazy claim that "Arab/Islamic culture" is uniformly anti-democratic (same culture-family, opposite results).
- **Post-civil-war presidentialism**. Americans treat their directly-elected presidency as *the* stable model. But in a country just out of civil war it's **winner-take-all**: only one side's candidate can win the top job, so the losers may prefer to **restart the war** than live with the result. A **power-sharing** system that gives every major group a slice of national power tends to be safer. → *Illustrates*: a lesson you simply cannot see by studying the US alone — the payoff of comparison.
- **Civil war & diamonds** (Collier & Hoeffler; **Sierra Leone**). A large **quantitative** study of hundreds of civil wars found that **ethnic division is not the main cause** people assume. War is far more likely where a group can seize a **valuable, lootable resource** — like the diamonds fuelling Sierra Leone's 1990s war. Where there's no such prize, ethnic division rarely turns violent. → *Illustrates*: the quantitative method + a genuinely counter-intuitive finding.
- **Ukraine 2014** — "is it a civil war?" When fighting erupted in 2014 (with a Russian military presence backing one side), scholars couldn't cleanly classify it: *how much* violence, for *how long*, before it "counts" as a civil war? → *Illustrates*: the hard first step of any scientific study — **defining and measuring your variables** precisely.
- **Almond & Verba, *The Civic Culture* (1963)**. They surveyed citizens across five countries and argued that stable democracies (US, UK) share a "**civic culture**" — people participate *and* defer enough to let leaders govern — whereas **Mexico** had a "**subject**" culture (citizens saw themselves as subjects, not participants), fitting its authoritarian rule until 2000. → *Illustrates*: the classic **modernist** political-culture claim — and the standard critique that culture may be an *effect* of institutions, not their cause.
- **US Catholics shifting Democrat → Republican**. Mid-20th-c. working-class Catholics voted **Democrat** on economic interest. As they grew affluent, they came to prioritise **moral/cultural** issues (e.g. abortion) and drifted **Republican**. → *Illustrates*: **postmaterialism** (Inglehart) — political culture changing over time and reshaping party alignments.
- **"Family values" (Reagan vs Clinton)**. No US politician dares oppose "family values," yet the phrase has **no fixed meaning**: Reagan's Republicans used it to claim the traditional middle-class family; Clinton's Democrats **reinterpreted** it to mean single mothers and two-income families needing afterschool programmes. → *Illustrates*: the **postmodernist** point — political symbols are contested and redefined through **discourse** (a play for the 3rd dimension of power).
- **Unions: France / US / UK**. Same institution, three preference-sets: **French** unions tied themselves to the **Communist Party** and pursued broad ideological goals; **US** unions stayed "bread-and-butter" (wages & conditions), shunning socialist parties; **British** unions built their own **Labour Party**. → *Illustrates*: the puzzle for **rational choice** — it takes preferences as given, so it can't explain *why* they differ so sharply across countries (this is the worked example above).
- **US two-term tradition** (Washington → FDR). Washington voluntarily stepped down after two terms; **no president broke the norm for 150+ years** until FDR won a third term in **1940** — after which it was written into the Constitution (22nd Amendment). → *Illustrates*: an **informal institution** that shaped behaviour purely because leaders and citizens believed it *should*.

- **Chile's democratic transition (1990s)**. One of the most successful exits from military rule — explained three different ways: **rational-choice institutionalists** (elites cut a strategic constitutional bargain that served their interests), **political-culture** theorists (Chilean values favoured democracy), **historical institutionalists** (Chile could revive its earlier stable democratic institutions, a legacy neighbours lacked). → *Illustrates*: how the **same event** gets three competing explanations — and the analyst's job is to weigh them.
- **Sweden vs US welfare state**. Sweden runs a large, expensive welfare state; the US spends far less. Why do two rich democracies diverge? **Interests**: strong labour won in Sweden, business overpowered labour in the US. **Beliefs**: Sweden's dominant Socialists spread social-democratic ideology; US "make it on your own" culture rejects socialism. **Institutions**: Sweden's unified labour body (LO) became central to policymaking; US unions stayed decentralised and weak. → *Illustrates*: the lead "**Where and why?**" puzzle, with one answer from each theory family.
- **US corporate power / oligarchy** (Winters). Is the US genuinely democratic if a **corporate elite** holds outsized power? Winters argues extreme wealth ("material power") lets **oligarchs** hire lawyers and lobbyists to shield their income from redistribution. → *Illustrates*: a "**Who rules?**" case pitting elite theory against pluralism.

The 11 recurring countries (used across the whole book): Britain, Germany, Japan, USA (wealthy democracies) • China, Russia (post-communist) • India (largest democracy) • Iran (theocracy) • Brazil, Mexico, Nigeria (post-authoritarian).

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Politics	Process by which communities make collective decisions (procedural; group, whole community, ≠ polity/policy)
Polity / Policy	The rules & institutions / the outcomes (vs <i>politics</i> = the process)
Distributional game	Politics as allocating resources — "who gets what" (Lasswell; Easton)
Scarcity / Preference heterogeneity	The two assumptions behind the distributional view of politics
Comparative politics	Subfield comparing power/decision-making across countries
Three faces of power	(1) decision-making, Dahl; (2) agenda-setting, Bachrach & Baratz; (3) ideological, Lukes
Empirical / Normative theory	Explains what <i>does</i> / what <i>ought to</i> occur
Single-case study	Deep study of one case (uses process tracing)
Comparative method	Careful case selection: most-similar vs most-different systems
Rational choice theory	Actors rationally pursue self-defined preferences
Political culture	Widely held attitudes/values/symbols about politics
Civic culture	Culture supporting stable democracy (Almond & Verba)
Political ideology	Conscious systematic belief-set about how politics <i>ought to be</i>
Institutionalism	Institutions ("rules of the game") explain behavior
Pluralist theory	Power dispersed among competing groups
Elite theory	A small elite controls virtually all power
Patriarchy	Rule by men

Exam pointers

- Be able to **apply the 3 dimensions of power** to an example, and say which theory family "sees" which dimension.
- Know the **Interests / Beliefs / Structures** trichotomy for Q1 and **Pluralist vs Elite** for Q2 — with one named theorist per box (the names are in the two tables above: e.g. Interests → *Achen & Bartels / Petersen*; Beliefs → *Almond & Verba, Inglehart, Foucault*; Structures → *Marx, Weingast*; Pluralist → *Dahl*; Elite → *Mills, Winters, Alexander*).
- Distinguish **most-similar vs most-different** systems designs with an example.
- Always flag **empirical vs normative** when a question mixes them.

Ansell — *Why Politics Fails*, Ch. 1

Book: Ben Ansell (2023), *Why Politics Fails: The Five Traps of the Modern World – and How to Escape Them*, Penguin.

Note: the provided PDF is titled "**Introduction: Simple Problems, Impossible Politics**" — this is the framing chapter the syllabus lists as "chapter 1." It sets up the whole book.

Chapter résumé

Ansell argues that our biggest challenges (climate change is the opening example) are often "**simple problems with impossible politics**": we understand the solution but can't get people to act. The reason is **political economy** — individuals are **self-interested**, and **self-interest** predictably collides with the collective good, producing **collective-action problems**. He introduces the **five goals** we broadly agree on — **Democracy, Equality, Solidarity, Security, Prosperity** — each of which is also a **trap**. Politics is fundamentally about making **collective promises** to each other; but promises can't be externally enforced, so they only work when made **self-enforcing** through **institutions** and **norms**. The book's project: learn to spot the five traps and escape them.

★ **The heart of the chapter:** one chain explains why politics fails — **self-interest** → **collective-action problem** → **tragedy of the commons** → **the need for self-enforcing political promises (institutions & norms)**. If you learn one thing here, learn to run that chain.

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Political economy** — model individuals as self-interested utility-maximizers, then scale up to society.
- **Self-interest** → **preferences** → **constraints** → **trade-offs** — the micro engine.
- **Collective-action problem** — self-interested individuals undermine a shared goal.
- **Tragedy of the commons & externalities** (negative/positive) — the recurring failure shapes.
- **Politics as promises** — collective, unenforceable, needing **self-enforcing** design.
- **Institutions** (formal rules) & **norms** (informal expectations) — what makes promises stick.
- **The Five Traps:** Democracy · Equality · Solidarity · Security · Prosperity.

Section-by-section main points

Opening — Simple Problems, Impossible Politics

- Climate change: science is a century old and well understood; the road from emissions → warming is *simple*. The hard part is getting anyone to act — a **global problem with domestic politics**. No world government to enforce, so everyone free-rides.
- International attempts show politics *can* work (Paris 2015) or fail (Kyoto, Copenhagen) — success came from flexibility, vague wording, deferral.
- Climate tests all **five** goals: democracy (global consensus?), equality (should richer pay more?), solidarity (do rich nations owe poor?), security (climate refugees, enforcement?), prosperity (short-term gain vs long-term survival).

Common ground

- **Politics** = how we make collective decisions / make promises to each other in an uncertain world. Essential for solving shared dilemmas.

- **Double-edged sword:** we need politics but hate it; we look for alternatives (markets, technology, strong leaders) but these are "**false gods**" — they still run into human disagreement.
- Disagreement is **inevitable** (elections have losers; spending is unequal; who guards the guards?). Push politics down in one place, it pops up elsewhere ("paste in the toothpaste tube").
- Despite polarization, most people **agree on five things** — which are also five **traps**.

| The five goals (each a trap)

- **Democracy** — right/ability of the mass public to choose and replace leaders. ~½ the world lives in democracies; broadly popular (86% in World Values Survey favor it) but under pressure (the "third wave" stalled; populism, referendums, attacks on media/expertise).
- **Equality** — everyone treated the same; but debate over *outcomes* vs *opportunities* and redistribution. Wide consensus that income gaps are too large (2019: only 7% disagreed), yet inequality has *risen* in rich countries since the 1980s → populist backlash ("inequality paradox").
- **Solidarity** — support for fellow citizens in hard times (illness, bad luck). Underpins popular "third-rail" policies (US Social Security, UK NHS). COVID-19 showed global health interdependence.
- **Security** — the most basic desire: to be safe. 70% prefer security over freedom (highest where war is recent). Concerns: violence *within* states, police violence ("who guards us from our protectors?"), return of interstate war (Ukraine).
- **Prosperity** — enough money to live/grow; but endless growth warms the planet → trade-off between prosperity and environmental survival.

| Political economy (the method)

- The school of thought taking seriously how individual and society interact: start with a **model of each of us** (what we want + how we plan to get it), then pan out to society and watch **best-laid plans undermined by... us**.
- **Basic model:** everyone is **self-interested** — has ordered **preferences** and tries to **maximize utility** (pick the highest-value option). Not an ethical claim — a *predictive analytical tool*.
- **Methodological individualism:** start from individuals, not classes/cultures/groups.
- **Constraints & trade-offs:** you can't have everything (physical, institutional, social limits) → every choice sacrifices an alternative (coffee vs tea; lower taxes vs social liberalism at the ballot box).
- Even **voting** is a puzzle: your single vote is unlikely to be decisive, so turnout must be partly explained by a sense of **duty**. Politicians too are self-interested (must win elections → campaign arms race).
- Studying self-interest is **liberating**, not cynical: even apparently selfless behavior often has a self-interested logic (e.g. the rich opposing public-education spending that "devalues" their kids' advantage).

| Collective-action problems

- When self-interested individuals interact, they can inadvertently wreck a shared goal.
- **Example — the Cod Wars** (Britain vs Iceland, 1950s–70s): overfishing a shared resource.
- **Tragedy of the commons:** without ownership, everyone fishes freely → stocks collapse; my self-interest hurts yours.
- **Externalities:** a market action's effect on a third party — mostly **negative** (pollution, congestion), sometimes **positive** (a neighbor's rose garden). Political life is "full of externalities."

- Root cause: we are **interdependent** — my choice affects your options — and we can't commit others (or ourselves) to "do the right thing." *The making of a tragedy*.

Politics as a promise

- We're *smart*: we anticipate what others will do — which is exactly why collective-action problems arise (can't blame "stupidity").
- Politics = making **collective promises** (politicians→voters, allies→adversaries). A **promise** ≠ a **contract**: it **can't be legally enforced by a third party** — there's *no higher power than politics itself*.
- So political promises are **fragile and temporary**; they succeed only when self-enforcing — designed so that reneging is hard.
- Two tools to grant promises permanence:
 - **Institutions** — formal rules/organizations that lock in expectations (e.g. the **US Senate filibuster**: powerful, flawed, over-represents small states, hard to remove safely — shows institutions structure behavior even when dysfunctional).
 - **Norms** — informal expectations about how we should behave; invisible but powerful, vaguer and harder to enforce than rules; not every leader can invoke them.
- Because institutions & norms vary, **politics plays out differently around the world** (e.g. Nordic high-trust, inclusive systems are hard to transplant).

The traps (close)

- Each of the five goals faces a **trap triggered by self-interest** that blocks the collective goal. Traps aren't destiny — but they're **insidious, pervasive, even enticing**.
- Two options: spot the traps "in the wild" and step around them, or — if already caught — learn to **escape**. *Only by understanding why politics fails can we make it succeed*.

The chain, run once (worked). This is the single argument the whole chapter builds — here it is end-to-end on the Cod Wars:

1. **Self-interest**. Every fisherman, British and Icelandic, tries to maximise his *own* catch (the political-economy starting model).
2. → **Collective-action problem**. They're **interdependent** — fishing the *same* sea — so each one acting on self-interest undermines the shared goal (a sustainable stock). Individually rational, collectively ruinous.
3. → **Tragedy of the commons / externality**. The sea is **unowned and hard to monitor**, so no one can be excluded → everyone overfishes → the stock collapses (tragedy of the commons). Put the other way: my extra catch imposes a cost on you — a negative externality.
4. → **Need for political promises**. We'd all be better off with a binding catch limit, but there's **no world government** to enforce one — so the *states* must make **political promises** to each other on behalf of their fishermen.
5. → **Institutions & norms**. A promise can't be enforced by any third party, so it only holds if it's self-enforcing — locked in by **institutions** (formal rules: recognised fishing limits/zones) and **norms** (informal expectations). When Iceland kept *extending* its limits, the promise broke and new ones were needed — *"politics never ends"*.

Reusable template (works on any trap): name the self-interest → show the **interdependence** that makes it a collective-action problem → identify the commons/externality failure → state the **promise** that would fix it → name the **institution/norm** that could make the promise stick.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Political economy	Study of how self-interested individuals and society interact
Self-interest	Model assumption: people pursue their own ordered preferences
Utility maximization	Choosing the option that yields the highest personal value
Constraint / trade-off	Limits force sacrifice of one option for another
Collective-action problem	Self-interested individuals undermine a shared goal
Tragedy of the commons	Unowned shared resource gets over-exploited
Externality	Effect of a transaction on a third party (negative/positive)
Politics-as-promise	Collective promises that no third party can enforce
Self-enforcing	Arrangement where reneging is made costly/hard
Institution	Formal rule/organization locking in expectations (e.g. filibuster)
Norm	Informal expectation about proper behavior
The Five Traps	Democracy, Equality, Solidarity, Security, Prosperity

Exam pointers

- Memorize the **five goals/traps** (Democracy, Equality, Solidarity, Security, Prosperity) — the spine of the whole book.
- Be able to **run the chain**: self-interest → collective-action problem → tragedy of the commons/externalities → need for political promises → institutions & norms (*worked end-to-end above*).
- Use the **Cod Wars** / **tragedy of the commons** as your go-to worked example.
- Key distinction: a **promise** (unenforceable, needs to be self-enforcing) vs a **contract** (third-party enforced).

Bridge to OD

Both readings converge on **institutions** and on modelling actors via **interests/self-interest** (OD's "Interests" family = Ansell's political-economy engine). Ansell's "politics = collective decisions" is almost verbatim OD's definition of **politics**. Good to cite them together on *why institutions matter*.

★ Fun facts & memorable details

The sticky examples, surprising stats and quotable lines from this module — the stuff worth dropping into an essay or exam answer.

Memorable examples (great to cite)

- **The Cod Wars** (Britain vs Iceland, 1950s–70s): two NATO allies clashing over cod — boats rammed, one accidental death by electrocution, and Icelandic coastguards fitting **wire-cutters** to slash British trawler

nets. A perfect little tragedy-of-the-commons story. (Ansell)

- **Civil war & diamonds:** statistical research (Collier & Hoeffler) found civil wars are driven more by control of **lootable resources** — diamonds, e.g. Sierra Leone — than by ethnic division. (OD)
- **The "new Jim Crow"** (Michelle Alexander): mass incarceration reframed as a modern system of racial control. (OD)
- **George Washington's two-term tradition:** an *informal* institution that held for 150+ years until FDR broke it in 1940 — then it was locked into the Constitution. (OD)
- **"Family values"** as a contested symbol — Reagan's Republicans and Clinton's Democrats each reinterpreted it (the postmodernist point about discourse). (OD)

Surprising stats

- **86%** worldwide (World Values Survey) say democracy is a good way to run a country — and in **China, Ethiopia, Iran & Tajikistan over 90%** agree with pro-democracy statements, *more* than in the US. (Ansell)
- **~70%** say they'd prefer **security over freedom** — highest where war is recent. (Ansell)
- **~95%** across wealthy countries think government should provide healthcare — even **85% in the US**. (Ansell)
- **2016** was, by some counts, the **most violent year since WWII**. (Ansell)

Quotable lines

- Marx: the modern state is "*the executive committee of the whole bourgeoisie*." (OD)
- Keynes: "*In the long run we are all dead*." — on why forecasting fails. (Ansell)
- Ansell on the inescapability of politics: push it down in one place and it pops up in another, "*like the proverbial paste in the toothpaste tube*."
- The **NHS** as Britain's "*national religion*." (Ansell)

Trivia

- OD's example of why natural science can be "purer": South Korea's **Woo Suk Hwang faked stem-cell results** — but biologists don't get *normatively* attached to findings the way political scientists do.
- The CO₂-warming theory dates to **1861**, revived in a **1956 New York Times** piece imagining "tigers roaming... and squawking Arctic parrots." (Ansell)

Lecture 2: The State (AUW)

Required reading: OD ch. 2 (*The Modern State*) • OD ch. 4 (*States and Identity*)

Theme of the lecture: the **state** itself — first *what a modern state is* and why some are strong while others fail (ch. 2), then how **identity** (nation, ethnicity, race, class, religion, gender, sexuality) becomes the central challenge to the state and to the liberal ideal of equal citizenship (ch. 4). Ch. 2 gives you the **anatomy** of the state; ch. 4 shows the **fault lines** running through it.

Lecture frame (AUW — Ayça Uygur Wessel). The lecture hangs both chapters on **four questions** — use them as the skeleton:

1. **What is a state?** → the four characteristics (OD Ch. 2).
2. **Where did states come from?** → two pathways: **European (war-driven)** & **colonial**.
3. **Why are some states stronger than others?** → theories of **strength & weakness**.

4. Who does the state represent? → the **nation** / **identity** puzzle (OD Ch. 4).

State ≠ Nation ≠ Regime ≠ Government (*memorise the one-liners*):

- **State** — the *permanent administrative apparatus*.
- **Nation** — a *group of people with a shared sense of belonging*.
- **Regime** — the *fundamental rules* of the state (its type).
- **Government** — the *people who currently run* the state.

Two exam-style puzzles the lecture poses:

- **What comes first?** Is there a neat causal order **Territory → Sovereignty → Legitimacy → Bureaucracy**, or are the four **mutually reinforcing**? (Best answer: mostly mutually reinforcing — bureaucracy raises the tax that funds the army that defends the territory that grounds sovereignty...)
- **Greenland:** rate its characteristics — strong on **territory**, but weak external sovereignty (part of Denmark). Shows the characteristics come in **degrees**, not all-or-nothing.

OD Ch. 2 — The Modern State

Book: Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 2.

Chapter résumé

Defines the **modern state** — the foundational unit of comparative politics — and separates it from *country*, *nation*, *government*, and *regime*. It argues every modern state shares **four characteristics** (territory, external/internal sovereignty, legitimacy, bureaucracy) that make it an exceptionally powerful ruling apparatus. It traces the state's **historical origins** (first in Europe, 15th–18th c., then exported worldwide by colonialism, universal only by the 1960s) and explains why states vary in **strength** (the strong/weak/failed spectrum, political goods, the resource curse, quasi-states). ~Half the chapter is eleven country case studies ranked strongest→weakest — so weight your revision toward the cases.

★ **The heart of the chapter:** a modern state = **four characteristics** (territory • external + internal sovereignty • legitimacy • bureaucracy); *how fully a state has them* decides whether it is **strong, weak, or failed**. Use the four as a checklist on any case.

The red thread. One question runs through the whole chapter: **does an entity have the four characteristics — and how fully?** That single test defines what a state is (the characteristics), explains where states *came from* (building the four via war & colonialism), and grades why they *differ in strength* (strong = has all four; failed = has lost them). Every case is scored on the same four.

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The four characteristics of the modern state** — the analytic backbone: **territory • external & internal sovereignty • legitimacy • bureaucracy**.
- **Sovereignty split:** *external* (recognised independence from outside powers) vs *internal* (sole law-making/enforcing authority inside) — they can come apart.
- **Weber's monopoly on the legitimate use of force** — the state claims to be the only body that may legitimately coerce.

- **Weber's three types of legitimacy** — traditional • charismatic • rational-legal.
- **Strong / weak / failed state** — a *continuum* measured by whether the state supplies political goods (security, rule of law, infrastructure).
- **Ideal type** — no real state matches the model perfectly; use it as a yardstick.

Section-by-section main points

What is a state? — state vs. the rest

Core: don't confuse the four — **state** (the apparatus) ≠ **government** (who runs it now) ≠ **regime** (the type of rules) ≠ **nation** (a people).

- A **state** = "an ongoing administrative apparatus that develops and administers laws and implements policies in a specific territory." **Government** = the transient occupants (US: "administrations"); **regime** = the *type* of government (liberal democracy, fascism — ch. 3); **nation** = a people with shared identity (ch. 4); **country** = too vague for analysis.

The four characteristics of a state (*heavily emphasised*)

Core: four features together make the state a uniquely powerful ruling apparatus — **the checklist you score every case on.**

- ① **Territory** — clearly defined borders; sizes range from Russia (6.5m sq mi) to micro-states under 200 sq mi. Borders still shift (Kosovo 2008, South Sudan 2011), usually to align state with nation.
- ② **External vs internal sovereignty** — *external* = recognised independence (counter-examples: colonies, Vichy France, Manchukuo — had territory/government but externally controlled); *internal* = sole authority to make/enforce law, defended against secession. A state needs *others to recognise it* (see the Somaliland case). Sovereignty ≠ omnipotence.
- ③ **Legitimacy** — the recognised right to rule; boosts sovereignty *far more cheaply than force*. **Weber's three types:** **traditional** (long-standing custom — divine right of kings), **charismatic** (personal virtue/heroism — early Mao), **rational-legal** (leaders chosen by accepted laws — elected under a constitution; Weber's marker of *modern* rule). In practice regimes **blend all three**. Collier: without legitimacy you get **repression, conflict, or "theater."**
- ④ **Bureaucracy** — appointed officials who implement law (collect tax, run the army, pave roads). Weak legitimacy + weak bureaucracy = the two key drivers of state weakness.

Where did states come from? — two pathways (*moderate*)

Core: the four characteristics were **built two ways** — Europe by *war & competition*, the rest by *colonial conquest* — and the route shapes later capacity.

① **European pathway** — "war made the state" (Charles Tilly). A causal flow driven by **military competition**:

Feudalism (overlapping authorities) → **absolute monarchies** (consolidate territory & sovereignty; "*L'état, c'est moi*" — state not yet separate from the ruler) → **war & political competition** (15th–18th-c. rulers were "war-lords/ladies") → **taxation + armies + administration** → **efficient bureaucracies** → **stronger territorial states.**

- **Tilly's four activities** (each reinforces the state — he likens the early state to a **protection racket**): **war-making** (neutralise external rivals) • **state-making** (neutralise internal rivals) • **protection** (neutralise clients' enemies) • **extraction** (raise the **tax** to fund the first three).
- **Brandenburg-Prussia** (*worked example*): surrounded by larger powers → needed armies → needed revenue (poor economy) → heavy **taxation in return for protection** → efficient bureaucracy → high **state capacity**. Prussia was strong **not because it always won**, but because it had to fight in a **very competitive environment**, which raised the incentive to build a strong state.
- Competition cut Europe from ~500 **sovereign entities in 1500** to ~50 today. The *truly* modern state arrives once it is seen as **separate from the ruler** and liberalism turns subjects into **citizens** (Glorious Revolution 1688; French Revolution 1789). (*Premodern states elsewhere ruled **people** more than precise territory — China's Confucian bureaucracy was closest to modern, ~1,800 years early.*)

② **Colonial pathway — statehood through conquest.** European powers **exported** borders, administrative structures and international recognition — but colonial borders **ignored existing political communities**. Result: **statehood ≠ state capacity** — postcolonial states inherited legal external sovereignty but **weak internal sovereignty**, imposed institutions and divided loyalties → mostly **very weak states** (universal statehood only by the 1960s). **Main take-away: the origins of statehood shape how *capacity* later develops.**

Why are some states stronger? — strong / weak / failed (*heavily emphasised*)

Core: strength = how many political goods the state actually delivers — a *continuum* (strong → weak → failed), not three boxes, and a state can be strong on one characteristic, weak on another.

- States supply political goods (Rotberg: security, rule of law, infrastructure). **Strong** = provides them generally; **weak** = only partially; **failed** = loses effective sovereignty over part/all territory (Syria, DRC, Afghanistan). Strength is a **continuum** and can move *both* ways (Fukuyama: even the US state has weakened).
- **Vicious cycle of weakness:** no resources → falling legitimacy → underpaid officials → corruption → worse services → citizens turn to mafias/private justice → the monopoly on force erodes further.
- **Why states differ — theories of *strength* (name + who):**
 - **Warfare** (Tilly) — external threats force state-building (Prussia).
 - **Colonial legacies** (Acemoglu, Johnson & Robinson) — externally imposed institutions shape later state capacity (Congo, Nigeria).
 - **Elite agreements** (North, Wallis & Weingast) — elites trade *private violence* for **impersonal institutions & the rule of law** (England).
 - (+ *Fukuyama's two paths: bureaucracy-first Prussia/Germany vs democracy-first US → machine politics.*)
- **Theories of *weakness*:**
 - **Resource curse** — resource dependence weakens **accountability** and breeds corruption (mineral revenue lets rulers ignore citizens; gives rebels a prize — *not* inevitable, cf. Norway).
 - **International system** — international **recognition** props up quasi-states that couldn't otherwise survive (post-1945 norm against conquest; Cold War patrons).
- Measured by the **Fragile States Index** (178 states, 12 factors — the chapter questions its equal weighting).

Cases & examples

Why these cases are here — circle them back to the theme. The chapter isn't telling eleven country stories for their own sake: each is a **worked example of the chapter's spine** — the **four characteristics**, the **strong**

→ **weak** → **failed** spectrum, and the **different bases of legitimacy** (Weber's three types). Read *every* case for three things: (1) **how strong, and why** · (2) **its basis of legitimacy** · (3) **any sovereignty problem**. The table maps each case to the concept it best demonstrates; the write-ups below give the story, and each closing → **line** states the tie back to the theme.

Case	Strength	Basis of legitimacy	Best demonstrates (chapter concept)
Germany	Strongest	shifting → liberal democracy	Fukuyama's bureaucracy-first path; first welfare state
Japan	Strong	democracy (emperor symbolic)	defensive modernisation
UK	Strong	traditional → rational-legal	slow evolution ; sovereignty is reversible (Brexit)
USA	Strong	rational-legal (written constitution)	Fukuyama's democracy-first path; state built by design
Mexico	Moderate	liberal democracy (post-PRI)	loss of the monopoly on force
China	Moderate	economic performance	legitimacy without democracy
Brazil	Moderate	cycled through all types	legitimacy can rest on many bases
India	Moderate–weak	liberal democracy	democracy surviving in a weak state
Russia	Weak	nationalism	external strength ≠ internal rule of law
Iran	Weak	theocracy	theocratic legitimacy
Nigeria	Weakest	contested	weak postcolonial state + resource curse
Somaliland	(boxed)	—	internal vs external sovereignty are separable
ISIS	(boxed)	religious only	the four characteristics as a checklist

- **Somaliland (internal vs external sovereignty)**. After Somalia collapsed in 1991, this ex-British region declared independence, wrote a 2001 constitution (an elected house + a house of **clan elders**), held real elections and grew on livestock/remittances — yet **no state recognises it** (one embassy, Ethiopia's). → *Shows the two sovereignties are separable*: it has near-full internal sovereignty but zero external — and looks more state-like than recognised Somalia.
- **ISIS — "was it a state?"** From its 2014 caliphate to 2017 defeat it held Belgium-sized territory (~6m people), taxed "every bushel of wheat" and ran a bureaucracy (even a DMV). But territory was only nominal, it rejected the international system (no external sovereignty), its legitimacy was purely religious, and it failed at **security**. → *Verdict: only "partially" a state* — the four characteristics used as a diagnostic checklist. (Tilly: "war made the state, and the state made war.")
- **Germany — first modern welfare state (strongest of the 11)**. Unified late (1871, Bismarck) on a merit-based **Prussian bureaucracy/military**; Bismarck built **Europe's first welfare programs** to undercut socialists. Legitimacy lurched: nationalism → Nazism → divided 1945–90 → reunified 1990, then led EU integration. → *Strong state despite a turbulent history; Fukuyama's "bureaucracy-first" path; voluntary ceding of sovereignty to the EU.*
- **Japan — determined sovereignty**. Consolidated under the **Tokugawa shogunate (1603)**; after US warships forced it open (1853), the **1867 Meiji Restoration** built a modern army, bureaucracy and constitution (1889) — the **first non-Western modern economy**. Militarism → WWII → US occupation

(first lost sovereignty in 400 years) → US-written pacifist democracy. → *Defensive modernisation; democracy replaces monarchy as legitimacy while the emperor stays symbolic.*

- **United Kingdom — the long evolution.** The opposite of the US: centuries of gradual change — single monarch from 1603, **Acts of Union 1707**, **Glorious Revolution 1688** starting the shift to liberal-democratic legitimacy; first to industrialise → global empire. → *Slow evolutionary state-building; sovereignty is reversible* — Scottish referendum (2014, lost 55–45) and **Brexit (2016)** reclaiming powers from the EU.
- **United States — a consciously crafted state.** Almost uniquely **created by design** (Declaration 1776 → Constitution after the failed Articles). Sovereignty tested by the **Civil War**; the Constitution built **federalism** and preserved slavery. Bureaucracy came *late* (machine politics until the **1880s Pendleton Act**). → *Rational-legal legitimacy via a written constitution; Fukuyama's "democracy-first" path; top external power but internally weakened by the legacy of slavery/racial inequality.*
- **Mexico — challenges to internal sovereignty.** A very weak first state (lost half its territory to the US, 1846–48); order under **Porfirio Díaz**, then the **Revolution (1910–20)** and **75 years of PRI rule** (electoral authoritarianism on oil + clientelism), ending with **Fox in 2000**. → *Above all, the loss of the monopoly on force* — drug cartels killed 75,000–100,000 in a decade.
- **China — economic legitimacy over reform.** Had a merit **Confucian bureaucracy** ~1,800 years before **Europe**; empire fell 1912 → **Communist victory 1949** (Mao; famine ≥20m dead) → after 1976 **Deng's** market reforms → history's fastest growth, now the #2 economy. → *Legitimacy shifts from communist ideology + Mao's charisma to economic performance* (a "modernising authoritarian" regime), tightening under Xi.
- **Brazil — many bases of legitimacy.** Had **more slaves than any American colony** and was the **last to abolish slavery (1888)**; gained independence peacefully as a monarchy. Cycled through charisma, **clientelism (the coronéis)**, Vargas's quasi-fascist **Estado Novo**, and military rule (1964–85) to democracy — then the **Petrobras scandal → 2016 impeachment**. → *A state that cycled through nearly every basis of legitimacy; corruption undermines the bureaucracy.*
- **India — enduring democracy in a weak state.** Territory forged by British rule; independence **1947** (Congress/Gandhi — the first successful 20th-c. anticolonial movement) amid **Partition** (largest migration in history, ≥1m dead). → *Uniquely for a postcolonial state, its legitimacy is continuous liberal democracy*, but the state is weak — corruption, mass poverty, Hindu–Muslim tension (its worst FSI indicator).
- **Russia — strong external, weak rule of law.** Four regimes: tsarist absolutism → the **communist USSR** (Stalin's modernisation killed ~20m) → a fragile 1990s democracy (oligarchs, mafias) → **Putin's electoral authoritarianism**; the USSR split into **15 states in 1991**; **Crimea annexed 2014**. → *External strength and nationalist legitimacy decoupled from internal rule of law.*
- **Iran — legitimacy via theocracy.** Heir to ancient Persia; **never colonised** but dominated by Britain/Russia; the **Pahlavi** modernising-authoritarian state (1925–79) → the **1979 revolution** under **Khomeini → the first modern theocracy**. → *Legitimacy runs monarchy → modernising authoritarianism → Islamic theocracy*; secure territory but a fairly weak state (corruption, sanctions, contested legitimacy).
- **Nigeria — an extremely weak state (weakest of the 11).** A colonial patchwork (Muslim north; Yoruba west; stateless Igbo east) under British "indirect rule"; independence 1960 → **Biafra civil war (1967–70, ~1m dead)** as oil came online; six coups; fragile democracy from 1999. → *The classic weak postcolonial state plus the resource curse* — oil fuels corruption and secession; sovereignty threatened by **Boko Haram**.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
State	Ongoing administrative apparatus making/implementing law in a territory
Government / Regime	The transient occupants / the type of government
Territory	Area with defined borders a state claims
External sovereignty	Recognised independence from outside powers
Internal sovereignty	Sole authority to make/enforce law inside
Legitimacy	The recognised right to rule
Traditional legitimacy	Right to rule from long-standing custom
Charismatic legitimacy	Right to rule from personal virtue/heroism
Rational-legal legitimacy	Right to rule via accepted laws/procedures
Bureaucracy	Appointed officials who implement the law
Feudal states / Absolutism	Overlapping sovereignties / single-monarch exclusive rule
Ideal type	Model of the purest version of something
Political goods	Security, rule of law, infrastructure a state provides
Strong / weak / failed state	Provides political goods generally / partially / loses sovereignty
Resource curse	Reliance on one resource lets the state ignore citizens
Quasi-states	Legally recognised but lacking a functioning state apparatus
Clientelism	Exchange of material resources for political support

Exam pointers

- Use the **four characteristics as a diagnostic checklist** (the ISIS box is the model answer).
- Give **Weber's three legitimacy types** with an example each, and note real states blend them (*developed under Legitimacy*).
- Explain **strong/weak/failed** as a continuum + at least two theories of *why* (Tilly's warfare • colonial legacies (Acemoglu, Johnson & Robinson) • North-Wallis-Weingast elite bargains; weakness = resource curse • international recognition).
- Keep **external vs internal sovereignty** distinct — Somaliland (internal only) and Russia (external strong, rule of law weak) are the go-to illustrations.

OD Ch. 4 — States and Identity

Book: Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 4.

Chapter résumé

Identity politics — organised around **nation, ethnicity, race, class, religion, gender and sexual orientation** — has become the central challenge to the modern state and to the liberal ideal of **equal citizenship**. The chapter's core theoretical move is to reject **primordialism** (identities as natural/ancient) for **constructivism**: an identity's *political saliency* is **socially constructed**, shaped by elites, grievance, and above all the state (education, censuses, laws). The central normative debate is **individual vs. group rights** — is legal equality enough, or do marginalised groups need recognition, autonomy, representation and status support? Each identity type gets a case study; the chapter weights **gender/sexuality, race, and religion** most heavily.

★ **The heart of the chapter:** an identity's **political saliency is socially constructed, not natural** (constructivism, not primordialism) — so the real battle is **individual vs. group rights** over recognition, autonomy, representation and status.

The red thread. The whole chapter is *one idea applied seven times*. For **each** identity marker — nation • ethnicity • race • class • religion • gender • sexuality — ask the same **two questions**: ① **how was its political saliency constructed?** and ② **individual rights or group rights?** Every section and case below is a variation on those two questions; if you can answer them for a marker, you can answer the chapter.

Lecture framing (AUW): this chapter answers the lecture's 4th question — *who does the state represent?* A state claims a **territory**, and territory comes with "**the people**" it claims to represent — but people and territory rarely coincide neatly. Key distinction: **State** (territorial/administrative org) ≠ **Nation** (a people with shared belonging) ≠ **Nationalism** (*the political project of making the nation politically sovereign / controlling a state*). A state can contain many nations; a nation can exist without a state; nationhood is **socially constructed** (Anderson's "*imagined community*").

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Political saliency** — how politically important an identity is; **created, not innate**.
- **Primordialism vs constructivism** — identities as natural/ancient vs **socially constructed** ("imagined communities," Anderson). *The chapter adopts constructivism.*
- **Nation vs ethnic group** — a nation has/seek a **state**; an ethnic group does not (a dissatisfied ethnic group can *become* a nation).
- **Cultural vs civic nationalism** → citizenship by **jus sanguinis** (blood, Germany) vs **jus soli** (soil, France); civic seen as more democracy-friendly.
- **The four demands of identity groups** — recognition • autonomy • representation • improved social status.
- **Group-rights toolkit: consociationalism** (Lijphart — share central power) vs the centripetal approach (Horowitz — incentivise leaders to moderate).
- **Three forms of secularism** — **neutral state** (USA) • **laïcité** (France) • **positive accommodation** (Germany); India's variant = "**principled distance**."
- **Assimilationist vs liberationist** strategies (feminist & LGBTQ).

Section-by-section main points

Understanding Identity — the chapter's core move

Core: it isn't groups but their political saliency that's constructed — **saliency is made, not given**. (*This is the lead argument for any ch. 4 answer.*)

	Primordialism (<i>almost no social scientist</i>)	Constructivism (<i>the chapter's choice</i>)
Identities are...	natural, ancient ("time immemorial"), fixed	socially constructed — "imagined communities" (Anderson)
Defined by	kinship, language, phenotype	stories, symbols, interpretation
Do they change?	no	yes — flexible; you hold many at once; elites activate whichever fits
Who talks this way	ethnic/national leaders (it legitimises their claims)	social scientists (Huntington's <i>Clash of Civilizations</i> = a sophisticated cultural version)

Why the chapter picks constructivism — primordialism *cannot explain* three things constructivism can:

1. **Change over time** — the *same* difference goes dormant → deadly: ex-Yugoslavia's religious identities barely mattered under communism, then became killing lines *as* war spread.
2. **Identities appearing / splitting** — "Serbo-Croatian" fractured into three "languages" as war came; "**Asian American**" & "**Hispanic**" were *coined* in the 1960s; "Igbo" as a unified group first appears in 1930s documents.
3. **The state manufacturing identity** — via schooling ("national history"), censuses and elections the state decides which categories even exist and become salient.

→ **The move:** reject primordialism, adopt constructivism, then for each marker ask *how* its saliency was built. Gender is the odd one out: rarely territorial, but the "proper woman" ideal **polices the boundary of every other identity**.

| The Policy Debate — individual vs group rights (*emphasised*)

Core: once an identity is salient, groups make **four demands**; the whole fight is whether to answer them with **equal individual rights** (liberalism) or **special group rights** (multiculturalism).

- **The four demands:** ① **recognition** (Taylor's "politics of recognition" — the universal one) • ② **autonomy** (self-rule over a region or personal/religious law; thwarted → secession → civil war) • ③ **representation** (may need institutional change) • ④ **improved status** (most groups start poorer).
- **FOR group rights** (Kymlicka): legal equality alone can't include culturally distinct minorities → multicultural integration (vs **assimilation**). Institutional form: **consociationalism** (Lijphart — each group gets a share of central power + vetoes; Switzerland, Belgium, Lebanon, Northern Ireland) — *the most common post-Cold War response*.
- **AGAINST group rights** (classic liberalism): only individuals have rights; group rights **freeze inequality** and erode the shared identity democracy needs. Alternative: the centripetal approach (Horowitz — electoral rules that *reward broad, cross-ethnic appeal*; Nigeria).
- **The sharp dilemma** (exam favourite): should groups pursuing *illiberal* goals — e.g. religious law limiting gender equality — get special rights?

| Nations, Nationalism & Immigration

Core: the only line between a nation and an ethnic group is the **state** — a nation has or seeks one; and nations are *made*, not found.

- Nations are **modern** and often *built by states* (d'Azeleglio: "*We have made Italy. Now we must make Italians.*").

- **Cultural (jus sanguinis) vs civic (jus soli) nationalism**; **immigration** is where the fight plays out (Syrian refugees, Brexit, Trump's wall). Even "civic" USA isn't so civic — **50%** think a "true American" is Christian, English-speaking, US-born.

Ethnicity

Core: ethnic saliency is **switched on**, not ancient — by **leadership + grievance + resource wealth + fear**.

- "Imagined" and shiftable (Serbo-Croatian split into three languages *as war came*); wants recognition/autonomy/representation (India reorganised states on linguistic lines).

Race (*heavily emphasised*)

Core: race = identity built on **physical** markers by **external imposition** (to justify domination/slavery) — the one identity that starts as *power over* a group, not self-assertion.

- Differs from ethnicity in *marking* (physical vs cultural), *origin* (imposed vs self-claimed) and built-in **power**. Genetic variation across "races" is no bigger than within them. Constructed by place: US "**one-drop rule**" vs Brazil's 12+ visual categories.

Social Class

Core: the one identity still often defined by "**objective**" criteria — yet its political saliency is falling.

- Marx's classes (bourgeoisie/proletariat) fit a post-industrial economy awkwardly; constructivists see class as symbols/aspiration. Union density **~35% (1985) → ~17%**; despite rising inequality, workers moved to **nationalist/right parties** (Brexit, Trump), not class politics (Huber: leaders mobilise whichever cleavage most cheaply wins).

Religion & the Secular State (*heavily emphasised*)

Core: religion's demands mirror ethnicity's (recognition + autonomy over personal law); what varies is **how the state handles religion** — three models of secularism to memorise:

Model	Rule	Country	Flashpoint
Neutral state	neutral about religion, but not opposed	USA	school prayer, creationism
Laïcité	religion barred from the public sphere	France , Turkey, Mexico	the veil bans
Positive accommodation	state supports registered faiths	Germany (church tax)	recognising non-hierarchical Islam

- India's "**principled distance**" is a fourth stance — treat groups **differently on purpose** (see the India case).
- Religion is more flexible than ethnicity (you can convert) *except* when politicised (ex-Yugoslavia marked identity despite low religiosity).

Gender & Sexual Orientation (*the most heavily emphasised — two cases*)

Core: both movements pose the multiculturalism question in its sharpest form — **assimilate into existing norms, or transform them?**

- **Assimilationist** (liberal feminists / mainstream LGBTQ): win **equal rights within** existing institutions (same-sex marriage extends a heterosexual institution).
- **Liberationist** (Iris Young; radical LGBTQ): **transform the norms themselves** ("sexual citizenship"; marriage seen as patriarchal).
- Both grew from the 1960s West (**Stonewall, 1969**); the **transgender** movement now challenges the gender **binary** itself.
- Outcomes: big legal gains, not parity — women = **24% of MPs**; quotas <10 states (1980) → >100 (2010); same-sex marriage **Netherlands (2001)** → 25 countries by 2019.

Cases & examples

Each identity type gets a case; each below: *what it shows* → *the concept*.

- **Northern Ireland — Good Friday Agreement (1998)**. With neither unionists nor nationalists able to win, the 1998 deal built a **consociational** system: NI stays British, power devolves to a PR-elected assembly, first/deputy-first ministers shared, every member labels as unionist/nationalist/other. It has collapsed repeatedly (2002–07; since 2017). → *Consociationalism/power-sharing — ends the violence but doesn't erase the division*.
- **Nationalism in Germany**. Germany ran a **strictly cultural** nationalism (**jus sanguinis**, codified 1913), auto-granting citizenship to ethnic Germans while denying it to German-born children of ~3m Turkish "guest workers." A 2000 reform opened **jus soli** (birth + residence + language); still **>40% of Turkish residents remain non-citizens**. Merkel's ~500k+ Syrian refugees (2015) revived the fight — the far-right **AfD** won 12.6% and 94 seats (2017). → *Cultural vs civic nationalism; immigration and who counts as "the nation."*
- **Ethnicity in Nigeria**. ~400 languages; the big three (**Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo**) were **constructed in the 20th century** ("Igbo" first appears in 1930s documents). A 1966 coup → anti-Igbo pogroms → **Biafra (civil war 1967–70, >1m dead)**. Nigeria then used **centripetal rules** (parties must be national; the president must win ≥25% in two-thirds of states; north/south rotation). → *Constructed/modern ethnicity + the centripetal approach + oil conflict*.
- **Racial politics in the USA (most detailed case)**. Race was **legally constructed** (one-drop → 1/32 under Jim Crow); "white" meant "not black," and the Irish/Italians/Jews only slowly "became white"; "**Asian American**"/"**Hispanic**" were coined in the 1960s. Persistent gaps: white wealth **>6×** black/Hispanic; ~1/3 of black men touch the justice system. From **Obama (2008)** to **Trump (2016)** — where **racial resentment, not economics, best predicted the Trump vote** (Sides/Tesler/Vavreck). → *Social construction of race, external imposition + power, and white backlash*.
- **Class politics in the UK**. Britain openly *recognises* class; unions built their **own party (Labour, 1900)** and peaked at **just over half the workforce unionised in 1979**, before the "winter of discontent" brought **Thatcher**, who broke union power; Blair's Labour moved to the centre. The working class shrank and many backed **Brexit**. → *Objective-vs-constructed class and the decline of class salience — mobilisation shifted from class to nation*.
- **Secularism in India**. A plural, devout society (>80% Hindu, ~13% Muslim) built on "**principled distance**" — the state treats groups *differently*, giving Muslims more autonomy over **personal law**. **Shah Bano (1986)**: the Court granted a divorced Muslim woman maintenance, then Parliament **reversed it** to restore Muslim personal law (communal rights beat individual equality). **Gujarat 2002**: ~2,000 Muslims killed. Modi/BJP push **Hindutva** against official secularism. → *Principled-distance secularism; autonomy vs uniform citizenship, fought through women's rights*.
- **Women in Iran**. A contradiction of **social gains but political/cultural repression**: Khomeini's regime mandated the hijab and stripped divorce rights, yet **1979→2002 female literacy rose 31%→69%, fertility**

fell 6.5→2.7, and women became 60% of university students — while holding ~2% of top posts. Islamic feminists claim *ijtihad* (the right to interpret texts); anti-veil protests since 2017. → *Social vs political gains; secular and Islamic feminism; gains are reversible under conservative rule.*

- **LGBTQ rights in Brazil.** Ended anti-sodomy law very early (1823), hosts the world's largest pride parade, yet is the largest Catholic country and elected the anti-gay Bolsonaro (2018). Courts (not the legislature) delivered civil unions (2011) and same-sex marriage (2013) via the constitution's anti-discrimination clause — but Brazil leads the world in transgender murders. → *LGBTQ rights in a new democracy — real court-won recognition alongside violence and religious backlash; mostly assimilationist.*

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Political saliency	How politically important an identity is (created, not innate)
Primordialism	Identities as natural/ancient/God-given
Constructivism	Identities as socially constructed ("imagined communities")
Social construction	Ongoing process by which a society defines who "we" are
Nation / Nationalism	Group that has/seek a state / the desire for one
Ethnic group	Cultural group <i>not</i> seeking its own state
Cultural / civic nationalism	Unity by shared culture / by shared political beliefs
Jus sanguinis / jus soli	Citizenship by blood / by soil (residence)
Race	Group defined on perceived <i>physical</i> markers, by external imposition
Social class	Group sharing status by wealth/income/work/education
Consociationalism	Ease conflict by giving each group a share of central power
Centripetal approach	Incentivise leaders to moderate & broaden appeal
Autonomy / Assimilation	Partial self-rule / minorities adopt the majority culture
Multicultural integration	Accommodate enduring ethnocultural identities
Neutral state / laïcité / positive accommodation	Three forms of secularism (USA / France / Germany)
Assimilationist / liberationist	Equal rights within norms / transform the norms

Exam pointers

- Lead with constructivism vs primordialism and *why* the chapter picks constructivism (saliency is *made*, not given) — the full argument + comparison table is worked out under Understanding Identity.
- Frame any identity conflict with the four demands + individual-vs-group-rights debate, then the consociationalism (Northern Ireland) vs centripetal (Nigeria) toolkit (*developed under The Policy Debate*).
- Know the three forms of secularism with a country each, plus India's principled distance (*table under Religion & the Secular State*).
- For gender/sexuality use the assimilationist vs liberationist split; Iran (social vs political gains) and Brazil (court wins vs backlash) are the sharpest cases.

★ Fun facts & memorable details

Sticky stats, dates and quotes from Module 2 (ch. 2 & 4) — the stuff that makes an answer land.

Quotable lines

- "L'état, c'est moi" ("The state, it is me") — **Louis XIV**, on the absolutist state not yet separate from the monarch. (ch.2)
- "War made the state, and the state made war." — **Charles Tilly**. (ch.2)
- "The difference between fascism and democracy is not whether the police are called, but when." — on the monopoly of force. (ch.2)
- "We have made Italy. Now we must make Italians." — **d'Azeglio**, on nations as built. (ch.4)
- Thesis of ch.4: liberalism vs communism defined the 20th century, "but nationalism won."

Striking numbers

- Europe went from ~500 sovereign entities in 1500 to ~50 states today. (ch.2)
- **China built a merit bureaucracy ~1,800 years before Europe** (empire united 221 BCE). (ch.2)
- **Mexican cartel violence**: 75,000–100,000 killed in a decade — a direct challenge to the monopoly on force. (ch.2)
- **India's Partition (1947)**: likely the largest migration in history, ≥1 million dead. (ch.2)
- US **white wealth is >6×** black/Hispanic; ~⅓ of **black men** pass through the justice system. (ch.4)
- Union density ~35% (1985) → ~17% today; UK unions peaked at **just over half the workforce in 1979**. (ch.4)
- Iran **1979→2002**: literacy 31%→69%, fertility 6.5→2.7, women 60% of university students — but ~2% of top posts. (ch.4)

Memorable facts

- **Tilly's "protection racket"**: the early European state is basically a protection racket — rulers sold *protection* against threats they themselves partly created, funding it by **extraction** (tax). (lecture)
 - **Brandenburg-Prussia** became a strong state **not by winning wars** but by having to fight in a brutally **competitive** neighbourhood — the pressure forced a strong tax-and-bureaucracy machine. (lecture)
 - **Germany** built **Europe's first welfare state** (Bismarck) as a tool to undercut socialists. (ch.2)
 - **Japan** was the **first non-Western modern economy**; US warships forced it open in 1853; the 1945 occupation was its first lost sovereignty in **400 years**. (ch.2)
 - **Brazil** had **more slaves than any American colony** and abolished slavery **last (1888)** — yet legalised **same-sex marriage (2013)** while leading the world in **transgender murders**. (ch.2 & 4)
 - **ISIS** reportedly ran a **DMV** and picked up garbage more efficiently than Iraq — but still failed the "state" test on security and recognition. (ch.2)
 - **Somaliland** works as a state but has **one embassy** and **zero recognition**. (ch.2)
 - The far-right **AfD (2017)** was the **first far-right party in the German parliament since 1960**. (ch.4)
 - **Stonewall (1969)** turned a tiny movement into a mass one "literally overnight." (ch.4)
 - "**Igbo**" as a unified identity first appears in documents only in the **1930s** — ethnicity as a modern construction. (ch.4)
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Lecture 3: Political Regimes (FK)

Required reading: OD ch. 3 (*States, Citizens, and Regimes*)

Theme of the lecture (Filip Kiil): ch. 2 asked *what a state is*; ch. 3 asks *what kind of government rules it* — the **regime** — and sorts regimes by the **ideology** that answers **who may rule and what rights citizens get**.

Lecture frame (FK) — the State–Regime–Citizen(–Ideology) nexus

Core: four linked concepts; the **regime** sits between the permanent **state** and the current **government**, and is classified by its **ideology**.

- **State** — the ongoing administrative apparatus (ch. 2); most enduring.
- **Regime** — the formal + **informal** institutions defining the *type* of government; more enduring than governments, less than the state. (*US: 46 administrations, one democratic regime since 1789; Nigeria: 8 regimes.*)
- **Citizen** — a member of the political community with **rights + duties** (vs a *subject*, who has only duties/obedience).
- **Ideology** — defines the **state–citizen relationship** and is how we classify regimes — but regimes often **diverge** from their ideology (informal institutions dominate, especially in weak states).

The V-Dem / "Regimes of the World" ladder (Lührmann, Tannenberg & Lindberg 2018) — the modern measure the lecture uses:

Regime	Multi-party elections?	Free & fair?	Rights + checks on the executive?
Closed autocracy	No	—	No
Electoral autocracy	Yes	No (restrictions undermine fairness)	No
Electoral democracy	Yes	Yes	Partial
Liberal democracy	Yes	Yes	Yes (rights, legal equality, checks)

Explaining regime *change* (the same **Interests / Beliefs / Structures** lens from Lecture 1):

Lens	How it explains change
Interests	Elites expand/restrict democracy to maximise power (democratise post-1990 for aid; backslide when power is threatened).
Beliefs	Democratic ideals spread in 19th–20th c.; fascism/communism caused reversals; recent populism erodes liberal values.
Structures	Industrialisation enabled democratisation; Cold War blocs sustained autocracy; globalisation/inequality now strain democracy.

OD Ch. 3 — States, Citizens, and Regimes

Book: Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 3.

Chapter résumé

Examines the **state↔people** relationship as embodied in different **regimes** — the formal + informal institutions defining a *type* of government. It traces the rise of the "**citizen**" (vs "subject") and of **civil society**, presents **T.H. Marshall's** three rights of citizenship (civil, political, social), then gives the chapter's core: a **taxonomy of regime types classified by ideology** — liberal democracy, communism, fascism, modernizing authoritarianism, personalist, electoral authoritarianism, theocracy. A recurring thread: **no regime works exactly as its ideology claims** — informal institutions often matter more.

★ **The heart of the chapter:** a **regime** = the formal + informal institutions defining a *type* of government, classified by its **ideology**. The single axis that orders them all: **how much power goes to citizens vs. the state**. **Liberal democracy** (limited state, broad rights) is the benchmark; every other regime tilts power toward the state and restricts full citizenship to a select group.

The red thread. Read the whole chapter as answers to **one question** — *how is power shared between citizens and the state?* Liberal democracy shares it widely (limited government + Marshall's rights); communism, fascism, modernizing & electoral authoritarianism, and theocracy concentrate it (in the party / a leader / a developing elite / God), restricting full citizenship to the working class / loyal nationals / the developers / the faithful. For **every** regime type ask: **who has power, and what rights do citizens get?**

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **State vs regime vs government** — continuous apparatus / *type* of government / current occupants.
- **Citizen vs subject** — rights + duties vs duties only.
- **Marshall's three rights** — **civil** • **political** • **social** (the yardstick for "full" citizenship).
- **Ideology-based regime taxonomy** — the seven types (below).
- **Dahl's 8 guarantees** — the working definition of liberal democracy.
- **Formal vs informal institutions** — informal rules (patronage, factions) often explain how a regime *really* works.

Section-by-section main points

| Citizens & civil society

Core: modern politics invented the **citizen** (rights + duties) out of the **subject** (obedience only) — and full citizenship needs all three of **Marshall's rights**.

- **Citizen vs subject:** 200–300 years ago Europeans were **subjects** of absolutist monarchs (no mechanism to protect "rights"); citizenship arose as sovereignty moved from the monarch to "**the people**" (after the French Revolution people addressed each other as "*citizen*").
- **Marshall (1963)** — **three rights:** **civil** (individual freedom, fair treatment) • **political** (participation, vote) • **social** (welfare, socioeconomic equality). Full citizenship needs *enough* social equality to make civil/political equality real. **Virtually no country fully provides all three.**
- **Civil society** — organised, nongovernmental, nonviolent activity by groups larger than families/firms; impossible under absolutism, enabled by religious pluralism + capitalism.
- **Popular sovereignty** — even dictators claim to rule *on behalf of* the people (theocracy claims God willed the exception). Emerging **postnational** citizenship (EU, ICC) — but core rights still sit in the **nation-state**.

Regimes, ideologies & citizens

Core: regimes are classified by **ideology**, but never match it perfectly — **informal institutions** often dominate (especially in weak states).

- Liberal democracy is the **benchmark all regimes respond to**: ~90% of the world's constitutions — including authoritarian ones — mention "democracy" (Elkins et al. 2014).

The regime taxonomy — *memorise this (the exam core)*

Core: seven regime types, each defined by an ideology answering **who has power** and **what citizens get**.

Regime	Key idea	Who has power
<u>Liberal democracy</u>	Individuals free with natural rights; govt must preserve life, liberty, property	The legislature (elected, removable)
Communism	<u>Historical materialism</u> → proletarian revolution → classless, stateless society	<u>Vanguard party</u> now; the proletariat "later"
Fascism	Organic society; the state creates the nation ; corporatism	A supreme leader
<u>Modernizing authoritarianism</u>	<i>Development</i> needs unity, so democracy must wait	A modern (educated) elite
Personalist regime	Claims to modernise but is really neopatrimonial	An individual ruler
<u>Electoral authoritarianism</u>	Blends democratic + authoritarian legitimacy	The ruling party (via rigged elections)
Theocracy	Rule by divine authority (Islamism → sharia)	God (via the clergy) — not the people

Liberal democracy

Core: liberal democracy = **democracy (rule by the people)** + **liberalism (individual rights)** — a *limited* state that protects rights and holds free, competitive elections.

- **Roots:** liberalism arose in the 16th–17th-c. religious wars; social contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Montesquieu, Rousseau). **Locke:** government is legitimate only if it preserves **life, liberty, property** (Jefferson → "pursuit of happiness"). Democracy was added later; early liberals limited citizenship to **male property owners** — expanded over the 19th–20th c.
- **Dahl's 8 guarantees** (the working definition): freedom of **association** · **expression** · right to **vote** · broad **office eligibility** · leaders' right to **compete** · alternative **information** · **free & fair elections** · institutions that make policy **depend on votes**.
- **Varieties of democracy:** **liberal** (political rights — UK) · **social democracy** (adds economic regulation + social rights — Sweden; a variant within liberal democracy) · **participatory** (direct involvement beyond voting — Switzerland).

Communism

Core: Marx's historical materialism — economic forces drive history — predicts a proletarian revolution ending in a classless, stateless utopia; in practice it produced the totalitarian state.

- **Feudalism → capitalism → socialism → communism.** Liberal democracy is a "shell" for capitalism; liberal rights = "equal rights for unequal people."
- **Stages: socialism** = collective ownership + dictatorship of the proletariat (a *class* dictatorship) → eventually stateless, classless **communism** (human nature itself changes).
- **Critique:** any theory promising utopia tends toward the totalitarian state (Russia/Stalin case).

| Fascism

Core: antiliberal *and* anticommunist — the state creates and embodies the nation; the individual exists only for the state; citizens have **duties, not rights**.

- **Organic** conception of society; a **supreme leader** embodies the nation. **Corporatism:** one state-controlled organisation per sector (one union, one business association). Rejects rationality/materialism → glorifies struggle & war → **totalitarian** (Nazi Germany case).

| Modernizing authoritarianism

Core: legitimacy through **development, not rights** — a **modern elite** must guide progress, and democracy would only interfere.

- Technocratic legitimacy rooted in **modernization theory** (postcolonial states must follow the West's path). **Four institutional forms:** **one-party** (civilian; postcolonial Africa/Asia — Tanzania) • **military** (coup — Brazil) • **bureaucratic-authoritarian** • **personalist**.

| Personalist regimes

Core: in the **weakest states**, one leader captures everything — even the party/military that raised him — via **neopatrimonial** patron–client loyalty rather than institutions.

- Weak, unstable, unpredictable; rule of law inconsistent. Most common in Africa (Mobutu, Marcos, Abacha/Nigeria).

| Electoral authoritarianism (hybrid)

Core: a **hybrid** — real opposition and elections *exist*, but the ruling party **manipulates the rules** so it never actually loses; it **proclaims itself democratic**.

- Blends liberal-democratic (elections) + modernizing-authoritarian (limits for "stability/development") legitimacy. Spread after the Cold War because open authoritarianism lost international legitimacy (Mexico/PRI case).

| Theocracy

Core: rule by **religious authorities on behalf of God** — so ultimate sovereignty is **Allah's, not the people's**.

- **Islamism** (a 19th–20th-c. reaction to Western imperialism, *not* traditional): sharia should be the basis of government. Key terms: **sharia** (law) • **ijtihad** (individual interpretation) vs **taqlid** (blind acceptance) • **shura** (consultation — the opening for quasi-democracy) • **umma** (community) • **jihad** (three kinds: inner struggle [most important] → righting injustice → armed defence [least]). Iran is the world's **only true theocracy** (Iran case).

Cases & examples

Why these cases are here — circle them back. Each country is a worked example of one regime type; read every case for (1) which type · (2) who has power · (3) what rights citizens get. The table maps case → type; the write-ups tell the story.

Case	Regime type	Who has power	Freedom House
<u>UK</u>	<u>Liberal democracy</u>	Parliament (sovereign)	Free
<u>Russia/USSR</u>	Communism → (now electoral authoritarian)	<u>Vanguard party</u> / Stalin	Not Free
<u>Germany (Nazi)</u>	Fascism	A supreme leader	(Free today)
<u>Brazil</u>	Modernizing authoritarian (military)	Technocratic military elite	Free (today)
<u>Nigeria (Abacha)</u>	Personalist	One ruler (neopatrimonial)	Partly Free
<u>Mexico (PRI)</u>	Electoral authoritarian	The ruling party	Partly Free
<u>Iran</u>	Theocracy	God (via the clergy)	Not Free
<u>Tanzania</u>	Modernizing authoritarian (one-party)	A single party	—

- **United Kingdom — "cradle of democracy."** Liberal democracy evolved gradually, with no single written constitution and no revolutionary break from monarchy: **Magna Carta (1215) → Glorious Revolution (1688) → Bill of Rights (1689)**; the franchise expanded only under pressure (1832 middle class ~7%; women's suffrage 1918); recent **devolution (1997)**, a standalone **Supreme Court (2005)**. → *The first liberal democracy; power rests on parliamentary sovereignty (a powerful informal institution) + the slow build-up of all three Marshall rights.*
- **Russia/USSR — the first "communist" regime.** Revolution came in the "wrong country" (agrarian, not advanced-capitalist). **Lenin** added the vanguard party and led the **October Revolution 1917**; **Stalin** built a totalitarian state (rapid industrialisation, 2–20 million deaths); **Gorbachev's** reforms → collapse **Dec 1991** into 15 states. → *Communism in practice = the totalitarian state; the regime diverged wildly from Marx's theory (Marx → Lenin → Stalin).*
- **Germany — the rise of the Nazis (fascism).** Hitler was elected, not a coup — the Nazis won 37% (1932) amid depression; the **Reichstag fire (1933)** → Enabling Act → dictatorship; unions replaced by a party-controlled front (corporatism); Nazism fused fascism with **racism** → the **Holocaust (~6m Jews)**. → *Fascism + totalitarian state; its horror delegitimised fascism globally, though neofascism persists (Le Pen's National Front — 2nd in France's 2002 presidential race).*
- **Brazil — a military modernizing-authoritarian regime (1964–85).** A US-backed coup installed a **technocratic military elite** that staked legitimacy on **development + anticommunism** (National Security Doctrine); state-led industry produced the "**Brazilian Miracle**" (1967–73) but rising inequality. When growth stalled, unions + the Church revived civil society → **democracy restored 1985**. → *Modernizing authoritarianism in military form — legitimacy = development, so no growth = no legitimacy.*
- **Nigeria — Abacha's personalist regime (1993–98).** After the military annulled the **1993 election**, **General Abacha** seized power, gutted the courts, jailed/killed opponents (hanged poet **Ken Saro-Wiwa**), and looted ~\$3 billion — ruling by **neopatrimonial** oil patronage. His **sudden death (1998)** ended it; wary officers delivered the **democracy in place since 1999**. → *Personalist regime — a weak state's institutions crumble around one man.*

- **Mexico — the PRI (electoral authoritarianism).** The PRI ruled ~71 years via regular *but rigged* elections — a **democratic veneer** over **clientelism, corporatism and fraud** (Tlatelolco Massacre 1968), with power rotated among factions and presidents limited to one **sexenio**. Erosion (contested 1988) → **Vicente Fox (PAN) broke the monopoly in 2000**. → *The classic hybrid regime — informal institutions (clientelism, fraud) dominate the formal democratic shell.*
- **Iran — the Islamic Republic (theocracy).** Khomeini's 1979 revolution built the first modern theocracy: a **Supreme Leader** (a cleric with veto power) + a **Guardian Council (12 clergy)** vetting all candidates/laws, *above* an elected president & parliament (**Majlis**). The **1979 constitution** makes **Allah sovereign** and sharia the sole law. → *Theocracy — permanent tension between theocratic authority and quasi-democratic elements (shura/elections).*
- **Tanzania — Nyerere's one-party regime.** Julius Nyerere ("Africa's philosopher-king") justified a **one-party** state by claiming Africa lacked class divisions; his **ujamaa** "African socialism" ruined agriculture but achieved **near-universal literacy**; he **voluntarily resigned (1985)**. → *Civilian one-party modernizing authoritarianism — the "development vs democracy" trade-off.*

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Regime	Formal + informal institutions defining a <i>type</i> of government
Citizen / Subject	Member with rights + duties / person with duties (obedience) only
Civil / Political / Social rights	Marshall's three: freedom & fair treatment / participation / welfare & equality
Civil society	Organised nongovernmental, nonviolent activity beyond family/firm
Social contract theory	Legitimate govt = free individuals contracting to be governed
Liberal democracy	Democracy + liberalism; Dahl's 8 guarantees
Social / Participatory democracy	Adds social rights & economic control / adds direct participation
Parliamentary sovereignty	Parliament is supreme (UK)
Historical materialism	Material/economic forces drive history (Marxism)
Dictatorship of the proletariat	First communist stage: rule by the working class
Totalitarian state	Controls ~all of society, eliminates civil society
Vanguard party	Lenin: elite party leading the proletariat
Corporatism	One state-controlled organisation per social sector
Modernizing authoritarianism	Legitimacy from "development" by a modern elite
Technocratic legitimacy	Right to rule based on expertise
Personalist regime / Neopatrimonial	One ruler dominates / power via personal patron–client loyalty
Electoral authoritarianism	Hybrid: opposition + elections, but rigged
Theocracy / Islamism	Rule by religious authority / sharia as the basis of government

Exam pointers

- Nail the state / regime / government / citizen distinctions + Marshall's three rights (civil/political/social) — the framing for any answer.
- Reproduce the seven-type regime taxonomy (key idea + **who has power**) — and answer everything through the red thread: *how is power shared between citizens and the state?*
- Define liberal democracy via Dahl's 8 guarantees + the **three varieties** (liberal/social/participatory).
- Distinguish the **authoritarian types** with a case each: communism (Russia) · fascism (Germany) · modernizing (Brazil/Tanzania) · personalist (Nigeria) · electoral authoritarian (Mexico) · theocracy (Iran).
- Use the **V-Dem ladder** (closed autocracy → electoral autocracy → electoral democracy → liberal democracy) and the **Interests/Beliefs/Structures** lens to discuss *regime change*.

★ Fun facts & memorable details

Sticky stats, dates & quotes from Lecture 3 (regimes).

Quotable lines

- Mussolini: "*The State is all-embracing; outside of it no human or spiritual values can exist*" — and he openly embraced the label "**totalitarian**."
- Marx: communism is "*a spectre haunting Europe*" (*Communist Manifesto*, 1848); liberal rights = "*equal rights for unequal people*."
- Nyerere: "*When a village of a hundred people have sat and talked together until they agreed where a well should be dug, they have practised democracy*."
- Locke's core liberties = "**life, liberty and property**" → Jefferson's "**life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness**."

Striking numbers

- ~**90%** of the world's constitutions — including authoritarian ones — mention "democracy."
- **Dahl** = **8** guarantees of liberal democracy.
- Deaths under **Stalin**: estimated **2–20 million**; USSR dissolved **Dec 1991** into **15** states.
- Hitler's Nazis won **37% (1932)** and he was **elected** chancellor — not a coup; ~**6 million** Jews killed.
- The **PRI** ruled **71 years**, winning **98% of local/congressional elections 1946–73** (and **98.7%** of the 1976 presidential vote).
- Iran's **Guardian Council** = **12 clergy**; Iran is nearly all **Shiite**, though Sunnis are ~**85%** of the world's Muslims.

Memorable facts

- The US has had **46 administrations but one regime** (since 1789); **Nigeria has had 8 regimes**.
- "**Kremlinology**" — analysts inferred Soviet power from who stood closest to the leader at parades.
- **Abacha** (Nigeria) looted ~**\$3 billion** and hanged the poet **Ken Saro-Wiwa**.
- Le Pen's **National Front** came **2nd in France's 2002 presidential election** — neofascism didn't die with 1945.
- The **three jihads**: inner struggle (most important) → righting injustice in the *umma* → armed defence (least important) — the reverse of the popular Western image.

Lecture 4: Systems of Government

Required reading: OD ch. 5 (*Governing Institutions in Democracies*)

Theme of the lecture: the various elements of states and systems of government — the different types of executive and legislative systems, focusing in particular on **parliamentarism vs. presidentialism**.

Lecture frame (FK). *Why it matters*: the institutional set-up **shapes policy** with big downstream consequences for people and businesses, and explains **why democracies function so differently** (US flashpoints the lecture cites: **Citizens United**, **Roe v. Wade**, the **filibuster**). Everything below runs on Lijphart's **majoritarian ↔ consensus** framing + Tsebelis's **veto players**.

OD Ch. 5 — Governing Institutions in Democracies

Book: Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 5.

Chapter résumé

How democracies organise their governing institutions — **executive, legislature, judiciary, bureaucracy**, and the **national ↔ subnational** split — and why the same rules on paper produce different outcomes depending on **context** (party number/discipline, institutionalisation). The organising claim: **the executive–legislative relationship** "more than anything else distinguishes different kinds of democracies," giving three models — **parliamentarism** (fusion, Westminster), **presidentialism** (separation, US), and **semi-presidentialism** (dual executive, France/Russia) — judged on **accountability, effective policymaking, and stability**. It sits all this on Lijphart's **majoritarian ↔ consensus** continuum (few vs many **veto players**), then covers **judicial review**, **bureaucracy** (the **principal–agent problem**), and **federal vs unitary** systems.

★ **The heart of the chapter**: the **executive–legislative relationship** is what most distinguishes democracies — **parliamentary** (powers *fused*), **presidential** (powers *separated*), or **semi-presidential** (executive *split*). Each is a different answer to **how executive power is chosen, checked, and removed** — trading off **accountability, effective policymaking and stability**.

The red thread. Everything hangs on one question: **how is executive power organised and held accountable?** Place each system on Lijphart's **majoritarian ↔ consensus** line (few ↔ many **veto players**): Westminster parliamentarism = most majoritarian (power concentrated, clear vertical accountability, weak horizontal check); US presidentialism = built-in separation/veto players (strong horizontal check, gridlock-prone). For any case ask: **how is the executive chosen · how is it removed · how many veto players · what's the accountability/efficiency/stability trade-off?**

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Executive** split into **head of state** (symbolic, represents the country) vs **head of government** (runs policy).
- **The three systems**: **parliamentary** (fusion) · **presidential** (separation) · **semi-presidential** (split executive).

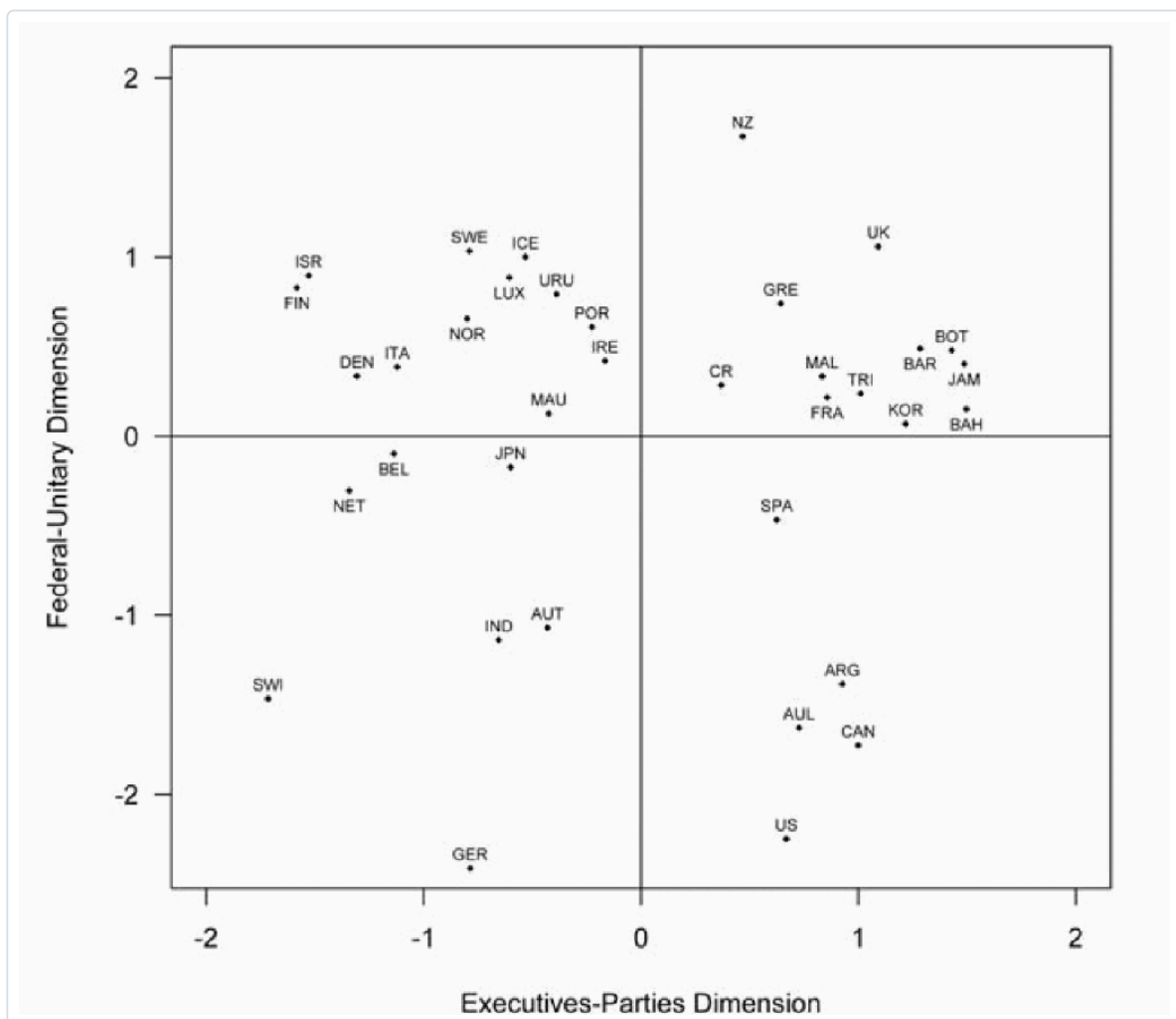
- **Majoritarian ↔ consensus democracy** (Lijphart) + **veto players** (Tsebelis) — the master frame.
- **Vertical vs horizontal accountability** (O'Donnell) — citizens→state vs state→state.
- **Judicial review** (+ common vs code law) · **principal–agent problem** (bureaucracy) · **federal vs unitary**.
- **The stability debate**: Linz's "*Perils of Presidentialism*."

Section-by-section main points

The framing — majoritarian vs consensus, and accountability

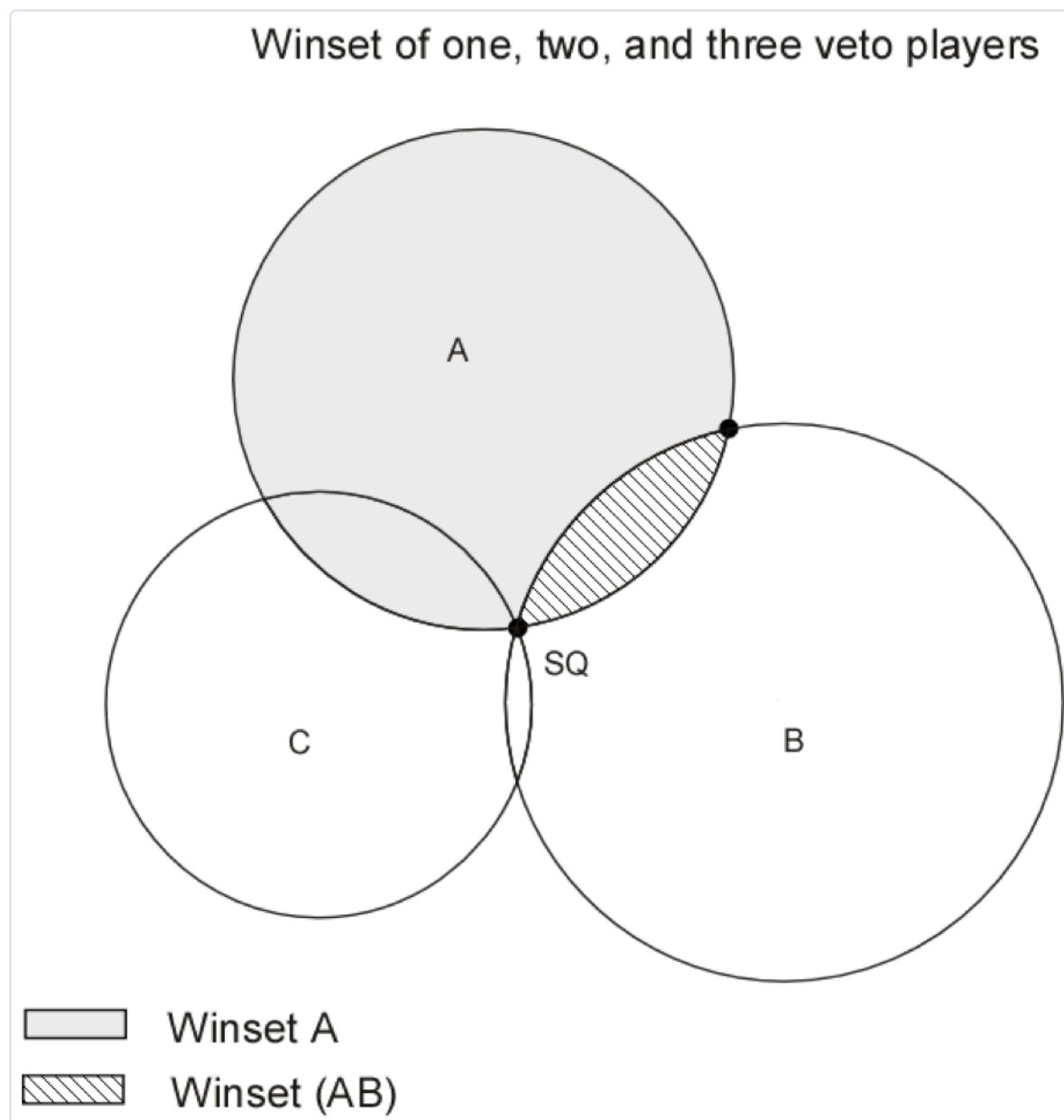
Core: institutions differ by **how much they concentrate vs disperse power** — Lijphart's majoritarian↔consensus line, measured by the number of **veto players**.

- **Majoritarian** (UK): single-party executive, executive dominates the legislature, unicameral, easily amended constitution → **few veto players**. **Consensus** (US/Germany): coalition executives, executive–legislative balance, bicameral, rigid constitution → **many veto players**.
- **Veto player** (Tsebelis): any actor whose agreement is needed to change policy — more of them (+ greater ideological distance) = less policy change.
- **Accountability** (O'Donnell): **vertical** = citizens hold the state accountable (elections, ch. 6); **horizontal** = state institutions check each other (this chapter). Only the **executive** is essential to all states; legislature + judiciary exist to *limit* it.



How to read it (Lijphart). Every democracy is a *point* on two axes. **Horizontal** = **Executives–Parties**: left = **consensus** (coalitions, many parties, balanced exec–legislature), right = **majoritarian** (single-party rule,

concentrated power). **Vertical = Federal–Unitary**: top = **federal/decentralised**, bottom = **unitary/centralised**. So the **UK** sits far right (pure majoritarian) but mid-high; the **US** sits right *and* very federal (bottom-right); **Switzerland/Germany** sit consensus + federal (bottom-left). The point: "majoritarian vs consensus" isn't one switch but a *position*, and the two dimensions vary independently.



How to read it (Tsebelis, veto players). Each circle = one veto player's set of policies it prefers to the status quo (SQ). A new policy can only pass if it lies inside *every* player's circle — the **overlap (winset)**. With one player the winset is huge (all of A); add player B and it shrinks to the small hatched sliver (AB); add C and it can vanish. **More veto players (and more ideological distance between them) → smaller winset → less policy change / gridlock** — the mechanism behind presidential gridlock and "stable" consensus systems.

★ **Why the majoritarian/PR choice matters for redistribution** (Iversen & Soskice 2006 — from the deck): with three classes (lower/middle/upper), in a **proportional** system the **middle class sides with the lower class** to redistribute from the rich → **bigger welfare states**; in a **majoritarian** system the middle class sides with the **upper class** to avoid heavy taxes from the poor → **less redistribution**. This is a big reason PR democracies redistribute more — a bridge to Lecture 5, and it helps explain the Sweden vs US welfare puzzle.

Executives & legislatures

Core: the executive fills two roles — **head of state** (symbolic) and **head of government** (policy) — and *how those relate to the legislature* defines the three systems.

- One person can hold both roles (US president) or they can be split (UK monarch + PM). The **executive-legislative relationship** is the key variable.
- **Legislatures: unicameral** (one house) vs **bicameral** (two — the upper house usually represents states/regions; standard in federal systems). Legislatures are *more powerful in presidential systems* than in parliamentary ones — because of separation of powers, a legislator can't also sit in the cabinet, so members have **no ministerial promotion to earn from the executive** and stay independent. (*In a parliamentary system, ministers ARE MPs, so ambitious MPs toe the party line to be promoted into the cabinet → a weaker, executive-dependent legislature. Note: this is about chasing cabinet (minister) posts, not re-election to one's own seat — every legislator chases that.*)

Parliamentarism — the Westminster model (*most emphasised*)

Core: executive and legislature are **fused** — parliament elects the chief executive (**PM**), who is *both* the majority-party leader *and* a sitting legislator. The purest **majoritarian** form.

- **PM is not directly elected:** citizens vote for parliament; the majority names the PM (in practice you know each party's candidate). A **ceremonial head of state** (monarch, or an esteemed elected "president") stays out of politics.
- **Removal = vote of no confidence** → PM resigns (party picks a new leader) *or* asks the head of state to call **new elections**; PM can also **dissolve** parliament. Usually **no fixed terms**. (No-confidence votes succeed only ~5% of the time but signal weakness.)
- **Power depends on the party system:** a disciplined single majority makes the PM "*the most powerful democratic executive in the world*" (legislation passes almost automatically). **No majority → coalition government**, small parties become **veto players**, stability drops (Sweden 2018: 133 days to form a government).
- **Cabinet** of ministers (must be MPs); in coalitions the PM must share out "portfolios" — the cabinet is the main policy-bargaining site and a check on the PM.

Presidentialism — the separation of powers

Core: executive and legislature are **elected separately with separate powers** (separation of powers, Montesquieu). The defining feature is *separation*, not that one person is both head of state & government.

- **President is directly elected** and serves a **fixed term**; branches generally **can't remove each other** (only a hard **impeachment**). This builds in **institutional veto players** — lawmaking needs *both* president and legislative majority → checks & balances, but **gridlock** (esp. under divided government).
- **Cabinet** is freely appointed (often non-legislators, any party), subject to legislative consent — but it's a **less important** body than in parliamentary systems. The **legislature is typically more powerful** than in parliamentary systems.
- **Coalitional presidentialism:** with fragmented legislatures the president must build an informal party coalition and act "a little like a PM" (**Brazil** is the classic case).

Semi-presidentialism — the hybrid

Core: executive power is **split** between a **directly elected president** (head of state, with real powers) and a **PM** (head of government, backed by the parliamentary majority, appointed by the president, removable by no-confidence).

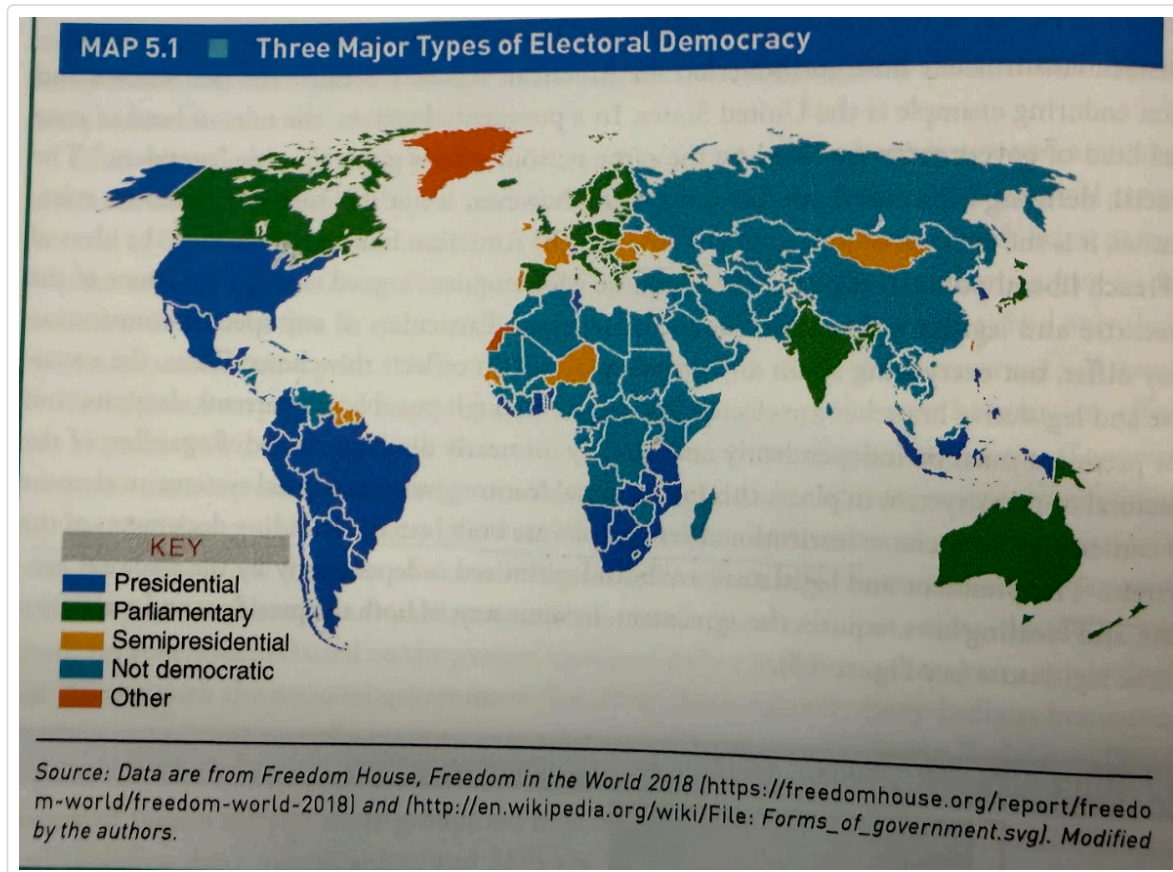
- Legislation needs the president's signature **and** PM/majority support; the powers must be **clearly divided** (often unclear in practice). Originated in **France, 1958 (de Gaulle)**.
- **Cohabitation:** president and legislative majority from **different parties** → president appoints an opposing-party PM (French norm: president runs foreign policy, PM runs domestic). Limits presidential power but can cause gridlock.
- **Elgie's key question:** *can the president dismiss the PM?* If **yes** → unstable, democracy endangered (**Russia**); if **no** → more power-sharing, no less stable than parliamentarism.

★ The core comparison — parliamentary vs presidential vs semi-presidential

Core: learn this table cold — it's the centre of the lecture and the exam.

Feature	Parliamentary	Presidential	Semi-presidential
Powers	Fused (exec from legislature)	Separated (elected independently)	Split executive (pres + PM)
Head of state / govt	Separate (monarch/ceremonial pres + PM)	Same person (president)	President (HoS, real powers) + PM (HoG)
Executive chosen by	Parliament (majority names PM)	Directly elected	President directly elected; PM by parliament
Terms	Usually no fixed term	Fixed term	Fixed presidential term; PM depends on parliament
How executive is removed	<u>Vote of no confidence</u> (+ PM can dissolve parliament)	Only impeachment (hard)	PM by no-confidence; president fixed
Veto players	Few (majoritarian)	Built-in (pres + legislature)	Depends (cohabitation adds them)
Classic cases	UK, Germany, India	USA, Brazil	France, Russia

- **Accountability:** parliamentarism = clearest **vertical** (voters know whom to blame) but weak **horizontal** under a single majority; presidentialism = strong **horizontal** (separation) but can hurt policymaking.
- **Policymaking (Samuels):** presidential systems **change the status quo less** and more slowly. *Illustration:* **Thatcher (UK) reshaped economic policy far more than Reagan (US)** despite similar aims — she had a compliant majority; he faced a Democratic Congress.



How to read it (OD Map 5.1 — three types of electoral democracy). Colour = a country's system: **blue = presidential** (note how it dominates the **Americas** — the US model spread across Latin America), **green = parliamentary** (most of Europe and the former British Commonwealth), **yellow = semi-presidential** (France and a scatter of others), teal = not democratic, orange = other. The visual take-away: the three systems aren't evenly spread — they cluster by **colonial/constitutional heritage**, which is why the same "choice" of system is really a legacy.

■ The stability debate — Linz's "Perils of Presidentialism"

Core: Linz (1990): presidentialism is more crisis-prone because of three flaws; but critics say the *society*, not the institution, is the real problem.

- **Linz's three perils:** ① **dual legitimacy** (two independently elected branches, no democratic tie-breaker) • ② **winner-take-all** presidents over-read their mandate and won't compromise • ③ **inflexible fixed terms** (a failing president can't be removed). Danger peaks for *new* democracies under coalitional presidentialism (small presidential party + fragmented legislature).
- **Counter (Cheibub 2007):** presidential systems just "*tend to exist in societies where democracies of any type are likely to be unstable.*" Semi-presidentialism is empirically **no less stable than parliamentarism** — if the president can't override the legislature or sack the PM.

■ Judiciary

Core: courts interpret law and, via judicial review, can strike laws as unconstitutional — making them a veto player and a check on the majority (the "why should unelected judges decide?" problem). Only real if institutionalised.

- **Two legal families → two review types: common law** (Britain + colonies incl. US; judges follow **precedent**) → **decentralised + concrete** review (*any* court can rule on constitutionality, but only inside a real case); **code law** (Roman/Napoleon; written code only, precedent ignored; French/Iberian colonies) → **centralised + abstract** review (one special **constitutional court**, which can rule on a law in the abstract).



How to read it (OD Map 5.2 — common vs code law). Blue = **common law** (Britain and its former colonies — US, Canada, India, Australia): judge-made law built on **precedent** → *decentralised, concrete* review. **Green** = **code/civil law** (continental Europe and its colonial reach across Latin America and Africa): a written **code** is supreme, precedent ignored → *centralised, abstract* review by one constitutional court. **Teal** = **mixed**. Like Map 5.1, the pattern tracks **colonial heritage** — which legal family a country inherited still shapes how (and by whom) laws get reviewed today.

- **Why let unelected judges override elected majorities?** Defenders: legislatures aren't perfectly representative either; judges are *appointed by elected officials* (Dahl 1957: justices sit within the ruling coalition); courts check the other branches and *claim* to protect minorities (though studies find they more often side with the powerful).
- **"Judicialisation of politics"** (Tate & Vallinder) — courts pulled into ever more political questions; "one of the most significant trends" of recent government, as many actors turn courts into a **veto point**.
- **Independence depends on informal factors + legitimacy:** a **fragmented, competitive** political system gives courts room; judges' own beliefs matter; and because courts command neither army nor purse, hard-won **legitimacy** is what makes review real. *Example: Brazil's Supreme Federal Tribunal (STF)* grew confident enough to help impeach presidents and drove the *Lava Jato* anti-corruption probe — but code-law **abstract review** lets ~70,000 cases/year flood in (~90% decided by a single judge), making it a clogged veto point.

Bureaucracy

Core: every state needs a merit-based, law-bound bureaucracy — but unelected officials with expertise create a **principal-agent problem** (agents pursue their own interests → inefficiency or corruption).

- **Professionalisation** (merit appointment) replaced **patronage** and gives bureaucrats **expertise = their own independent power** — which is exactly what creates the principal-agent gap (agents may expand budgets/turf, or take bribes).
- **Iron triangle** — a cosy, closed policy loop of **bureaucrats + legislators + business** in one sector that serves the insiders and keeps everyone else out (see the Japan case: iron triangles + amakudari).
- Controls: **political appointees** (US ~6–8 per department; UK ~2 per ministry), specific legislation, **legislative oversight** (committees, hearings, budgets), courts — none perfect. **New Public Management (NPM)** (Reagan/Thatcher, 1980s): privatise, add competition, "customer satisfaction," flatten hierarchies — a UK 30-year study found a **1/3 staff cut but slightly higher costs and slightly worse, less-fair service**.
- **Corruption**: two types — **bribery + rent-seeking** (using regulation for advantage instead of being productive); worse in **more-regulated, more-unequal** economies (rational-choice), or from postcolonial legitimacy deficits (**Ekeh's "two publics"** in Africa: a moral *primordial* public vs an amoral *civic* one). **Majoritarian** systems (clear responsibility) let voters punish it better. **Johnston's four syndromes**: *Influence Markets* (rich democracies — US, Japan) → *Elite Cartels* (middle-income — Brazil) → *Oligarchs & Clans* (Russia) → *Official Moguls* (poorest).

Federal vs unitary systems

Core: **unitary** = the centre holds sole sovereignty (local powers delegated & revocable); **federal** = sovereignty is **constitutionally shared** with subunits — a built-in way to **limit majorities and protect minorities** (more veto players).

- **Why federate**: bring government closer (big countries); divide power (bicameral upper house + judicial review); protect ethnic/religious minorities (**Belgium** = federalism + consociationalism; **541 days** to form a government in 2010).
- Real power depends on **revenue control** and **upper-house strength**, not paper rules (strong **US Senate** vs weak German **Bundesrat**). **Symmetrical** (US) vs **asymmetrical** (special powers for some units). **Devolution** = reversible decentralisation in a unitary state (UK → Scotland/Wales/N. Ireland). Riker: federalism is inherently unstable (→ centralisation or secession).
- **Examples**: **federal** = US, Germany; **unitary** = France, UK, **Denmark**. In US federalism the **national** level holds war & foreign policy, coining money, admitting new states; **states** hold schools, public welfare, local law & order (the "**Hamilton** [federal] vs **Jefferson** [states]" division).
- **Federalism is only as real as the politics behind it** (revenue + party system, not paper): **Mexico** looked federal on paper but the **PRI** centralised everything via revenue until democratisation (2000) decentralised power to governors; **India** = *centralised* federalism (the centre can redraw state borders or impose "**President's Rule**"), decentralising since 1989 as state parties bargain in national coalitions; **Russia** = a federal **shell** — Putin gutted regional autonomy (appointing governors from 2004; centre took ~85% of revenue). Weak institutions can even preserve **subnational authoritarianism** inside a national democracy (Gibson).

Cases & examples

Why these cases are here — circle them back. Each country shows **one system in practice** — and how the *same rules* give different results depending on the party system. Read each for: *which system · how power actually flows · the accountability/stability trade-off*.

Case	System	What it adds
UK	Parliamentary (Westminster)	strongest PM — until Brexit broke party discipline
India	Parliamentary	same rules, different outcome via the <u>party system</u>
USA	Presidential	<u>separation of powers</u> → gridlock; strongest legislature
Brazil	Coalitional presidentialism	strong formal powers ≠ effective power (30 parties)
France	Semi-presidential	the classic case — cohabitation makes it work
Russia	Semi-presidential	dominant president → <u>electoral authoritarianism</u>
Japan	(bureaucracy)	unelected bureaucratic power (iron triangles, <i>amakudari</i>)

- **United Kingdom — Westminster parliamentarism.** With a disciplined single majority, the PM is "*the most powerful democratic executive in the world.*" But **Brexit** shattered discipline: May's deal was crushed, parliament seized the agenda, 117 of her own MPs voted no-confidence, she resigned — and **Boris Johnson became PM via a ~160,000-member party vote, no national election.** → *Parliamentarism; the majority-party mechanism (not paper rules) drives PM power; removal via no-confidence + party replacement.*
- **India — same model, different result.** India copied Westminster almost exactly, yet outcomes track its party system: one-party (Congress) dominance 1947–89 made PMs *less* constrained than British ones; post-1989 **coalitions** forced constant negotiation (3 PMs in the first 30 years → 12 in the next 30). → *Identical rules → different outcomes based on party number; multipartism pushes parliamentarism toward consensus.*
- **United States — presidential separation of powers.** The Framers feared a strong executive, so the president's *formal* powers are modest (veto, appointments with Senate consent, commander-in-chief); separation of powers + **weak, polarised parties** → **gridlock**, the norm under divided government (Senate 60-vote rule). Contested workarounds: signing statements, executive orders. → *Presidentialism; built-in veto players; the world's most powerful legislature (Congress).*
- **Brazil — coalitional presidentialism.** The 1988 constitution gives the president **more** formal power than the US president (decrees, line-item veto, budget monopoly) — yet **~30 fragmented parties** (Bolsonaro's own held <10% of seats) force presidents to build **9-party coalitions**, trade pork for votes (often illegally), and still face impeachment (**Dilma Rousseff, 2016**). → *Strong formal powers ≠ effective power; the instability Linz warned of.*
- **France — the classic semi-presidential case.** The **Fifth Republic (1958, de Gaulle)** invented the model: a **directly elected president** (foreign policy & defence, real power) *alongside* a **PM** answerable to the National Assembly (domestic policy). It works precisely because of **cohabitation** — when the president's party *loses* the Assembly, the president must appoint a **PM from the opposing majority** and retreat to their own domain (e.g. Mitterrand with a right-wing PM, Chirac with a left-wing PM). → *Semi-presidentialism done "right": because the president cannot simply dismiss the PM, the two share power and the system stays as stable as parliamentarism — the mirror image of Russia (Elgie's dividing line).*
- **Russia — semi-presidentialism gone dominant.** The 1993 constitution created an exceptionally strong presidency (appoints PM — reject the nominee 3× and the Duma is dissolved; **decrees with force of law**). **Putin** used it to turn a weak democracy into an **electoral authoritarian regime**. → *Elgie's warning: a president who can dismiss the PM at will removes the incentive to compromise and endangers democracy.*
- **Japan — bureaucratic power.** Japan's elite bureaucracy (recruited from Tokyo University law) drove the postwar boom and often *wrote* the laws, via **iron triangles** (bureaucrats–politicians–business) and **amakudari** ("descent from heaven" — officials taking jobs in firms they'd regulated). Scandals + stagnation

eroded it; Abe's 2014 reform tripled PM appointment control. → *The principal–agent problem: unelected officials wielding real power.*

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Executive / Legislature / Judiciary	Implements / makes / interprets the law
Head of state / Head of government	Symbolic representative / runs the government
Majoritarian / Consensus democracy	Power concentrated (few veto players) / dispersed (many)
Veto player	Actor whose agreement is needed to change policy
Vertical / Horizontal accountability	Citizens hold state accountable / institutions check each other
Parliamentarism	Exec & legislature fused; parliament elects the PM
Vote of no confidence	Parliament's vote to remove the PM/government
Presidentialism	Exec & legislature elected independently, separate powers
Separation of powers	Constitutional division of power among branches
Coalitional presidentialism	Presidential system where the president must build a party coalition
Semi-presidentialism	Executive split between elected president + PM
Cohabitation	President & PM from different parties
Judicial review	Courts can rule a law unconstitutional
Common law / Code law	Precedent-based / written-code-only
Principal–agent problem	Agent's self-interest may not match the principal's
New Public Management	1980s reform: privatise, competition, "customer" focus
Unitary / Federal	Sole central sovereignty / sovereignty shared with subunits
Symmetrical / Asymmetrical federalism	All subunits equal / some have special powers
Devolution	Reversible decentralisation in a unitary state

Exam pointers

- Reproduce the parliamentary vs presidential vs semi-presidential comparison cold — powers (fused/separated/split), how the executive is **chosen** and **removed**, term length, veto players, a case each.
- Explain parliamentarism (fusion, PM, no-confidence, dissolution) and presidentialism (separation, fixed terms, impeachment, gridlock) as opposite answers to *how executive power is checked*.
- Use **Lijphart's majoritarian ↔ consensus** + **veto players** to place any system, and **vertical vs horizontal accountability** to evaluate it.
- Deploy Linz's "Perils of Presidentialism" (dual legitimacy · winner-take-all · fixed terms) *and* the Cheibub counter — the set-piece stability debate.

- Show that **rules** $\neq$ **outcomes**: UK vs India (party system) and Thatcher vs Reagan (policymaking) are the go-to illustrations.
- Know **federal vs unitary** (+ devolution) as a majority-limiting / minority-protecting device.

★ Fun facts & memorable details

Sticky stats, dates & quotes from Lecture 4 (systems of government).

Quotable / memorable

- Linz's famous article: "**The Perils of Presidentialism**" (1990). Cheibub's rebuttal: presidential systems "*tend to exist in societies where democracies of any type are likely to be unstable*."
- The British PM with a solid majority is "*often called the most powerful democratic executive in the world*."
- **Kenya (2013)** switched from a British-style **parliamentary** to a US-style **presidential** system with its new constitution — a live natural experiment.

Striking numbers

- **Belgium 2010**: a world-record **541 days** to form a government; **Sweden 2018**: 133 days.
- Votes of no confidence **succeed ~5% of the time**.
- **Boris Johnson** became PM chosen by **fewer than 160,000** Conservative members — no national election.
- **India**: 3 PMs in 1947–77 → **12** in 1977–2007 (multipartism = less stability).
- **Brazil**: 30 parties in the Chamber; presidential coalitions average **9 parties**; **60% of Congress under indictment** in 2016.
- **US Senate**: representatives of just over **10%** of the population can block a bill (60-vote rule); state representation ratio $\approx$ **66:1**.
- **Semi-presidentialism** spread from **10 (1990)** → **52 (2018)** systems; 16 are former French/Portuguese colonies.
- **Federal** countries $\approx$ **25**, but hold **>40% of the world's population**; 7 of the 10 largest countries by area are federal.

Thinkers to name-drop

- Separation of powers $\leftarrow$ Montesquieu • semi-presidentialism $\leftarrow$ **France 1958 / de Gaulle** • code law $\leftarrow$ **Napoleon** • majoritarian/consensus $\leftarrow$ **Lijphart** • veto players $\leftarrow$ **Tsebelis** • vertical/horizontal accountability $\leftarrow$ **O'Donnell** • federalism-as-bargain $\leftarrow$ **Riker**.

Lecture 5: Participation and Representation (FK)

Required reading: OD ch. 6 (*Institutions of Participation and Representation*)

Theme of the lecture: Why do some citizens participate while others don't? Why are some interests represented while others aren't? We examine how different institutions — specifically electoral and party systems — shape political participation and representation.

OD Ch. 6 — Institutions of Participation and Representation

Book: Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 6.

Chapter résumé

Looks at the three institutions through which democracies channel **participation and representation** — **electoral systems, parties/party systems, and civil society (interest groups)** — and asks which best represent ordinary and marginalised citizens. It opens with *why anyone participates at all* (a **collective-action problem**), then its analytic core: how **electoral systems** (plurality/SMD · majoritarian · PR · mixed) convert votes into seats and thereby shape the **number of parties (Duverger's Law)**, proportionality, stability, and the representation of women & minorities. It classifies **party systems**, surveys how parties mobilise (programmatic / clientelist / populist) amid a "crisis of party democracy," contrasts **pluralist vs neocorporatist** interest-group systems, and closes on the master **trade-off (Powell): diverse representation ⇔ clear accountability**.

★ **The heart of the chapter: institutions decide who participates and whose interests get represented.** The **electoral system** is the master lever — **SMD/plurality** squeezes politics toward *two parties + clear accountability but wasted votes*; **PR** opens it to *many parties + proportional, diverse representation but coalition instability* (Duverger's Law). Underneath sits one unavoidable **trade-off (Powell): broad representation ⇔ clear accountability/governability**.

The red thread. Two questions run through the chapter. ① **Why participate (or not)?** — voting is individually "irrational" (a **collective-action problem**), so *institutions* raise or lower the cost (PR & simple systems → higher turnout). ② **Whose interests get represented?** — the **electoral system → party system → interest-group system** chain decides. For any case ask: **how do votes become seats · how many parties result · who gets left out (small parties, women, minorities) · and what's traded off (representation vs accountability)?**

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- The electoral-system menu: **SMD plurality (FPTP) · majoritarian (two-round / alternative vote) · proportional representation (PR) · mixed/semiproportional**.
- **Duverger's Law** — SMD → two parties; PR → multiparty.
- **Party systems** — dominant-party · two-party · multiparty; **sociological** (cleavages) vs **institutional** (electoral rules) origins.
- **Mobilisation types** — programmatic · patronage/clientelist · populist.
- **Interest groups: pluralism** (many, neutral state — US) vs **neocorporatism** (few peak associations bargain with the state — Germany).
- The **Powell trade-off** — representation/participation ⇔ accountability/governability.

Section-by-section main points

Lecture frame (FK). The lecture opens by asking *what representation even is* (**Pitkin**), then works through the institutions that produce it — **electoral systems → party systems → civil society** — and closes with **case studies** (UK, Germany, Japan, Brazil).

| What is representation? — Pitkin's four views

Core: before asking *how* institutions represent, ask *what* "representation" means. **Hanna Pitkin** (*The Concept of Representation*, 1967) distinguishes **four** senses:

- **Formalistic** — the institutional arrangement that **authorises** a representative and holds them **accountable** (elections = the "before" and "after" of representing).
- **Descriptive** — the representative **resembles** the represented (shares gender, ethnicity, class) — "**standing for**" (the case for **quotas** / descriptive representation).
- **Symbolic** — the representative **stands for** the represented symbolically (a leader/flag people identify with).
- **Substantive** — the representative **acts in the interests** of the represented — "**acting for**" (the **delegate** [follow instructions] vs **trustee** [own judgment] debate).
- *Why it matters:* the electoral systems below are really machines for producing one kind of representation or another — **PR** boosts **descriptive** representation (more women/minorities); **SMD** emphasises the **formalistic** local link.

| Why participate? — the collective-action problem

Core: voting is individually "**irrational**" (Downs) — one vote rarely decides anything — so participation is a **collective-action problem** that *institutions* must overcome.

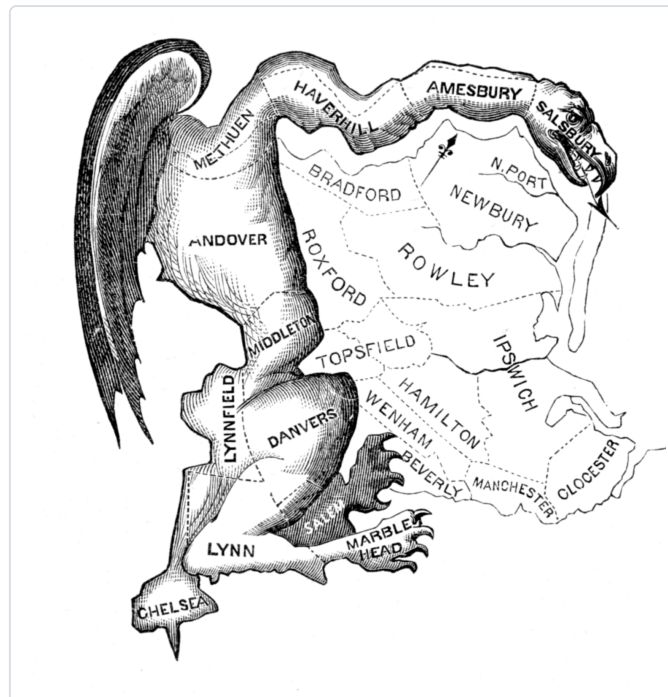
- People vote anyway for **expressive/solidaristic** reasons, charismatic leaders, and to avoid the **emotional cost** of not participating (guilt, exclusion).
- **Institutions shape turnout:** complex systems depress it among the less-educated; **PR/mixed systems raise it** (fewer "wasted votes"); parties & interest groups lower the cost of finding and acting on your interests.

| Electoral systems — *the core of the chapter* ★

Core: the electoral system is the master lever — *on what basis are you represented* (a **district**, a **party/idea**, or a **group**), and *how do votes become seats*?

System	Votes → seats	Parties (Duverger)	Proportionality	Turnout	Women/minorities	Cases
SMD plurality (FPTP)	most votes in each district wins (no majority needed)	two parties	low (wasted votes)	lower	worse	<u>UK</u> , <u>US</u> , <u>India</u>
Majoritarian (two-round / AV ranked-choice)	need 50%+1 → runoff or reallocate	~two blocs	low–medium	—	—	France
Proportional (PR) — closed/open list	seats = vote share (national/large districts, a threshold)	multiparty	high	higher	better	<u>Israel</u> , <u>Brazil</u> (open)
Mixed / semiproportional	SMD seats + party-list PR	multiparty	high (compensatory , <u>Germany</u>) / medium (noncompensatory , <u>Japan</u>)	higher	—	<u>Germany</u> , <u>Japan</u>

- **SMD/FPTP: strengths** — strong voter–representative link, single-party government (efficient, accountable); defenders also invoke **virtual representation** (co-partisans elected in *other* districts speak for you).
Weaknesses — **wasted votes**, **disproportionality** (a party can win many seats on ~35% pluralities; a broad-but-thin party wins almost none), gerrymandering, fewer women/minorities. (*Empirically the SMD "closer link" is weak — Curtice & Shively found no real advantage in voter–rep contact.*)



How to read it (the original "Gerry-mander," 1812). SMD only works if someone *draws the district lines* — and whoever draws them can rig outcomes. This famous cartoon mocks a Massachusetts district that Governor **Elbridge Gerry**'s party contorted into a **salamander** shape to pack/crack opponents into losing

configurations. *Gerry + salamander = "gerrymander."* It's the visual shorthand for why single-member districts are vulnerable to **manipulated boundaries** — a weakness PR (large multi-member districts) largely avoids.

- **Majoritarian — two-round runoff & the Alternative Vote.** Unlike FPTP, the winner must clear an **absolute majority (50%+1)**, so the count needs a *second step* FPTP doesn't have. Two ways to get there:
 - **Two-round system (TRS / runoff)** — *France*. **Round 1:** win outright if you get 50%+1; if not, the top candidates go to a **second-round runoff** a week or two later (top two — or in France's legislative version, *everyone above 12.5% of registered voters*), and whoever leads the runoff wins. Voters whose first choice is knocked out get to **re-choose** among those left.
 - **Alternative Vote (AV) / ranked-choice / instant-runoff** — *one ballot*, but you **rank** candidates 1-2-3... Count the 1st preferences; if nobody has 50%+1, **eliminate the last-placed candidate and transfer their ballots to each voter's next-ranked choice**; repeat until someone passes 50%. It's a runoff done "instantly" in a single election.
 - *Mini worked example (AV):* three candidates — **A 40% · B 35% · C 25%**, nobody at 50%. Eliminate **C**; C's voters' 2nd choices split (say **+18%→B, +7%→A**). New totals: **A 47% · B 53% → B wins** — even though A *led* the first count. That flip is the whole point: it rewards the **broadly acceptable** candidate over the one with the biggest *minority*.
 - *Effect:* squeezes extremes, rewards second-choice-friendly candidates, wastes fewer votes than FPTP; produces **~two blocs** but more softly than FPTP. (*Case: Maine 2018* — *first US Congress seat decided by AV; Golden won 50.5–49.5 after trailing on the first count.*)
- **PR: strengths** — few wasted votes, **higher turnout**, far **more women & minorities** (lists + quotas), more information/positions, more egalitarian policy (Orellana). *Weaknesses* — no identifiable individual rep, **coalition instability**, small extremist parties gain outsized leverage; **Kedar:** PR voters even vote for *more extreme* parties on purpose, expecting post-election compromise to pull policy back to the middle.
 - **Closed vs open list** — *who decides the order within a party's seats?* Under PR you vote for a **party**, which then fills its won seats from a ranked **list of candidates**. The two variants differ in *who sets that rank*:
 - **Closed list:** the **party** fixes the order in advance; you vote only for the party, and if it wins *n* seats they go to the top *n* names on the party's list. → **more party control, party discipline, and easy use of quotas** (a party can guarantee women high spots), but voters can't pick the *individual*. (*e.g. Israel.*)
 - **Open list:** you vote for the party **and** for a **specific candidate** within it; the candidates' *own* vote totals decide who gets the party's seats. → **more voter choice over individuals**, but it makes candidates compete against their *own* party-mates → **weaker, more personalist parties**. (*e.g. Brazil* — *a big reason its parties are so fragmented and weak.*)
- **Mixed:** two ballots (a district candidate + a party list) — blends a personal rep with proportional fairness; **Germany's compensatory** version tops seats up to full proportionality, **Japan's noncompensatory** version keeps SMD & PR separate (less proportional). **AV/ranked-choice** wastes fewer votes than FPTP (Maine 2018 elected the first US Congress seat by AV).
 - **Is Germany still "mixed"? (2023 reform).** You can argue it's **drifting toward pure PR**. Germany's compensatory mechanism caused the Bundestag to balloon (**736 seats in 2021** via overhang + balance seats). The **2023 reform** (first used in the **2025** election) **capped the house at 630** and **abolished overhang & compensatory seats**: a party now gets **only** the seats its **second (list) vote** earns, and district winners are seated **only if their party's list vote covers them** (*Zweitstimmendeckung*) — otherwise the narrowest district winners **lose their seats** even though they won locally. So the **first vote no longer guarantees a personal representative**, and total seats are set almost entirely by the party

vote → many now call it "**personalised PR**" rather than a genuine mixed system. (*The Constitutional Court upheld the cap in 2024 but reinstated the basic-mandate/3-seat clause.*)

- **Redistribution link (Iversen & Soskice — from Lecture 4):** PR → the middle class allies with the poor → bigger welfare states; majoritarian → middle allies with the rich → less. A key reason electoral systems shape *policy*, not just seats (the Sweden vs US welfare puzzle).

Table 1. Electoral system and the number of years with left and right governments (1945-98)

		Government partisanship		Proportion of right governments
		Left	Right	
Electoral system	Proportional	342 (8)	120 (1)	0.26
	Majoritarian	86 (0)	256 (8)	0.75

Note: Excludes centrist governments (see text below for details).

How to read it (Iversen & Soskice). Count the years each system spent under left vs right government (1945–98). Under **PR**, the right governed only **26%** of the time; under **majoritarian**, the right governed **75%** of the time. Same democracies, opposite tilt — hard evidence that the electoral system biases which side holds power over the long run, and hence how big the welfare state gets.

Duverger's Law — and its limits

Core: SMD/plurality → **two parties** (small parties get squeezed out and voters stop "wasting" votes on them); PR → multiparty.

- **But not deterministic:** it holds in *established* democracies; in **new/diverse** democracies voters aren't strategic (ethnic/identity voting persists), so FPTP can still produce many parties (Moser & Scheiner) — see **India**. And it can break even in old democracies (**France 2017:** Macron's one-year-old party upended a near-two-party system).

Party systems

Core: classify a system by the **number & relative strength** of parties. First, *what parties are for*; then the three types; then where they come from.

- **What parties do — five functions (FK deck):** ① **mobilise** citizens to participate • ② **recruit** the political elite (candidates/leaders) • ③ **simplify** choices (a label voters can reason with) • ④ **organise government** (form and run the executive/legislature) • ⑤ **provide opposition** (a government-in-waiting that scrutinises). (*This is what distinguishes parties from interest groups below — parties seek office; interest groups only seek influence.*)
- **The three types — by number & strength:**
 - **Dominant-party:** many parties compete in more-or-less free & fair elections, but **one wins every election** and governs continuously (**ANC**, South Africa — won all six post-apartheid elections, though its share fell to **57.5% in 2019**). **Key nuance:** the line to an **electoral-authoritarian regime** (ch. 8) is

thin — the test is *how* the party keeps winning: by genuine **popularity** (still a democracy) vs by **manipulating the rules, using state resources, and intimidating rivals** (authoritarian).

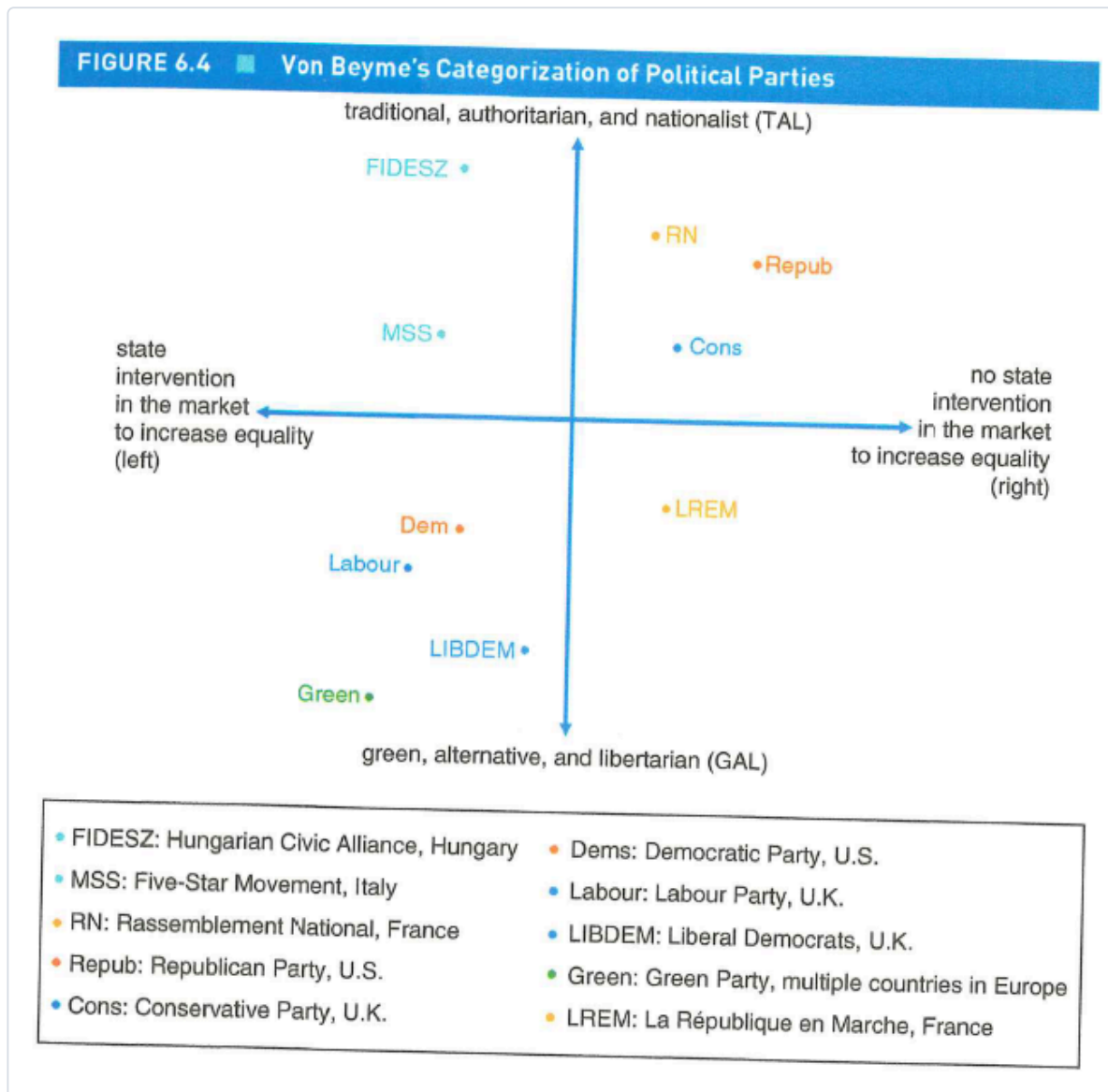
- **Two-party**: only **two** parties can realistically win, though more compete (**US** — no third party significant since the Republicans emerged in the 1850s; **UK**). Third parties (Ross Perot's Reform Party) flare up but **rarely survive more than two elections**.
- **Multiparty**: **more than two** parties could win and govern → **coalitions**. Two sub-variants: **(a)** two large parties, one usually needing small partners to reach a majority (**Italy**); **(b)** three-four roughly equal parties, a majority *always* needing a coalition of ≥ 2 .
- **Where party systems come from — two rival explanations** (the answer to "why do some countries have 2 parties and others 6?"):
 - **Sociological** — parties grow out of social *cleavages*. A party forms to represent a self-conscious social group, so the **number of parties mirrors how many deep social divisions a society has**. Two classic 19th-century European cleavages:
 - **Economic (capital vs labour)** — became **universal** with industrialisation: *every* country got a **business/"liberal" party** and a **workers' party** (socialist/social-democratic). This one cleavage alone yields **two** party families.
 - **Religious** — existed in **some** countries, not all: **Germany** has a Christian party (CDU/CSU) speaking for a Catholic minority in a Protestant country; **France**, almost entirely Catholic, never needed one.
 - **The rule**: each *additional* salient cleavage tends to add a party family → **both economic + religious salient = multiparty; only economic salient = two-party**.
 - **Institutional (Duverger)** — the *electoral rules shape the party count*. Rational politicians build whatever kind of party *wins under the given rules*, so the **system** drives the number, not just society. **Under SMD** you must come **first in a district** to win *anything*, so (i) small/ideological parties get **no seats** and wither, and (ii) voters **stop "wasting" votes** on no-hopers → politics collapses toward **two** broad catch-all parties. **Under PR** (seats $\approx$ vote share) *both* pressures vanish → **multiparty survives**.
- **Bridging the "chicken-and-egg"**: the institutional effect holds in **established** democracies but *not* in **new** ones, where voters aren't strategic (ethnic/identity voting persists, FPTP winners take seats on 20–30%) — Boix; Moser & Scheiner. **France** is the classic Duverger case (its two-round SMD pushed a fragmented system to ~two blocs, 82% of seats by 2012) — until **2017**, when Macron's one-year-old party blew it up.

How parties mobilise — and the "crisis of party democracy"

Core: parties win support in **three distinct ways** — how a party mobilises tells you what *kind* of party it is:

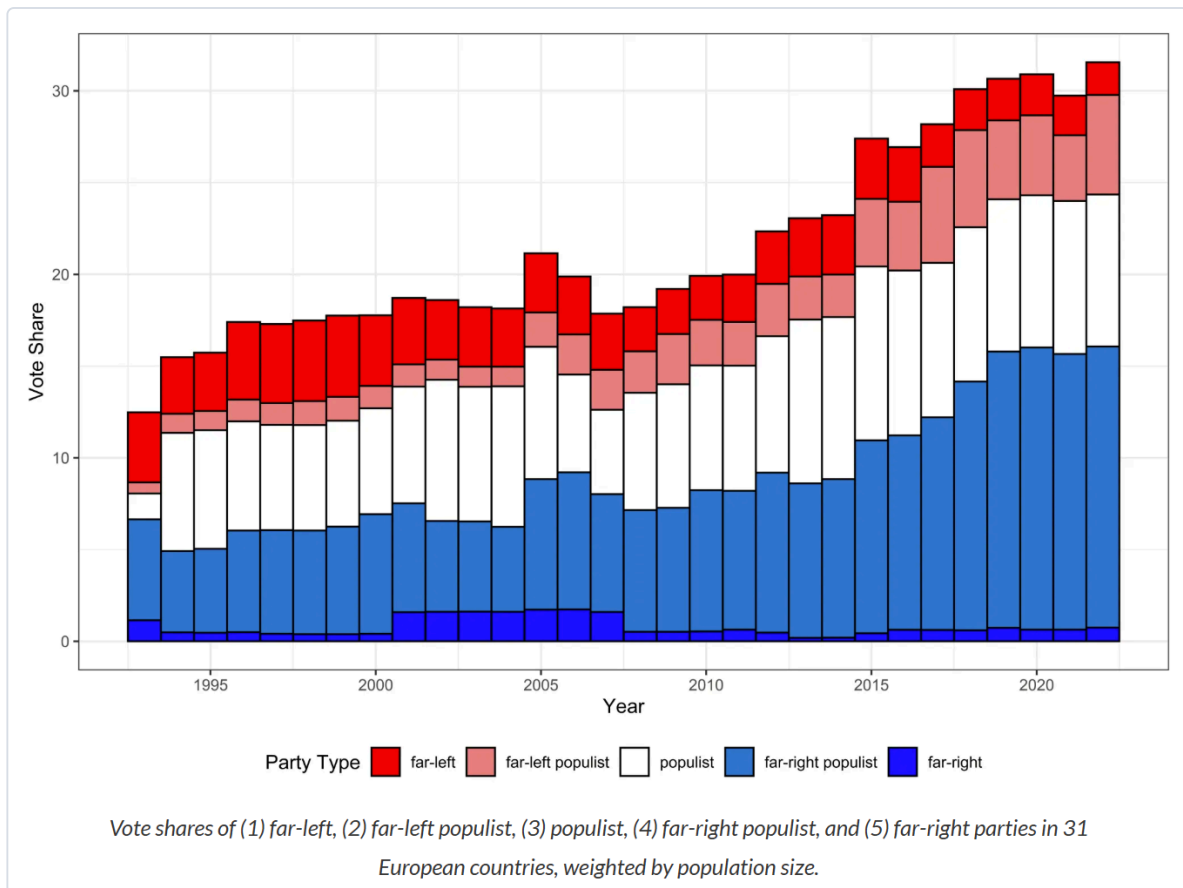
Type	How it wins votes	Signature	Where it thrives
Programmatic	offers ideas / ideology / policy — you vote for its platform	manifestos, left–right positioning	established, richer democracies
Patronage / clientelist	trades material benefits for votes , delivered through local brokers	jobs, cash, favours, "get out the vote" machines	poorer / newer & statist economies
Populist	a personalist leader frames " the people " vs a " corrupt elite "	crisis rhetoric, anti-establishment, deliberate " bad manners "	anywhere in a "crisis of party democracy"

- **Where parties sit — two ideology axes (FK):** parties map onto **two** dimensions, not one — the classic economic **Left–Right** (redistribution: *state intervention to increase equality* $\rightleftharpoons$ *no intervention*) *plus* the modern cultural **GAL–TAN** — **GAL** (Green/Alternative/Libertarian: progressive, cosmopolitan, pro-environment, individual rights) vs **TAN/TAL** (Traditional/Authoritarian/Nationalist). Today's populist/far-right parties (Farage, Salvini, AfD) mobilise mainly on the **TAN** end of this *second* axis.



How to read it (Von Beyme, OD Fig. 6.4). The **horizontal axis** = **economics** (left = *state intervention to increase equality*; right = *no intervention*); the **vertical axis** = **culture/values** (bottom = **GAL**; top = **TAL/TAN**). A party's position is the *pair* of coordinates — e.g. **Labour/Dems** sit centre-left & GAL-ish, **RN (Rassemblement National)** & **FIDESZ** sit right & strongly **TAL**, **Greens** sit far **GAL**. The point: two parties can share an economic position yet be opposites on culture — which is exactly how the far-right mobilises on the **TAN** axis without moving economically.

- **Caveat on "programmatic":** **Achen & Bartels** ("folk theory" critique) argue voters mostly vote by **social identity**, not by carefully weighing ideas — so pure programmatic appeal is partly a myth.
- **Crisis of party democracy:** only ~20% trust parties (though ~80% value democracy); falling loyalty/membership/turnout, rising **electoral volatility**, single-issue/postmaterialist voting, and **far-right/anti-system** parties (nativism, post-2015 refugee crisis). Explanations: economic (globalisation, manufacturing decline); **dealignment** (voters detach from all parties) vs **realignment** (they switch); catch-all parties → "**cartel parties**" (Mair) colluding at the centre → lost efficacy.



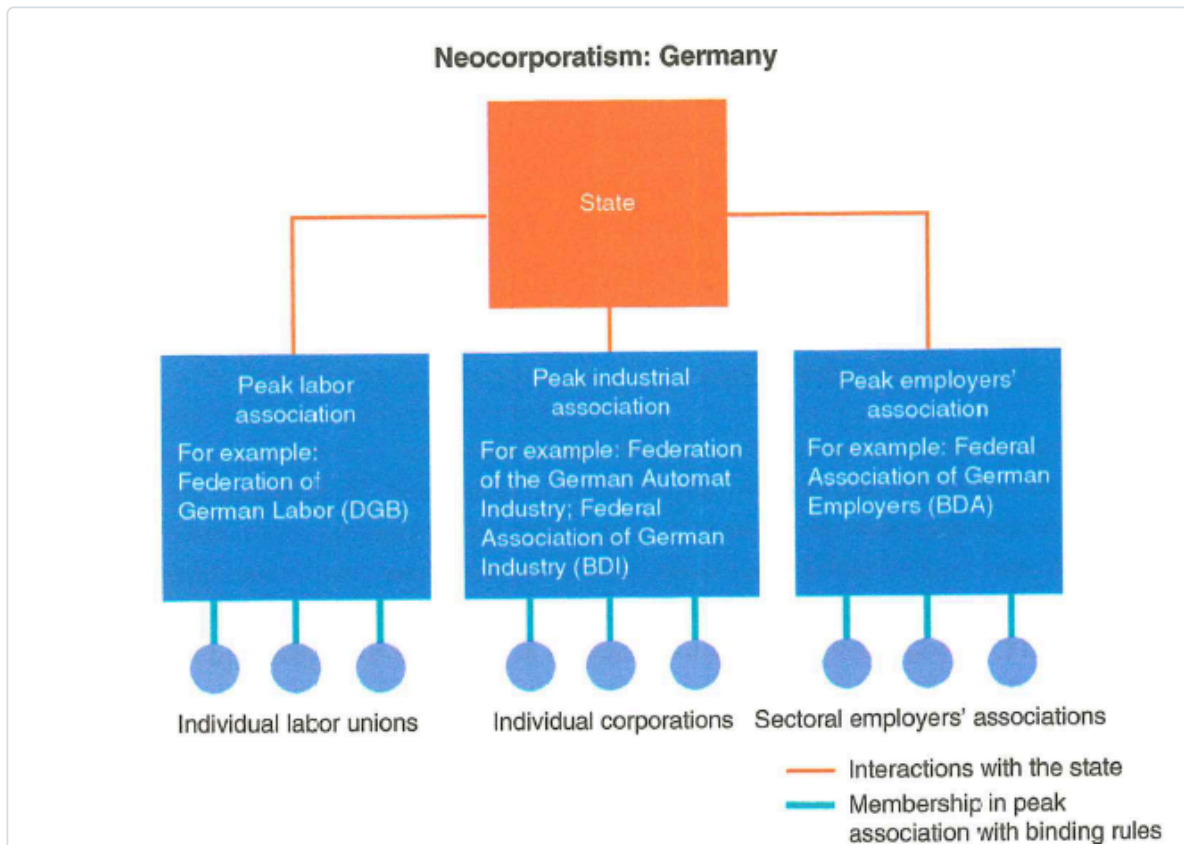
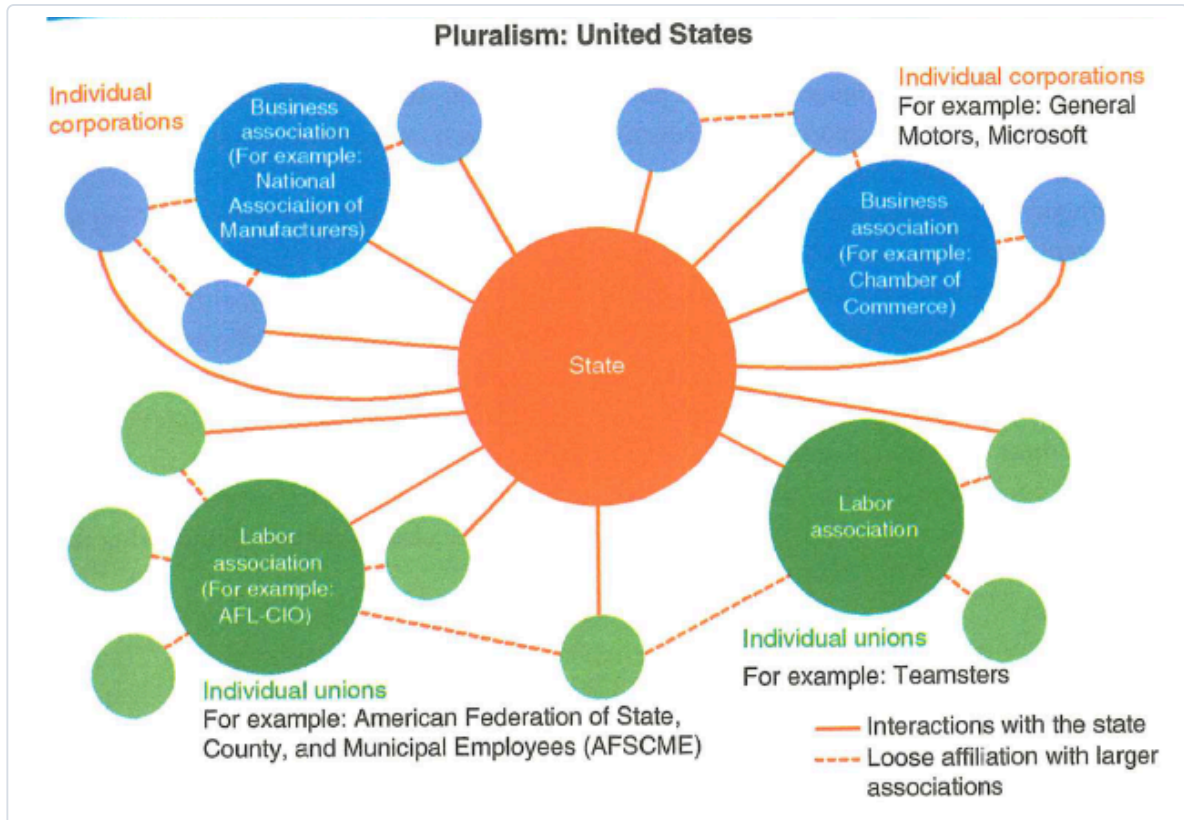
How to read it (The PopuList, Rooduijn et al. 2024). Each bar = one year's **combined vote share** of anti-establishment parties across 31 European countries; the colours split them into far-left, far-left-populist, populist, **far-right-populist (blue)** and far-right. The story is the **near-doubling** from ~12% (1993) to ~31% (2022), and that most of the growth is the **blue far-right-populist band** — the empirical face of the "crisis of party democracy."

- **US exception:** not dealignment but partisan **sorting/polarisation** (Abramowitz), racial realignment, and Trump's **status-threat** populism (Mutz 2018).

Civil society & interest groups — pluralism vs neocorporatism

Core: beyond parties, organised **interest groups** (they *don't* seek office, unlike parties) represent society — in two rival models. Groups grew sector-by-sector: first **labour, business, agriculture**, then **women/minority** groups; in divided societies, ethnic/religious groups dominate (some, like the KKK, are internally *undemocratic* — a tension for democracy).

- **Pluralism (US):** **many** competing groups, a **neutral** state; easy entry & local control, but fragmented clout — and **business is inherently privileged** (Lindblom). **Schattschneider's** famous jab: "*the flaw in the pluralist heaven is that the heavenly chorus sings with a strong upper-class accent*" — i.e. who gets organised is skewed toward the well-off.
- **Neocorporatism** / societal corporatism (Germany, N. Europe): a **few large, hierarchical peak associations** the state recognises as *the* voice of each sector negotiate **binding** deals; more influence (esp. for labour countering business) but **less participatory** (little incentive to form new groups). (*State corporatism = the mandated, authoritarian version — ch. 8.*)
- **Social-capital debate:** Putnam (*Bowling Alone*) sees civic **decline**; Skocpol adds that mass-membership bodies gave way to **managed advocacy**; critics (Dalton, "**Kicking in Groups**") reply that activity just **moved to new forms** (movements, single-issue groups).



How to read them (OD). *Pluralism (US, first diagram):* many groups orbit a **neutral** state, connected by thin/loose lines — lots of competing voices, easy entry, but **fragmented** clout and no single channel.

Neocorporatism (Germany, second): the state is formally wired to just a **few large peak associations** (peak labour DGB, peak industry BDI, peak employers BDA), each sitting *above* its own member firms/unions — fewer, **binding** channels → more influence (esp. for labour) but **harder for new groups** to break in. Same job (representing interests), opposite architecture: *many-and-loose* vs *few-and-binding*.

The master trade-off (Powell)

Core: systems open to **diversity** (PR · multiparty · pluralism) maximise **representation & participation** but blur **accountability & governability**; **majoritarian** systems (FPTP · two-party) do the reverse. *There is no free lunch — every design chooses a point on this line.* The chapter's most robust finding: **PR represents women far better than SMD** (India goes further with **reserved seats**).

Cases & examples

Why these cases are here — **circle them back**. Each shows **one electoral/party system in action** and *who it represents vs leaves out*. Read each for: *which system · how votes became seats · who got left out*.

Case	Electoral system	Party system	What it shows
<u>UK</u>	SMD/FPTP	two-party	extreme disproportionality (UKIP 12.6% → 1 seat)
<u>Germany</u>	mixed compensatory PR	multiparty	how mixed PR lets new parties (Greens, AfD) in
<u>Japan</u>	mixed noncompensatory	dominant (LDP)	more majoritarian; Duverger working haltingly
<u>India</u>	SMD/FPTP + federal	multiparty	Duverger's limits in a diverse democracy; reserved seats
<u>Brazil</u>	open-list PR (no threshold)	fragmented	weak-party fragmentation (30 parties) + populism
<u>Israel</u>	pure closed-list PR	hyper-multiparty	PR instability under extreme diversity

- **UK — SMD/FPTP.** The paradigm two-party FPTP system: modest vote margins → big seat majorities → single-party government. But it's wildly **disproportional** — in **2015, UKIP won 12.6% of the vote → 1 seat**, while the **SNP won fewer votes → 56 seats** (geographically concentrated in Scotland). → *SMD/FPTP → disproportionality, wasted votes, majoritarian governance.*
- **Germany — mixed compensatory PR.** Designed after Weimar with a **5% threshold** + compensatory mixed PR → a stable multiparty system. The **Greens (1983)** got in *because* the semiproportional system let them clear the threshold (unlike Britain's Greens); by **2017** the two big parties fell to a record **54%**, and the far-right **AfD** won its first seats. **Note (2023 reform):** to stop the house ballooning (736 seats in 2021), Germany **capped it at 630** and **scrapped overhang/compensatory seats** — seats now follow the **list vote** and a district win no longer guarantees a seat, so it's arguably become **personalised PR** rather than truly "mixed." → *Mixed PR sustains a multiparty system and lets new/ideological parties gain representation — though the 2023 reform pushes it toward pure PR.*
- **Japan — mixed noncompensatory.** The **LDP dominated 1955–93** via factions & clientelism; the **1994 reform** (300 SMD + 180 PR, *noncompensatory*) pushed toward two parties — the **DPJ won 308/480 in 2009**, but the **LDP swept back in 2012** ("lucky, not popular" — a split opposition). → *Noncompensatory mixed = more majoritarian than Germany; Duverger's Law working haltingly.*
- **India — FPTP in a diverse federation.** FPTP "should" give two parties, but **huge diversity + federalism** yields many *state-level* two-party fights that aggregate into a **national multiparty** system (parties: 50 in 1952 → 342 in 2009). **BJP (Modi) 2014: 31% of the vote → 52% of seats** under FPTP. **120 of ~600 seats are reserved** for lower castes/tribes. → *Duverger's limits in a new/diverse democracy; reserved-seat representation.*
- **Brazil — open-list PR, no threshold.** No incentive for intra-party cooperation → extreme fragmentation (**30 parties by 2018**) and weak, local parties (a third of legislators switched parties 1989–95). Recession + the "car wash" scandal → mass protests → **Rousseff impeached (2016)** → outsider populist **Bolsonaro won 2018** atop a tiny party. → *Open-list PR's weak-party fragmentation + accountability failure + populism.*

- **Israel — pure PR.** The whole country is **one district**, a 120-seat Knesset, **3.25% threshold** → ~a dozen parties win; governments = a big party + 3–6 small ones, lasting ~2 years; **2019 produced three elections in one year.** → *PR's instability under extreme diversity — the cost of maximal proportionality.*

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Collective-action problem	Individuals rationally don't act (vote) though all suffer if none do
Electoral system	Legal mechanism translating votes into offices/seats
Single-member district (SMD)	Each district elects one representative
Plurality / FPTP	Most votes wins (no majority needed)
<u>Majoritarian</u>	Winner needs an absolute majority (50%+1)
<u>Two-round system (runoff)</u>	If no 50%+1 in round 1, top candidates meet in a second-round runoff (France)
<u>Alternative Vote (AV) / ranked-choice</u>	Rank candidates; eliminate last-placed & transfer their votes until one passes 50%
Proportional representation (PR)	Seats = vote share (national/large districts + a threshold)
<u>Closed-list PR</u>	Vote for a party; the party sets the candidate order (party control, quotas) — Israel
<u>Open-list PR</u>	Vote for party and a candidate; candidates' own votes set the order (voter choice, weaker parties) — Brazil
Mixed / semiproportional	SMD seats + party-list PR (compensatory / noncompensatory)
Duverger's Law	SMD → two parties; PR → multiparty
Party system	Number & strength of parties (dominant / two-party / multiparty)
Programmatic / patronage / populist mobilisation	Win support by ideas / material rewards / anti-elite personalism
Interest-group pluralism	Many competing groups, neutral state (US)
Neocorporatism	Few peak associations bargain binding deals with the state (Germany)
Peak association	Body uniting a whole sector to negotiate with the state
Social capital	Networks + norms of reciprocity underpinning civil society
Powell trade-off	Diverse representation ⇔ clear accountability

Exam pointers

- Reproduce the electoral-systems comparison cold — how each converts votes→seats, its effect on the **number of parties (Duverger)**, **proportionality**, **turnout**, and **women/minorities** — with a case each.
- Answer both spine questions: **why participate** (collective-action problem; institutions shape turnout) and **whose interests get represented** (electoral → party → interest-group chain).

- State Duverger's Law and its limits (India; France 2017).
- Contrast pluralism vs neocorporatism (US vs Germany) for interest representation.
- Land on the Powell trade-off (representation $\rightleftharpoons$ accountability) and the robust finding that **PR represents women better**; use Iversen & Soskice to link PR $\rightarrow$ more redistribution.

★ Fun facts & memorable details

Sticky stats, dates & quotes from Lecture 5 (participation & representation).

Quotable

- Schattschneider (1942): "*Modern democracy is unthinkable save in terms of parties.*"
- Downs (1957): for most people, voting is technically **irrational** — the seed of the collective-action problem.
- Powell's master **trade-off**: representation/participation $\rightleftharpoons$ accountability/governability.

Striking numbers

- **UK 2015**: UKIP won **12.6%** $\rightarrow$ **1 seat**; the SNP won *fewer* votes $\rightarrow$ **56 seats**.
- **US 2012 House**: in the ten most gerrymandered states, Republicans won **7% more votes but 76% more seats**.
- **Israel**: whole country = one district; **3.25% threshold**; **three elections in one year (2019)**; governments last $\sim$ 2 years.
- **India**: parties grew **50 (1952) $\rightarrow$ 342 (2009)**; **120 of $\sim$ 600** seats reserved for lower castes/tribes; BJP 2014 = **31% of vote $\rightarrow$ 52% of seats**.
- **Brazil 2018**: its most fragmented legislature ever — **30 parties**.
- **Women in legislatures**: Nordic countries lead at **42.5%**; US House only **23.4%** (2019). Robust finding: **PR elects more women than SMD**.
- Only $\sim$ **20%** of citizens trust parties, though $\sim$ **80%** call democracy "a very good thing."
- **Maine 2018**: first US Congress seat decided by **ranked-choice** — Golden won 50.5–49.5 after trailing on the first count.

Memorable

- **France**: the top two parties held **56% of Assembly seats (1973) $\rightarrow$ 82% (2012)** — then the system **collapsed in 2017** with Macron's one-year-old party.
 - **$\sim$ 60 countries** used FPTP in 2019 — almost all former British colonies; **Belarus** was the only continental-European one.
 - The social-capital debate in two titles: Putnam's *Bowling Alone* vs its rebuttal "**Kicking in Groups**."
-

Lecture 6: Institutions and Institutionalisms (AUW)

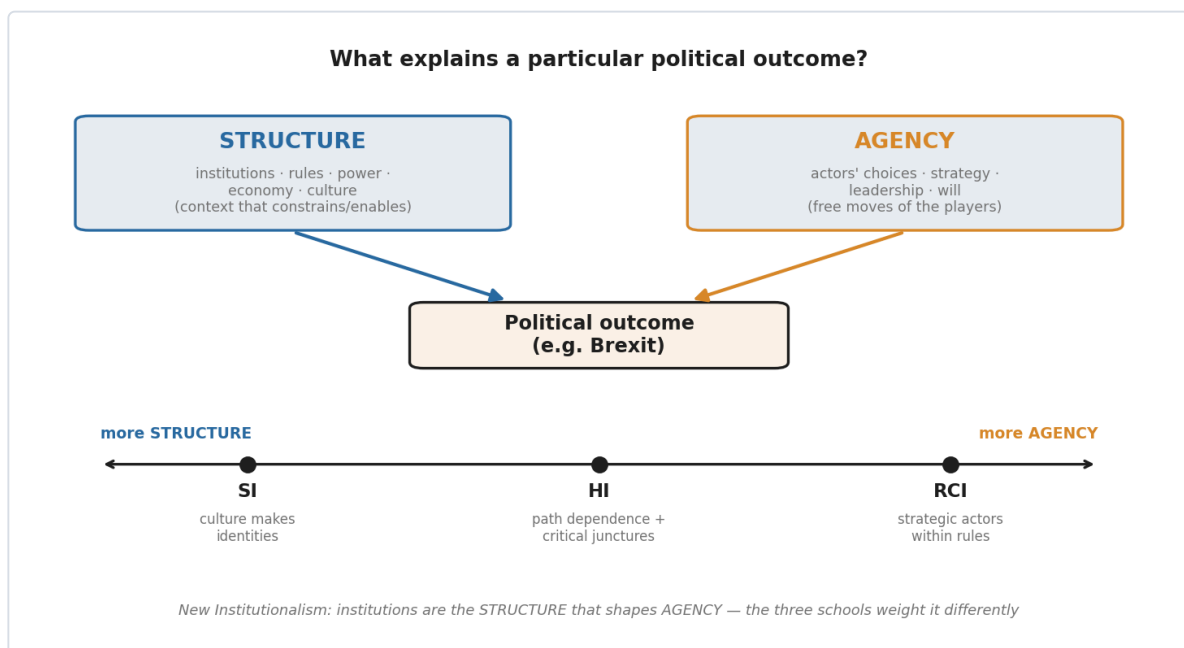
Required reading: Hall & Taylor (1996), *Political Science and the Three New Institutionalisms* • Busemeyer & Thelen (2020), *Institutional Sources of Business Power* (an HI example)

Theme of the lecture: the role of **institutions and structures** in political processes — how institutions shape the behaviour of political actors, and what drives institutional **change vs continuity** — focusing on the rational-choice (RCI), historical (HI), and sociological (SI) variants of **New Institutionalism** (with path dependence and institutional legacies as central concepts).

Lecture frame (AUW) — the essentials before the three schools

Core: institutions $\neq$ organizations. Institutions are the **rules/norms that enable or constrain actors**; organizations are **groups of actors**. (*Ayca's example: the **Social Democratic Party** is an organization; the constitutional & legal rules, its internal statutes, and the unwritten norms governing it — e.g. can an MP defy the leadership and keep their job? — are institutions.*)

- **The grand debate it enters: structure vs agency** — *what explains a particular political outcome?* (the deck's opening question). Two pure answers:
 - **Structure** = the **context that shapes action** — institutions, rules, laws, social & economic structures, distributions of power, culture. On this view an outcome is driven by the **situation actors are in** (the "board and rules of the game"); actors are almost **carried along** by their environment.
 - **Agency** = the **capacity of actors to choose and act independently** — strategy, leadership, will. On this view an outcome is driven by **what particular people decided to do** (the "players' free moves").
 - *Why it matters:* explain **Brexit** (or any outcome) and you're implicitly taking a side — was it the deep **structures** (Britain's institutional history, its economy, EU rules) or the **agency** of key actors (Cameron calling the referendum, Johnson/Farage campaigning)? Pure structure = actors are dupes of context; pure agency = "great men" make history.
 - **New Institutionalism's answer** (the "revised" theory: behavioralism → institutionalist critique → New Institutionalism) is a **middle position: institutions are the key structure that shapes agency** — they **enable and constrain** actors without fully determining them. And the three schools sit at **different points** on the structure↔agency line: **SI** most *structural* (culture constitutes actors' identities & preferences → least free agency), **RCI** most *agency* (strategic actors freely maximise *within* the rules), **HI** in between (path dependence & power dominate, but actors act at **critical junctures**).



How to read it (the deck's opening framing). The **same outcome** (e.g. Brexit) can be explained by **structure** (the constraining context — institutions, rules, power, culture) or by **agency** (what actors chose to do). Institutionalism says it's *both*, with institutions as the structure that channels agency — and the **spectrum**

at the bottom is the exam-useful part: **SI** leans most structural (culture makes the actors), **RCI** leans most agency (strategic actors within fixed rules), **HI** sits in the middle (path dependence + critical junctures). Locating a school on this line is how you answer "which weights structure vs agency?"

- **Why study institutions?** They have **profound political consequences** — e.g. electoral system → party system (majoritarian → two-party; PR → multiparty — Lectures 4–5); parental-benefit design → labour-market gender equality.
- **The definition of "institution"** *widens* across the three schools — this is the key organising idea:

School	What counts as an institution
RCI (narrowest)	"Rules of the game" — constitutions, laws, regulations, court decisions
HI (middle)	The above + procedures, routines, norms, conventions (how things are done; SOPs)
SI (broadest)	All the above + symbol systems, cognitive scripts, moral/discursive templates — " <u>frames of meaning</u> " (role of the state, national identity, <u>patriarchy</u> , institutional racism...)

Hall & Taylor (1996) — The Three New Institutionalisms

Chapter résumé

Hall & Taylor show that "the new institutionalism" is **not one theory but three** — **rational-choice (RCI)**, **historical (HI)**, and **sociological (SI)** institutionalism — which arose in the 1980s–90s (all reacting against 1960s–70s **behavioralism**) yet developed **independently**, "paint quite different pictures of the political world," and rarely cited each other. They compare the three on **two questions fundamental to any institutional analysis**: (1) **how institutions relate to behaviour**, and (2) **how institutions originate and change**. Their verdict: none is wrong — each captures a **partial** truth — so they call for **cross-fertilisation**.

★ **The heart of the reading**: three schools answer the same question — *how do institutions shape political behaviour and outcomes?* — very differently. **RCI**: institutions are rules that structure **strategic interaction** among fixed-preference utility-maximisers ("calculus"). **HI**: institutions distribute **power** unevenly and lock in **paths** over time (eclectic). **SI**: institutions are **cultural frames of meaning** that constitute actors' very identities and preferences ("cultural"). The exam task: fill in the comparison table and use it to build *three competing explanations* for one outcome.

The red thread. Everything reduces to **two cross-cutting approaches** (Hall & Taylor's own device): the **calculus approach** (actors strategically maximise; institutions give certainty about others' behaviour; persist as a **Nash equilibrium**) vs the **cultural approach** (actors interpret via worldviews; institutions provide moral/cognitive templates; persist because **taken-for-granted**). **RCI = pure calculus** · **SI = pure cultural** · **HI = both**. For any theory ask: *calculus or cultural* — and how does that answer "how do actors behave / what do institutions do / why do they persist"?

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The three schools**: **RCI** · **HI** · **SI** (+ the widening definition of "institution").
- **Calculus vs cultural approaches** — the master framework for *how institutions affect behaviour*.

- **RCI toolkit:** strategic interaction · collective-action dilemmas · gains from exchange · Nash equilibrium.
- **HI toolkit:** power asymmetries · path dependence · critical junctures · unintended consequences.
- **SI toolkit:** frames of meaning · logic of appropriateness · isomorphism · legitimacy.

Section-by-section main points

| What "New Institutionalism" is — and why it's "new"

Core: New Institutionalism is the family of approaches (from the 1980s) holding that **institutions shape political behaviour and outcomes** — reviving institutions as an *explanation* after behavioralism had sidelined them. The single claim uniting all three schools: **institutions are not a neutral backdrop; they structure what actors do** (they then disagree on *how*).

- **Why "New"? — three waves of theory** (the deck's *original* → *counter* → *revised* arc):
 - ① **Original theory — "old" institutionalism** (early–mid 20th c.): the **descriptive** study of *formal* institutions — constitutions, legal codes, the machinery of government. Detailed on paper rules, but **static, atheoretical, country-by-country** — it described institutions without explaining behaviour.
 - ② **Counter theory — behavioralism** (1960s–70s): reacted *against* the old school — politics should be a **science of observable behaviour** (attitudes, voting, opinion), explained by **individuals and informal processes**. Institutions were demoted to **epiphenomena** — just the *aggregate* of individual choices, so the formal rules "don't really matter."
 - ③ **Revised theory — New Institutionalism** (1980s–90s): **brings institutions back in** — but *revised*. It concedes the behaviorist focus on action, yet insists institutions **actively shape and constrain** that action and its outcomes (not merely describe it). "Institutions back in, now doing real explanatory work" is what makes it **New**. (*This is also the structure ⇌ agency answer: institutions are the structure that channels agency.*)
- **What New Institutionalism studies — institutions, through three guiding questions** (deck):
 - ① **What do institutions look like?** — e.g. **Danish labour-market rules** ("flexicurity" — flexible hiring/firing + strong welfare security); **post-conflict peace-building** institutions (truth & reconciliation commissions in **Rwanda, South Africa**).
 - ② **What similarities & differences do they show across contexts?** — e.g. **neocorporatism in Sweden vs Germany; presidentialism in the US vs Brazil** (same type, different workings — Lecture 4).
 - ③ **Why do they show those similarities/differences across time & space?** — the question the **three schools answer differently** (RCI vs HI vs SI). *Today's reading is exactly this move:* why does **privatisation of education** take three different forms in Germany, Sweden and the USA (Busemeyer & Thelen)?
- **The pay-off for the rest of the lecture:** all three schools **agree** institutions matter and shape behaviour; they then **split two ways** — on *how* institutions work (calculus vs cultural) and on *what even counts* as an institution (the widening definition above). Those two splits generate the three schools below.

| The two archetypes — calculus vs cultural

Core: any institutionalism must answer three questions — *how do actors behave? what do institutions do? why do they persist?* — and there are two archetypal answer-sets.

In plain terms: the **calculus** side sees people as **calculators** (institutions are the rules that make deals work); the **cultural** side sees people as **role-players** following scripts (institutions are the shared meanings that tell us

what's "done"). This one split is the engine of the whole lecture — **RCI** = pure calculus, **SI** = pure cultural, **HI** = both.

	Calculus approach (→ RCI)	Cultural approach (→ SI)
How do actors behave?	Instrumental, strategic utility-maximisers ; preferences given exogenously	Behaviour bounded by a worldview ; satisficers ; choice depends on <i>interpretation</i>
What do institutions do?	Provide certainty about others (information, enforcement); shape expectations	Provide moral/cognitive templates ; shape identities & preferences themselves
Why do they persist?	They're a Nash equilibrium — deviating makes you worse off	Taken-for-granted ; one actor can't change a collective convention

HI is eclectic — it uses *both*.

★ The three institutionalisms compared (*the exam table — from the screenshot*)

Core: memorise this. To answer "why did outcome X happen?", read *across a row* for three competing explanations.

Dimension	Rational Choice (RCI)	Historical (HI)	Sociological (SI)
Definition of institutions	Rules/procedures that structure strategic interaction (narrow)	Formal/informal procedures, routines, norms, conventions embedded in the polity/economy (tied to organizations)	Symbol systems, cognitive scripts, moral templates — "frames of meaning" (dissolves the institution/culture line)
Example they study	US Congress (committees, rules of procedure)	Cross-national public policy (welfare states, labour, corporatism)	Organizational forms & their diffusion (why education ministries worldwide look alike)
Institutions ↔ behaviour	Calculus	Eclectic (both)	Cultural
How do actors behave?	Fixed exogenous preferences ; instrumental, strategic maximisers	Both strategic <i>and</i> worldview-shaped (strategies can ossify into worldviews)	Socially-constituted interpreters; " logic of appropriateness " — what's "rational" is itself socially constituted
What do institutions do?	Structure strategic interaction; provide info/enforcement → reduce uncertainty, enable gains from exchange ; solve collective-action problems	Structure conflict — privilege some interests, demobilise others; distribute power unevenly	Confer meaning & legitimacy ; constitute actors' identities & preferences
Why do they persist?	They're a Nash equilibrium (deviation costs you)	Path dependence — groups develop interests "costly to shift"	Taken-for-granted ; can't be changed by one individual
How/why do they change?	Deductive; voluntary agreement / competitive selection (<i>weak on change — the "equilibrium paradox"</i>)	Critical junctures (crisis/war) → branching points ; otherwise path-dependent	Adopt new templates for legitimacy (not efficiency); borrowing/diffusion ; can even be <i>dysfunctional</i>
Particular focus	Strategic interaction; collective-action dilemmas; gains from exchange	Power asymmetries; path dependence; unintended consequences; ideas	Legitimacy; culture; isomorphism
Key concepts	transaction costs, principal-agent, Nash equilibrium, gains from exchange	path dependence, critical junctures, unintended consequences, "mobilization of bias"	frames of meaning, cognitive scripts, logic of appropriateness, isomorphism
Hall & Taylor's critique	Thin/"simplistic" motivation ; exogenous preferences; functionalist origins	Vague on the precise causal mechanism ; too inductive	"Bloodless" ; "action without agents" ; misses power

Rational Choice Institutionalism (RCI) — the "calculus" school

Core: institutions are the **rules of the game** that let self-interested players strike deals they otherwise couldn't trust each other to keep — and they last because **breaking them would leave you worse off**.

- **In plain terms:** everyone is out for themselves and constantly *calculating*. Left alone, people get stuck in situations where they'd *all* be better off cooperating but nobody trusts anyone else to do their part.

Institutions are the **rules that make cooperation pay**, so people follow them.

- **Where it came from — the US Congress puzzle** (this is *why* the school exists): plain rational-choice theory predicted Congress could never pass stable laws. Legislators want different things on many issues, so any bill should be beaten by a new majority — endless "**cycling**." Yet Congress *does* produce stable legislation. **Why?** Because its **rules** structure the game: agenda control limits which options get voted on, committees carve up jurisdiction, and enforcement makes **logrolling** (vote-trading) deals stick. Those rules **lower the "transaction costs" of doing deals** and let legislators capture "**gains from exchange**." → *institutions solve the collective-action problems that would otherwise paralyse a legislature.*
- **Its four defining assumptions:**
 1. **Fixed preferences + strategic maximising.** Actors have a set menu of wants and act instrumentally to get as much as possible, via extensive calculation.
 2. **Politics = collective-action dilemmas.** Individually rational choices often produce a **collectively bad** result (classic images: the prisoner's dilemma, the tragedy of the commons) — unless an institution guarantees others will cooperate too.
 3. **Strategic interaction is central.** What you do depends on **what you expect others to do**; institutions shape those expectations by supplying **information + enforcement** that cut the uncertainty about everyone else.
 4. **Origins explained by function.** An institution exists *because of the value it delivers* to those who set it up — created by **voluntary agreement**, or selected because efficient forms **out-compete** rivals.
- **Borrowed toolkit:** the "new economics of organization" — **transaction costs** (Williamson), **property rights, principal-agent** (how "principals" monitor and enforce compliance on their "agents," e.g. Congress over regulatory agencies).
- **Why institutions persist — a Nash equilibrium** (*in plain terms*: a settled situation where **no one can do better by breaking ranks alone**, so everyone sticks with it).
- **Best at:** precise, generalisable theory; and above all **explaining why institutions persist**.
- **Weak at — origins & change.** Three linked charges: **functionalist** (you can't read an institution's origins off its *effects* — unintended consequences are everywhere); **intentionalist** (assumes founders foresaw those effects — "heroic prescience"); **voluntarist** (treats creation as equals freely contracting, **ignoring power asymmetries**). Plus the **equilibrium paradox**: if the status quo is *already* a Nash equilibrium, why would anyone agree to change it? (RCI needs a better theory of *dynamic equilibria*.)
- **Exemplars:** US Congress — **Shepsle, Weingast; Cox & McCubbins** (parties, not just committees); **Ostrom** (common-pool resources); **North** (economic institutions); **Tsebelis** (EU reform).

Historical Institutionalism (HI) — power + path dependence

Core: institutions **hand power to some groups and not others**, and early choices push a country down a **path** that gets costly to leave — so big change waits for rare crisis moments (**critical junctures**).

- **In plain terms:** history matters, and the playing field is **tilted**. The rules a country built long ago give some groups the upper hand and lock the country onto a track. You mostly stay on that track — until a shock (war, economic crisis) forces a switch.
- **Where it came from:** reacted against 1960s **group theory** and **structural-functionalism** (plus a neo-Marxist debate) → brought the **state** back in as an actor that *structures* group conflict rather than neutrally refereeing it. Most HI work = **cross-national comparisons of public policy** (welfare states, tax, labour movements).

- **What counts as an institution (a middle-width definition):** the **formal and informal procedures, routines, norms and conventions** embedded in organisations — from a constitution's rules to a bureaucracy's standard operating procedures to the conventions governing unions or bank–firm relations.
- **Its four features:**
 1. **Eclectic on behaviour** — uses *both* **calculus and cultural approaches**. Sometimes actors strategically calculate (Immergut: doctors' groups compromise or not depending on where they can appeal a decision); sometimes strategies "**ossify over time into worldviews**" that then shape identities (Hattam: US vs British unions developed different outlooks).
 2. **Power asymmetries (its signature move)**. Institutions **distribute power unevenly** — they give some groups **disproportionate access** to decisions and "structure conflict to privilege some and demobilise others." So HI stresses that **some groups win while others lose** (this is the *2nd and 3rd faces of power* from Lecture 1). (*Steinmo on tax; Weir on which coalitions can form.*)
 3. **Path dependence + unintended consequences**. *In plain terms:* the *same* pressure produces *different* results in different countries because each inherited a different institutional track. Past policy leads groups to organise, adopt identities and build interests that become "**costly to shift**" → **lock-in**. Change is bunched at **critical junctures** — crisis/war moments that open a "**branching point**" onto a new path; between them, continuity rules. **Acknowledged weakness:** HI is weak on explaining *what triggers* a critical juncture in the first place.
 4. **Ideas belong in the causal chain**. Institutions aren't the *only* cause — ideas matter too (Goldstein: US institutions amplified some trade ideas over others; Weir: institutions set the *timing* of when Keynesian ideas caught on).
- **Why institutions persist** — *path dependence* / **lock-in** (*in plain terms:* the longer you're on a track, the more expensive it becomes to reverse, so you don't).
- **Best at:** the most "**commodious**," **realistic** school — the **bridge/pivot** between RCI and SI (its arguments translate into RCI terms yet open toward SI).
- **Weak at:** pinning down the **exact causal mechanism** (the price of being eclectic); and it leans so heavily on **induction** (digging through the historical record) that it's been **slow to build systematic, generalisable theory**.
- **Exemplars:** Immergut (health-care reform), Steinmo (tax), Hattam (US labour), Skocpol (welfare states & state capacity), Thelen (how institutions evolve). (*The school Bussemeyer & Thelen exemplify — see below.*)

Sociological Institutionalism (SI) — culture & legitimacy

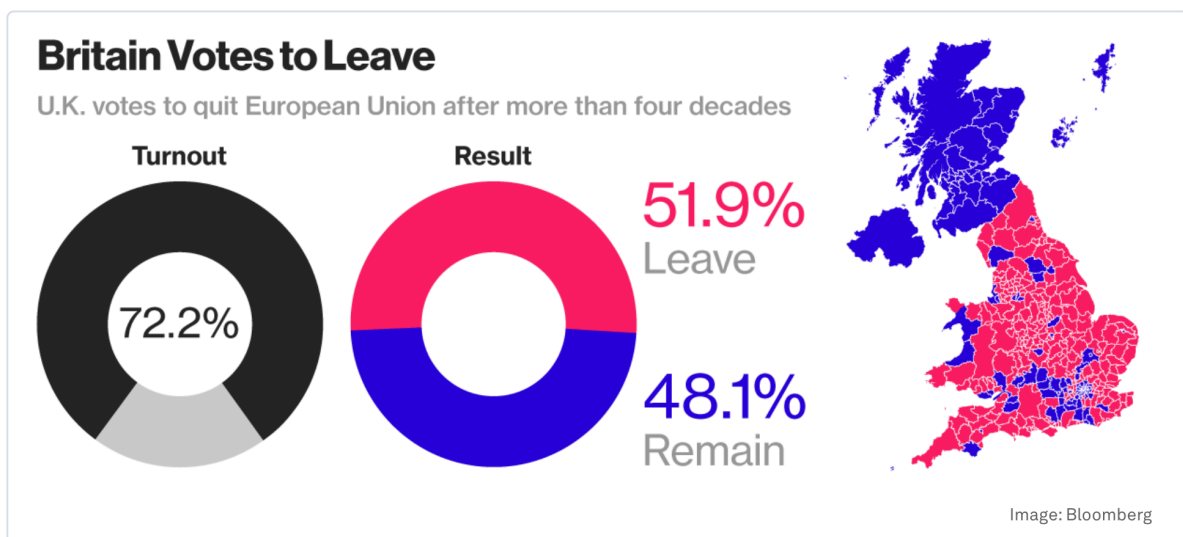
Core: institutions are **cultural frames of meaning** — the scripts, symbols and "done things" of social life — that shape not just what actors *do* but **who they think they are and what they want**; organisations adopt practices to look **legitimate**, not to be efficient.

- **In plain terms:** we do most things because they're "**the normal, proper way**," not because we've calculated they pay off. Institutions *are* culture — they hand us the mental **scripts** for what's even thinkable, and organisations copy the **respectable** forms to fit in, **even when those forms don't actually work well**.
- **Where it came from:** **organization theory** in sociology (late 1970s). It challenged the Weberian assumption that organisations look alike because that's the **most efficient** design. Its counter-claim: the striking sameness across firms, schools and ministries is **culturally transmitted** — forms spread like "myths and ceremonies," adopted because they're **legitimate**, not because they're efficient.
- **Its three features:**

1. A very broad definition of "institution." Not just rules and norms, but **symbol systems, cognitive scripts and moral templates** — the **"frames of meaning"** that guide action. This **dissolves the line between "institutions" and "culture"** (the *cognitive turn*: culture is a web of scripts and templates, not just warm attitudes/values).
 2. **How institutions shape action — the cognitive view.** They supply the scripts and categories you need to **interpret the world at all**; they specify not just what you *should* do but **what you can even imagine doing**. So institutions shape actors' **identities and preferences themselves** — not just constrain pre-set preferences. People act by a **"logic of appropriateness"** (in plain terms: asking "what fits my role / what's the done thing here?" rather than "what's my biggest payoff?"). Even what counts as "rational" is **socially defined** — people act to **express who they are appropriately**, not only to grab material gain.
 3. **Origins & change = legitimacy, not efficiency.** An organisation adopts a practice because it's **valued in the wider culture** and makes the organisation look legitimate — **even if the practice is dysfunctional** for its real goals (Campbell: a *logic of appropriateness* vs a *logic of instrumentality*). *Where legitimacy comes from:* the **regulatory state** (by fiat), **professions** (professional standards), **discussion networks/forums** (shared "cognitive maps" of best practice), and transnational ideas of **"modernity"/"development."** (Fligstein: *firms diversified because it became the valued thing in managers' professional circles*; Soysal: *immigration policy followed international human-rights norms of what's appropriate, not what was functional.*)
- **Isomorphism** (in plain terms: organisations in the same field **coming to look identical** — same forms, procedures, symbols — by copying the legitimate template "regardless of local conditions").
 - **Why institutions persist — taken-for-granted.** They're so obvious no one questions them, and **no single person can change a collective convention** on their own.
 - **Best at:** meaning, legitimacy, identity — and the **inefficiencies RCI can't explain** (the classic point: you still **stop at a red light with no one around** — hardly a payoff-maximising move). It even explains where RCI's "given" preferences *come from*.
 - **Weak at: power & agency** — critics call it "curiously bloodless"; it can miss the **power struggles** in institutional change and end up looking like **"action without agents."**
 - **Exemplars:** Meyer & Rowan ("myth & ceremony"), DiMaggio & Powell (isomorphism / the "organizational field"), March & Olsen (*logic of appropriateness*), Dobbin, Fligstein, Soysal.

Change vs continuity — each school's answer (AUW's deck; the Brexit test)

Core: take one outcome (e.g. Brexit) and give **three competing explanations** — one per school.



How to read it (the Brexit outcome the three schools explain). The 2016 referendum: **72.2% turnout, 51.9% Leave vs 48.1% Remain** — razor-thin — with the district map showing a **geographic split** (Scotland, London & N. Ireland Remain-blue; most of England & Wales Leave-pink). This single result is the *explanandum*: **RCI** reads it as actors' cost–benefit calculus and interests, **HI** as path dependence hitting a critical juncture, **SI** as a clash of identities/paradigms — same fact, three lenses.

School	Explains CHANGE by...	Explains CONTINUITY by...
RCI	disrupted equilibrium; actors' interests (utility-max, cost–benefit); strategic action; few veto players (or in agreement)	policy equilibrium ; many veto players (or in disagreement)
HI	critical junctures ; <u>unintended consequences</u> ; powerful agenda-setters ; institutional inertia	<u>path dependence</u> ; policy lock-in ; institutional power vested in key actors
SI	societal shifts (materialism→post-materialism); a new economic paradigm (Keynesianism→neoliberalism); IR shift (multilateral→unilateral)	deep taken-for-granted structures; national identities ; nested power structures

★ Worked example — the three schools explain **Brexit**

Core: the exam move is to take **one outcome** and give **three competing explanations**. None is "the" answer — each spotlights a different driver, and they're strongest *combined*. Each school's Brexit account, developed:

① **RCI — Brexit as strategic actors pursuing interests.** Institutions are rules that structure the strategic game; the outcome is the aggregate of **cost–benefit calculations** by utility-maximisers.

- **Elite gamble:** Cameron called the 2016 referendum as a *rational* move to manage his own party — buy off Eurosceptic backbenchers and kill the **UKIP** threat — **expecting Remain to win**. A calculated bet (that misfired: unintended consequence, but the *decision* was strategic). Leave elites (**Johnson, Gove**) likewise made career-maximising bets.
- **Voters as calculators:** those who read themselves as **economic losers** from EU membership/immigration (job & wage competition, strained services) found Leave in their interest; **winners** (London finance, exporters reliant on the single market, the highly educated) voted Remain.
- **Rules of the game:** a **binary referendum stripped out the usual veto players** (parliament's equilibrium was bypassed), so a bare 51.9% majority could flip policy.
- *Blind spot:* takes preferences as **given** — it can't say *why* so many Britons wanted "out."

② **HI — Brexit as a critical juncture releasing a path-dependent tension.** Institutions distribute power and **lock in paths**; big change needs a **critical juncture**.

- **Path dependence:** Britain was always the "*awkward partner*" — it **stayed out of the founding EEC (1957)**, joined **late (1973)**, then negotiated **opt-outs** (no euro, no Schengen, the budget rebate). Forty years of *half-in* membership + a sovereign **Westminster** tradition jealous of pooled sovereignty + a Eurosceptic press kept **exit latent** on the path.
- **Critical juncture + timing:** the referendum landed at a specific conjuncture — **post-2008 austerity** and the **2015 refugee crisis** — that gave Leave its opening; Cameron's **2015 election pledge** (itself an unintended consequence of earlier intra-party moves) set the branching point.
- *Blind spot:* strong on *why Britain / why now*, weak on the **precise decision mechanism** on the day.

③ **SI — Brexit as a clash of identity frames.** Institutions are **cultural frames of meaning** that constitute identities; people act by the logic of appropriateness, and change = a shift in the taken-for-granted paradigm.

- **Identity, not calculation:** Leave mobilised a **national-sovereignty identity** ("take back control") against a cosmopolitan, pro-European one — the deep split was **older/less-educated/"left-behind" towns vs younger/urban/university-educated**. Voting Leave *expressed who people felt they were*.
- **Cultural backlash / values shift** (Norris & Inglehart): a **materialist→post-materialist** realignment in which **cultural identity trumped economic interest** — for a certain British self-understanding, being governed from Brussels simply wasn't "appropriate" to *being British*.
- **Blind spot:** strong on **meaning/identity**, weak on **power and strategic agency** (who engineered the vote).

Putting them together (cross-fertilisation). They're complementary: **HI** explains *why Britain and why 2016* (the path + juncture), **SI** explains *why the identity cleavage existed to be mobilised*, and **RCI** explains *why Cameron gambled and how interests aggregated into 51.9%*. That's the model answer — locate each on the structure⇌agency spectrum (SI most structural → RCI most agency) and show how the three combine.

■ Hall & Taylor's conclusion — cross-fertilise

Core: each school reveals a **genuine but partial** dimension of behaviour, so they should **borrow from each other** rather than stay in isolation.

- Who does what: **RCI** = precision & persistence (weak on motivation/change); **HI** = power & history (weak on mechanism); **SI** = meaning & legitimacy (weak on power/agency). HI is the **bridge** — its arguments translate into RCI terms yet open toward SI (actors pick institutions strategically, but "from a menu made historically available").
- **Emerging syntheses they cite:** **Kreps** (corporate culture as an efficient supplement to monitoring); **Garrett & Weingast** (norms/ideas as "**focal points**" that select among multiple equilibria); **Scharpf** ("decision rules" [incentives] + "decision styles" [beliefs about appropriate behaviour]); **Bates & Weingast** (strategic interaction as **signalling games** needing cultural context). (*Caveat: they don't claim a full synthesis is yet possible — "there is much to be said for tenacious debate."*)

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Institution vs organization	Rules/norms that constrain actors vs groups of actors
Calculus vs cultural approach	Strategic maximising vs interpretation-by-worldview
RCI / HI / SI	Rational-choice / historical / sociological institutionalism
Nash equilibrium	Why institutions persist for RCI (deviation costs you)
Collective-action dilemma	Individually rational, collectively bad (RCI's image of politics)
Path dependence	Past choices lock development onto costly-to-reverse paths (HI)
Critical juncture / branching point	Crisis moment when big institutional change sets a new path (HI)
Unintended consequences	Ubiquitous — why you "can't deduce origins from consequences"
Mobilization of bias	Institutions distribute power unevenly (HI)
Logic of appropriateness	Act on what's socially appropriate, not calculation (SI)
Isomorphism	Organizations in a field converge on the same form (SI)
Frames of meaning	Symbol systems/scripts that constitute action (SI's institutions)

Exam pointers

- Reproduce the RCI/HI/SI comparison table — the exam's whole point (Ayca's table).
- Nail **institution** ≠ **organization** and the **widening definition** (RCI rules → SI frames of meaning).
- Use the calculus vs cultural distinction to explain *how* each school links institutions to behaviour.
- Run the change-vs-continuity table on one outcome — see the worked Brexit example: three competing explanations (RCI strategic gamble/interests • HI critical juncture/path dependence • SI identity-frame clash), then combine them.
- Know each school's **signature critique** (RCI thin motivation • HI vague mechanism • SI bloodless/no power).

Busemeyer & Thelen (2020) — Institutional Sources of Business Power (*an HI example*)

Chapter résumé

An exemplary **Historical-Institutionalist study**: where does **business power** come from? The standard split is **structural** power (business's privileged position as investor — the exit/investment threat) vs **instrumental** power (lobbying, donations). Busemeyer & Thelen add a third, **institutional business power** — power that "results when state actors **delegate public functions to private business actors**" and, "over time, through **policy feedback and lock-in effects**," produces an **asymmetrical dependence of the state on business**. They prove it in **education/skill formation** (a "quintessentially public" area where you'd *least* expect business power) across **Germany, Sweden, and the USA**.

★ **The heart of the reading:** business power isn't a fixed feature of capitalism — it's **built by institutions over time**. Once the state hands parts of a public service to private actors, **policy feedback** + **lock-in** make the state **dependent** on them and the change **near-impossible to reverse**. This is *classic HI*: **power asymmetries compounding through path dependence**.

Section-by-section main points

The argument — a third kind of business power

Core: to structural + instrumental power, add **institutional business power** — endogenous to **past policy-design choices**, not a generic feature of capitalism.

- **Three types:** **structural** (investor's exit threat — Lindblom) • **instrumental** (lobbying/donations) • **institutional** (entrenched role in delivering a **public function**). They act as "**communicating vessels**."
- **Two conditions** set how strong institutional power is: **(1) the credibility of business's exit threat** and **(2) the depth of state dependence** (has the state lost the capacity to provide the service itself?). Both high → power strongest.
- Once entrenched, institutional power grants business insider "**quiet politics**" access (Culpepper) — so it needs far less *overt* lobbying. The three cases are deliberately "**most different**" (Esping-Andersen's three welfare worlds × Hall & Soskice's *varieties of capitalism*) to show a **common dynamic despite maximally different systems**.

Three mechanisms → three countries

Core: the *same* dynamic (state shares a public function → feedback entrenches business → lock-in) plays out three ways across maximally different systems.

Country	Mechanism	What happened
Germany	Delegation	state consciously shares regulatory space with employers (dual apprenticeship training)
Sweden	Deregulation	state retreats from provision (school vouchers / for-profit "free schools")
USA	Accretion	private actors <i>invite themselves in</i> (venture philanthropy, charter schools)

- **Germany — Delegation (dual vocational training).** Firm-based apprenticeships rest on **employer voluntarism** (~500,000 youths/year, ≈ the number entering university). **Highest** institutional power: both state dependence *and* exit threat are high. Twice (**1970s; red-green 1998**) governments floated a statist **training levy** + school-based alternative; both times employers threatened to cut training places and the government **backed down** — and by the 2000s **unions & Social Democrats had reversed** to defending firm-based training (preference **conversion via feedback**). → *Delegation + lock-in + preference change = HI*.
- **Sweden — Deregulation (school vouchers).** Early-1990s reforms broke a near-total **public monopoly**; public money now funds private "independent" schools. By 2014 **ten corporations held 30% of the market** (biggest: AcadeMedia, owned by VC firm EQT); ~85% of voucher schools are **for-profit** — a "welfare-industrial complex." The **2016 Reepalu** profit-cap proposal died after providers threatened to shut down; Reepalu himself: "*we'd be in an easier situation if this had been introduced twenty years ago*" (**lock-in spoken aloud**). → *Deregulation + self-reinforcing feedback (even unions flipped pro-privatisation)*.
- **USA — Accretion (venture philanthropy & charters).** Wealthy donors (**Gates, Broad, Walton**) "invite themselves" into education, funding charter schools/CMOs. **High exit threat, lower state dependence**

(private funds *supplement*). Charters $\approx$ 6% of US enrolment but **$\sim$ 95% in post-Katrina New Orleans**; **Gates ranked the most influential individual in US education policy — ahead of the Secretary of Education**. In the 2014 de Blasio vs **Eva Moskowitz** fight, Walton-funded groups bused parents to Albany and Gov. Cuomo vowed "We will save charter schools!" $\rightarrow$ *Accretion — instrumental power converting into entrenched institutional power*.

Why it's HI — and how RCI/SI would differ

- **HI hallmarks:** power runs through the whole study (asymmetric state $\leftrightarrow$ business dependence tilting "over time"); **historical legacies** (each country a longitudinal narrative); **path dependence & lock-in** ("reclaiming lost territory becomes more difficult over time"); **policy feedback**; **critical junctures** (German 1982 government change; **Hurricane Katrina** enabling New Orleans's charterisation).
- **RCI would say:** business power = a credible **exit/holdup threat** in a principal-agent game; delegation persists because it's **efficient** (lowers state costs) — but static RCI misses the *temporal tilt* and the change in actors' preferences.
- **SI would say:** private provision spreads because it becomes **legitimate/taken-for-granted** (Germans see employer involvement as "an asset"; Swedes internalise "free choice"; Gates's role "taken for granted") — an NPM/"choice" **template diffusing** (isomorphism) — but SI under-weights the raw **power** the authors foreground.

Exam pointers

- Use this as your **worked HI example**: name the mechanism per country (**Delegation/Germany** • **Deregulation/Sweden** • **Accretion/US**) and show **power + path dependence + lock-in**.
- Define **institutional business power** vs structural vs instrumental, and its **two conditions** (exit threat + state dependence).
- Be ready to **re-explain the same outcome in RCI and SI terms** (Ayca's exercise).

Informal institutions (*AUW coda*)

Core: informal institutions = the "informal rules of the game" — "*socially shared rules, usually unwritten, created, communicated and enforced outside officially sanctioned channels*." They can matter as much as formal ones (esp. in weak states) — and are **not necessarily undemocratic**.

- **Examples:** *dedazo* ("big finger", Mexico — the outgoing PRI president secretly picks his successor) • *amakudari* ("descent from heaven", Japan — retired bureaucrats get corporate jobs) • **clientelism** (Peronist Argentina). *Not* undemocratic: the **folkways of the US Senate** (Matthews 1959 — apprenticeship, courtesy, reciprocity, specialisation); pre-Erdoğan Turkish university-rector elections.

★ Fun facts & memorable details

Sticky bits from Lecture 6 (institutions & institutionalisms).

Quotable

- The framing line: "*political science today is confronted with not one but three 'new institutionalisms.'*"
- **SI's best point** (why we're not just calculators): "*anyone who has waited at a traffic light when no one else was around*" has to admit institutions work non-instrumentally too.
- **RCI's key logical error** (Hall & Taylor): "*one cannot safely deduce origins from consequences*" — because unintended consequences are everywhere.
- SI critique in three words: "*action without agents.*"
- **Reepalu (Sweden)**: "*We'd be in a somewhat easier situation if much of what we're proposing had been introduced some twenty years ago*" — path dependence, out loud.
- **Cuomo (US)**: "*We will save charter schools!*"

Memorable

- The three schools "developed **quite independently of each other**," each "assiduously burnishing its own paradigm" — a paper about theories that ignored each other.
- **Germany**: ~500,000 start firm-based apprenticeships each year — about the same as start university.
- **New Orleans** after Katrina: ~95% of children in charter schools — the highest of any US city.
- **Bill Gates** was ranked the **single most influential individual in US education policy** — ahead of the **Secretary of Education** (who, at the time, was herself a venture philanthropist).
- **Institution ≠ organization**: the Social Democratic *Party* is the organization; the rules and unwritten norms governing it are the *institutions* — the distinction the whole lecture turns on.

PART II · INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

IR I: Realism (AUW)

Required reading: PG = Goldstein & Pevehouse, *International Relations* — **ch. 1** (*The Globalization of International Relations*) + **ch. 2** (*Realist Theories*). • Lecturer: Ayça Uygur Wessel.

Theme of the lecture: first, *what is International Relations* and why we need **theories** to explain it (the field, key actors, **sovereignty**, levels of analysis, the collective-goods problem). Then the field's oldest and most influential theory: **realism** — how, in a world with no world government, states end up in **competition** for **power** and **security**.

★ **The heart of the lecture:** a theory is *an explanation of patterns* in world politics (what happened → **why**). Realism's answer runs in one chain: because the international system is **anarchic** (no sovereign above states), states can't trust each other, so they must **self-help**, which means watching **relative power** — and that breeds **competition**, alliances, and war. States are treated as **unitary, rational actors** pursuing the **national interest defined as power**. *Realism isn't "war is good" — it's "given anarchy, this is the logic states are trapped in."*

The red thread. Everything hangs on one word: **anarchy** — *not chaos*, just "**no world police**." Ask of any event: *how does the absence of an enforcer above states drive this?* Trust becomes risky → survival can't be outsourced → power (especially **material/military**) is the currency → and because one state's gain can shift the balance, even **cooperation** is viewed through the lens of **relative advantage**.

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Theory** (explains patterns) · levels of analysis (individual / domestic / interstate / global).
 - Collective-goods problem & its three solutions: **dominance** · **reciprocity** · **identity**.
 - **State** · **sovereignty** · **anarchy** · **non-state actors** (IGOs, NGOs, MNCs).
 - **Realism** — unitary + rational actor; national interest = **power**; classical vs structural vs offensive vs neoclassical.
 - Self-help · **power** (capability vs influence; hard/soft) · relative vs absolute gains · security dilemma.
 - Balance of power · **balancing** (internal/external) · **polarity** (uni/bi/multi) · **hegemony** & hegemonic stability.
 - **Alliances** (NATO) · **deterrence/compellence** · the Prisoner's Dilemma.
-

A. Introducing International Relations (PG ch. 1 — the set-up)

| What IR is — and why we need theory

Core: IR = the relationships among the world's governments, tangled up with other actors (UN, corporations, individuals), other relationships (economics, culture), and history/geography. We need **theories** because facts don't explain themselves — a theory turns "*what happened*" into "*why*."

- *In plain terms:* a theory is a **pair of glasses**. Realism and liberalism look at the *same* events (a war, an alliance, a trade deal) and each highlights different causes. A good theory gives you **clear assumptions** (e.g. realism assumes states are **rational**) and a **shared vocabulary**.
- IR is a **subfield of political science**; its two big halves are **international security** (war & peace) and **international political economy (IPE)** (trade, money, North–South relations).

| The collective-goods problem — the core puzzle of IR

Core: how can a group (of states) serve its **collective interest** when each member is tempted to put its **own** interest first? Everyone benefits from a **collective good** (clean climate, a strong alliance) *whether or not they help pay* — so each is tempted to **free-ride**, and if too many do, the good collapses.

- *In plain terms:* it's the **group-project problem** at world scale — everyone wants the good grade, nobody wants to do the work. Domestically a **government** forces contributions (taxes); internationally there's **no world government**, so the problem is especially hard.
- **Three ways to solve it** (recurring across the whole course):

Solution	How it works	In plain terms	Upside / Downside
Dominance	a power hierarchy imposes order top-down (a "government without a government")	<i>someone's the boss — obey those above you</i>	order & stability / oppression & resentment
Reciprocity	tit-for-tat — reward cooperation, punish cheating	<i>I'll help you if you help me; I'll hit back if you cheat</i>	robust, <u>self-enforcing</u> / downward spirals, hard accounting
Identity	a shared sense of "we" makes members sacrifice for the group	<i>we're family, so I give without keeping score</i>	deep cooperation / can demonise an out-group

Examples: nuclear non-proliferation runs on all three — **dominance** (the UNSC "big five" keep the bomb), **reciprocity** (the NPT bargain: you stay non-nuclear, we disarm), **identity** (Sweden/Japan chose *not* to build one). **Realism is built on the *dominance* principle.**

Actors — states and non-state actors

Core: the lead actors are **states** — a **state** = "an inhabited territory controlled by a government that exercises **sovereignty**." But the stage is crowded with **non-state (transnational) actors**.

- **State** = territory + government + **sovereignty** (answers to no higher authority) + **recognition** by others.
Careful: *state* ≠ *nation* (a shared identity) ≠ *country*. A **nation-state** is one where the population shares a national identity — the modern state system is only ~500 years old (before: empires, city-states, fiefs).
- **Non-state actors** (Table 1.2):

Type	Members are...	Examples
IGOs (intergovernmental orgs)	national governments	UN, NATO, WTO, EU
NGOs (non-governmental orgs)	individuals & groups	Amnesty, Red Cross, Greenpeace
MNCs (multinational corporations)	firms across borders	ExxonMobil, Toyota, Walmart
Others	individuals, cities, networks	Bono, al-Qaeda, Iraqi Kurdistan

(There are >50,000 NGOs and ~5,000 IGOs; there were 193 UN members in 2018.)

Sovereignty & anarchy

Core: **sovereignty** = a state's right to do as it likes **inside** its own borders (the **norm of non-interference**), and it's the flip side of **anarchy** — "not chaos, but the lack of a central government that can enforce rules."

- **In plain terms: anarchy** = "**no world police**." No one stands above states to force them to keep promises or protect them — so, realists say, each must ultimately **look after itself** and watch others' **capabilities, not their intentions**.
- **Territorial integrity** (respect borders) and **diplomatic norms** (an embassy = home soil) are strong shared **norms** — the system is far from chaotic even without a ruler.

Levels of analysis — the "zoom level" of an explanation

Core: a **level of analysis** is the *scale* at which you look for causes. The same "why" question can be answered at several levels at once — none is *the* correct one.

Level	You explain events by...	In plain terms	Example causes
Individual	particular people's choices/psychology	<i>the person</i>	great/"crazy" leaders, crisis decisions, assassinations
Domestic	groups <i>inside</i> a state	<i>the country's insides</i>	democracy vs dictatorship, public opinion, ethnic conflict, bureaucracies
Interstate / systemic	states interacting; the distribution of power	<i>states vs states</i>	<u>balance of power</u> , alliances, polarity, trade
Global	worldwide forces	<i>the whole planet</i>	technology, the environment, the legacy of imperialism

Tip: higher levels change **more slowly** (individuals rotate through office often; the system's structure rarely shifts). **Realism lives mostly at the interstate/systemic level.**

B. Realism — the main theory (PG ch. 2 + the deck)

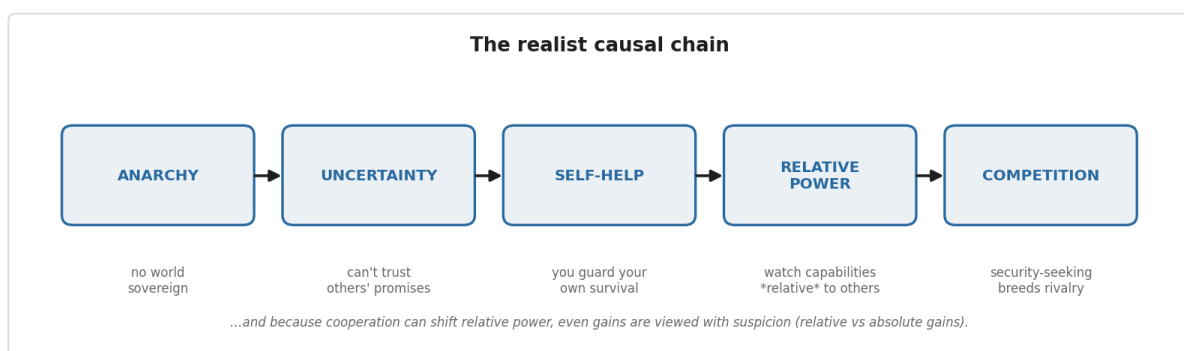
What realism is — its assumptions

Core: realism = "a broad tradition that explains IR mainly in terms of **power**." It's a **family** of theories, not one theory, but they share a few assumptions.

- **The core assumptions:** ① states are the key actors; ② each is a **unitary** actor (speaks with one voice — domestic politics is a "black box"); ③ each is a **rational** actor (defines its interests and picks the option that maximises them); ④ the system is **anarchic**; ⑤ **power politics** trumps morality, ideology and economics.
- **Rational ≠ good or moral.** A rational choice is just the best cost–benefit bet given the incentives. *If a state calculates the expected costs of not fighting exceed those of fighting, war can be rational.*
- **Realism vs idealism/liberalism:** where idealists see human nature as basically good and the system as a *community* that can cooperate, realists see it as **selfish** and the system as **anarchy** — and accuse idealists of studying the world as it *ought* to be, not as it is.
- **The lineage:** Thucydides ("the strong do what they can, the weak suffer what they must") • Machiavelli (expedient power) • Hobbes (the anarchic "state of nature" — cf. Hobbes in PET Module 2) • Morgenthau (modern classical realism: national interest defined as power).

★ The realist causal chain — the argument in one line

Core: this is the spine of the whole lecture. **Anarchy → uncertainty → self-help → attention to relative power → competition.**



How to read it (the causal chain). Walk it one link at a time: **anarchy** (no world sovereign) means a state **can't trust** others to keep promises → **uncertainty**; if no one guarantees your survival you must **self-help** (arm, ally); **self-help** means constantly judging your **capabilities relative to others**; and everyone doing this at once produces **competition**. *A worked link (deck):* "Anarchy creates uncertainty because a state can't trust another to keep its word — e.g. **Denmark-US** under Trump's Greenland threats, which pushed DK to boost conscription and Nordic military ties even though both are NATO allies."

- **Self-help** ≠ 'never cooperate'. States *do* cooperate — but always with one eye on how the deal shifts the balance.

Power — the currency of realism

Core: power = "the ability to influence others' behaviour." For realists it's mostly **material / hard power** (Lukes' 1st face — see PS Lecture 1), and it's **relational**: *how capable am I relative to you?*

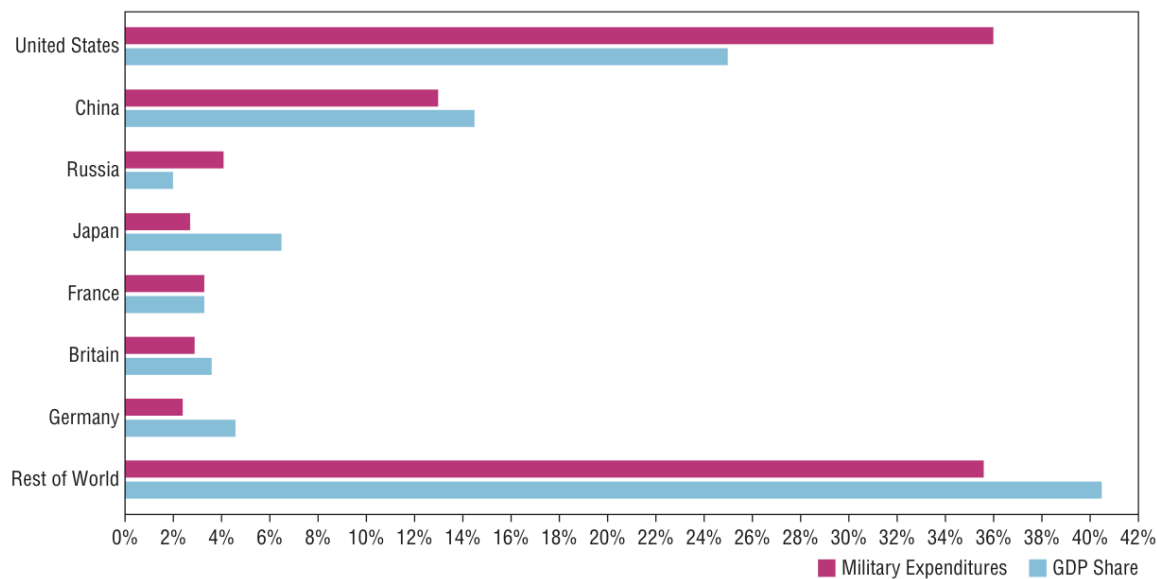
- **Two ways to think about power:**
 - **Power as influence** = getting another to do what it *wouldn't otherwise* do (but this is circular — we rarely know the "otherwise").
 - **Power as capability** = the *resources* behind influence — easier to measure. **Best single yardstick** = **total GDP** (bundles size, wealth, technology).
- ★ **Elements of power (capabilities) — the sub-concepts.** Power-as-capability is a **bundle of resources**, and the textbook sorts them two ways: by **time horizon** (long- vs short-term) and by **tangibility** (material vs non-material).

Time horizon	Tangible (material)	Intangible (non-material)
Long-term — change slowly; who <i>will</i> be powerful	total GDP · population · territory · geography · natural resources	political culture · patriotism · education of the population · science/technology base · credibility / reputation (keeping its word) · power of ideas / soft power
Short-term — influence <i>now</i>	military forces (size, composition, preparedness — the realist's #1) · military-industrial capacity (make weapons fast) · quality of the bureaucracy	legitimacy & support from constituents/allies · loyalty of the army & politicians to the leader

- **Best single yardstick** = **total GDP** (bundles size + wealth + technology) — but only a *rough* estimator.
- **Fungibility** = how far one element **converts into** another. **Money is the most fungible** (it buys the rest); realists treat **military force** as the most important short-term element and rate the others by how fungible they are **into** military power.
- **Geopolitics** = using **geography** as power — "*location, location, location*": bases near a rival, control of **trade routes & key resources** (oil pipelines in Central Asia; new **Arctic** shipping routes as the ice melts).
- ★ **Long-term beats short-term (worked example): Pearl Harbor (1941)** — Japan had the short-term **military** edge and overran the Pacific, but the US's greater **long-term** power resources (economic potential) let it build up and **overwhelm** Japan. (*Capabilities aren't just what you have now, but what you can generate.*)
- ★ **Relative vs absolute gains (the exam favourite).** A liberal asks "*do I gain?*" (**absolute**). A realist asks "*do I gain more than my rival?*" (**relative**) — because today's cooperation can fund tomorrow's threat. (*Deck exercise: if a deal gives you +10 but your rival +20, a realist may refuse — the rival's larger gain shifts the future balance.*) Examples: US-USSR nuclear parity; US-China tech race.

Figure 2.3 Great Power Shares of World GDP, 2017, and Military Expenditures, 2016

Data Sources: World Bank Development Indicators, 2017; SIPRI Yearbook, 2016.



How to read it (great-power capabilities). Two bars per country — **GDP share** (blue) and **military-spending share** (magenta). The realist reads it as the **distribution of material power**: the **US** leads on *both*, **China** is a clear second, and the other five trail — a snapshot of who can bring what to bear. (This is "power as capability" made concrete.)

The security dilemma — why arming backfires

Core: security dilemma = when a state arms to feel safer, it makes others feel *less* safe, so they arm too — and everyone ends up less secure. A direct product of anarchy, and the engine of **arms races**.

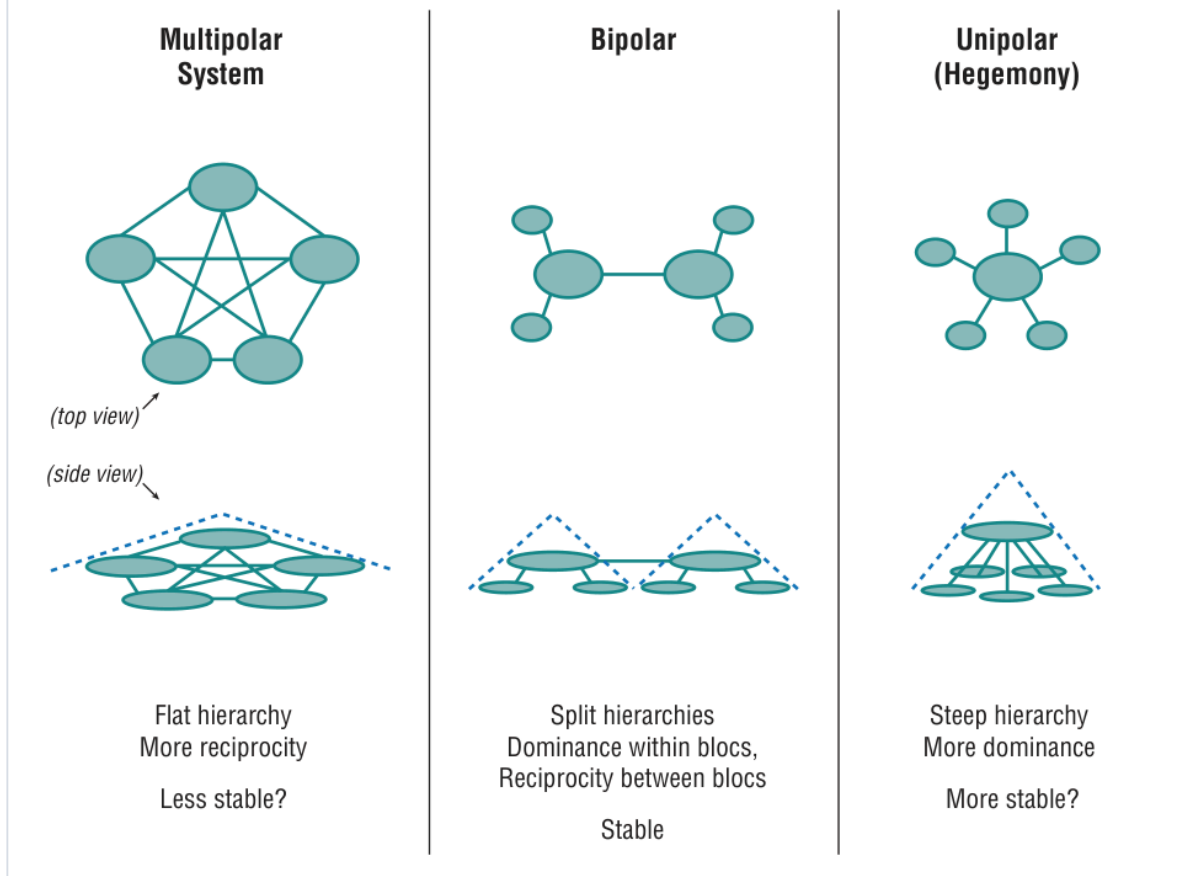
- *In plain terms*: you buy a gun for self-defence; your neighbour sees it, feels threatened, buys two; now you're both more armed and **no safer**. Realists think it's **unsolvable** under anarchy; liberals think institutions can ease it.

Balance of power, balancing & polarity

Core: balance of power = a distribution in which **no single state can dominate** — because when power concentrates, others have an incentive to **counter** it. It can be an **outcome**, a **process** (balancing), or a **strategy**.

- **How states balance: internal balancing** (build up *your own* capabilities) vs **external balancing** (form alliances). A **balancer** throws its weight against whoever is strongest (Britain in Europe for centuries).
- **Balancing vs bandwagoning**: instead of balancing the strongest, small states sometimes **jump on the bandwagon** of the winner (after WWII most joined the US bloc rather than balancing it) — and states often **balance threats**, not raw power (US power was greater but less threatening than the USSR's).
- **Polarity** = how many "poles" (great-power centres) the system has — and structure shapes the choices available to states:

Figure 2.4 Power Distribution in the International System



How to read it (polarity). **Multipolar** (5–6 independent powers): a *flat* hierarchy of shifting alliances — the classic balance of power, but war-prone. **Bipolar** (two blocs, e.g. Cold War): dominance *within* each bloc, reciprocity *between* them — often judged **stable**. **Unipolar / hegemony** (one dominant state): the *steepest* hierarchy. Empirically the book reports peace is best preserved by **hegemony**, next by **bipolarity** — *not* by multipolar equality. (Link: **power-transition theory** says the biggest wars come when a **rising** power threatens to overtake the top state — the "Thucydides Trap," e.g. US–China.)

Hegemony & hegemonic stability

Core: a **hegemon** holds such a **preponderance of power** that it can **single-handedly set the rules** of the system (Britain in the 1800s; the US after 1945). **Hegemonic stability theory:** the system is most orderly when power is most **concentrated** — the hegemon supplies order like a stand-in government (detering aggression, underwriting free trade, providing a reserve currency).

- *Why would the strongest enforce rules that help everyone?* Because as the **biggest trader/producer** it gains most from an open, stable system it dominates. (Downside: weaker states may see hegemony as **infringing their sovereignty** — China uses "hegemony" as an insult.)

The realism family — four versions

Core: realism is a **family**; the versions differ on *where* the drive for power comes from and *how much* domestic politics matters.

Version	Key theorist	Where the power-drive comes from	States are...
Classical	Morgenthau (1948)	human nature + ambition; a timeless "struggle for power"	interest-maximisers
Structural / Neorealism	Waltz (1979)	the anarchic structure itself forces <u>self-help</u> (not human nature)	—
Defensive (structural)	Waltz	enough power to be safe	security maximisers → <u>balance of power</u> forms
Offensive (structural)	Mearsheimer (2001)	<i>more</i> is always safer → seek to dominate	power maximisers , never satisfied with the BoP
Neoclassical	Zakaria, Rose (1998)	structure + domestic factors (leaders, perceptions, state–society relations) as an intervening variable	—

In plain terms: **classical** = "it's in our nature"; **structural** = "it's the situation (anarchy), not our nature"; **defensive** = "grab enough to be safe"; **offensive** = "the only safe amount is *all* of it"; **neoclassical** = "structure pushes, but domestic politics filters the push."

- ★ **Offensive realism up close** — "**the best defence is offence**" (**Mearsheimer**). This is the concept behind "*you attack in order to defend yourself*." It chains straight off **capabilities**: (1) under **anarchy** you can never be **sure** of another state's **intentions** — they can hide them, and they can change overnight — so you must judge others by their **capabilities** (the realist maxim "watch capabilities, not intentions"); (2) but *any* state with the **capability** to hurt you is a **potential** threat; (3) so the *only* way to be **certain** you're safe is to be **more powerful than everyone else**. Hence offensive realists say states are **power maximisers** who **expand** — and **will strike first (pre-emption)** — not out of greed but as the *safest* route to survival. **Defensive** realists reply that grabbing *too much* power backfires: it triggers **balancing** by others (and feeds the **security dilemma**), so the smart move is **enough** security, not domination. (*That debate — is more power always safer, or does over-reach make you less safe? — is the whole offensive-vs-defensive-realism split.*)

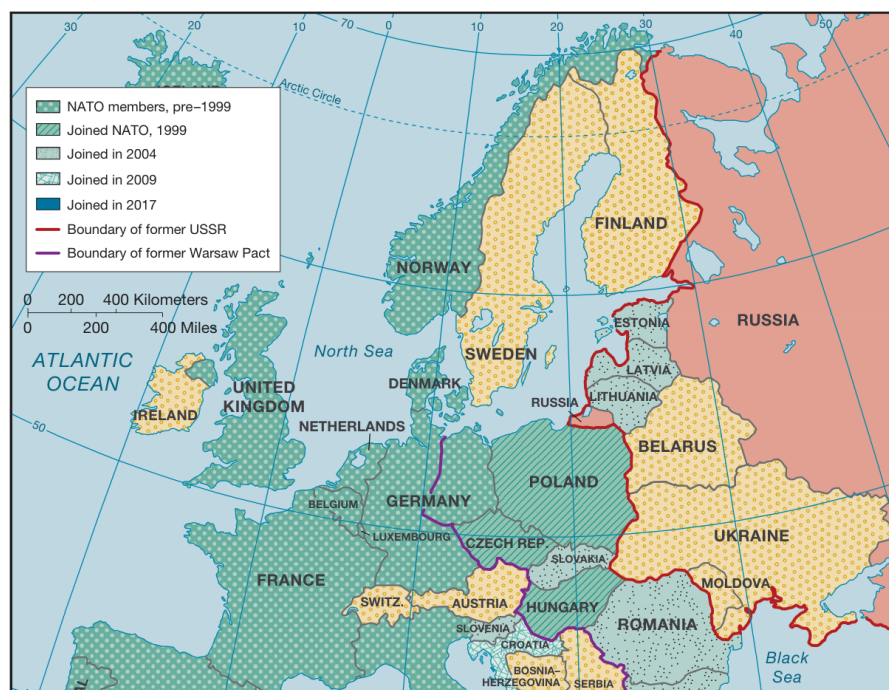
Alliances & NATO

Core: an **alliance** = a coalition of states coordinating (usually by treaty) against a **common threat**. Realists stress **fluidity** — alliances are "*marriages of convenience, not love*," made and broken on **national interest** (Palmerston: "*no eternal allies... only perpetual interests*"). No element of power shifts as **fast** as an alliance.

- NATO** (1949) = a US-led alliance built to **deter the USSR**; its Cold War rival was the **Warsaw Pact**. Its collective-defence heart, **Article V**, was first invoked *after 9/11* — **Europe defending the US**, the reverse of its original design. Post-Cold-War it **expanded east**:

Figure 2.7 NATO Expansion

Sources: U.S. Department of Defense.



How to read it (NATO expansion). The shading shows NATO creeping **eastward** toward Russia in waves (Poland/Czech/Hungary 1999 → the Baltics + others 2004 → ...). Realists read this as classic **security-dilemma** material: the West sees it as **securing democracies**; Russia sees encroachment on its borders — each side's "defensive" move looks **threatening** to the other. (**Burden-sharing** — who pays — is the recurring intra-alliance fight, e.g. Trump vs NATO.)

The Prisoner's Dilemma — why rational states fail to cooperate

Core: the **Prisoner's Dilemma (PD)** models why **rational actors**, each pursuing **self-interest**, all end up **worse off** than if they'd cooperated. It's realism's pessimism in a 2×2 box.

- *The story:* two prisoners are questioned separately. Each reasons "*whatever the other does, I'm better off **confessing** (defecting)*" — so both defect and get long sentences, when **mutual silence** (cooperation) would have been better.

Figure 2.9 Payoff Matrix in India-Pakistan PD Game

		Pakistan	
		Cooperate	Defect
India	Cooperate	(3,3)	(1,4)
	Defect	(4,1)	(2,2)

Note: First number in each group is India's payoff, second is Pakistan's. The number 4 is highest payoff, a 1 lowest.

How to read it (the PD matrix). Each cell = (India's payoff, Pakistan's payoff); 4 = best, 1 = worst. "Cooperate" = don't build the bomb; "Defect" = build it. Read India's logic: *if Pakistan builds (right column), 2 > 1 so India should build; if Pakistan doesn't (left column), 4 > 3 so India should still build. Defecting dominates* — so both build (2, 2), even though **mutual cooperation (3, 3)** is better for both. That's the tragedy: individually rational →

collectively worse. (*Real world: India tested 1998, Pakistan followed within weeks.*) **Deterrence** (threaten punishment so an attack never happens) and **compellence** (force someone to *act*) are the strategies states use to escape or manage it.

■ The cooperation puzzle — the bridge to next lecture

Core: if the system is anarchic, **why is cooperation sometimes deep and durable** (EU, WTO, NATO)?

Realist answer: institutions ultimately just **reflect the interests and power of the strongest states**. **Liberal answer** (next lecture): institutions can **change the incentives** and make cooperation easier.

Cases & examples

- **Denmark–US / Greenland (Trump)** → **anarchy** → **uncertainty**: even between NATO allies, DK couldn't fully trust US respect for its sovereignty → boosted conscription & Nordic defence ties.
- **India–Pakistan nuclear race** → the **Prisoner's Dilemma** in the flesh (both defect → both nuclear, 1998).
- **US–China** → **power-transition** / **relative gains** — a rising power unsettling the top spot; balancing in tech, trade, the South China Sea.
- **Rise of China / balancing** → as China's capabilities grow, *others* balance it (Japan's deals with South Korea & the Philippines) — not everyone balances the US.
- **NATO expansion east** → **security dilemma** (Western "securing democracies" vs Russian "encroachment").
- **Libya 2011** → power-as-capability (NATO's ~300:1 GDP edge) *and* **unintended consequences** (weapons spilling into Mali).
- **Nuclear non-proliferation** → the **three solutions** (dominance/reciprocity/identity) working together.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
International relations (IR)	Relations among governments + their links to other actors/forces
Collective-goods problem	Serving the group interest when members are tempted to free-ride
Dominance / reciprocity / identity	The three ways to get cooperation without a world government
Sovereignty	A state's right to rule inside its own borders (non-interference)
Anarchy	No central authority above states ("no world police") — <i>not</i> chaos
Levels of analysis	The scale of explanation: individual / domestic / interstate / global
Realism	Explains IR mainly through power
Unitary / rational actor	State acts as one voice, maximising its interests (rational ≠ moral)
National interest	The state's overall interest — for realists, defined as power
Self-help	Each state must provide its own security
Power (capability vs influence)	Resources behind influence vs getting others to act differently
Relative vs absolute gains	Do I gain <i>more than my rival</i> vs do I gain at all
Security dilemma	My arming makes you insecure → you arm → both less safe
Balance of power	A distribution where no state can dominate; balancing counters the strong
Polarity	Number of great-power centres: unipolar / bipolar / multipolar
Hegemony	One state preponderant enough to set the system's rules
Alliance / NATO	Coalition vs a common threat; NATO = US-led, anti-Soviet, now expanded
Prisoner's Dilemma	Rational self-interest → both defect → both worse off than cooperating
Deterrence / compellence	Threat to stop an action vs threat to force an action

Exam pointers

- Define **anarchy** correctly (**not chaos** — no enforcer) and run the realist causal chain cold: anarchy → uncertainty → self-help → relative power → competition.
- List realism's **assumptions** (unitary + rational actor, states, anarchy, power > morality) and stress **rational ≠ good** (war can be rational).
- Explain **power as capability vs influence**, and nail relative vs absolute gains (the realist refuses a deal a liberal would take).
- Explain the security dilemma and use NATO expansion as the case.
- Compare polarity types and state the finding that **hegemony/bipolarity** preserve peace better than multipolarity; add **power-transition theory**.
- Place the four realisms (classical/defensive/offensive/neoclassical) and their theorists.
- Work the Prisoner's Dilemma matrix (why *defect* dominates → both worse off) and connect it to arms races & deterrence.

- Use the collective-goods problem + **dominance/reciprocity/identity** to frame *why* cooperation is hard under anarchy.

★ Fun facts & memorable details (IR I: Realism)

Sticky bits from the realism lecture.

- **Thucydides**, ~2,400 years ago: "*the strong do what they have the power to do and the weak accept what they have to accept*" — realism's oldest one-liner.
- **Anarchy ≠ chaos**. It just means **no world police** — the system actually runs on remarkably stable **norms** (an embassy is treated as home soil; borders are respected).
- **Rational ≠ right**: for a realist, if the expected cost of *not* fighting beats the cost of fighting, **war is the rational choice** — morality doesn't enter the calculation.
- **NATO's Article V** (an attack on one is an attack on all) has been invoked **exactly once** — after 9/11, with **Europe** coming to the defence of the **US**, the mirror image of why NATO was built.
- **The relative-gains trap**: a realist may **turn down** a deal that makes them richer (+10) if it makes a rival richer still (+20) — because the *gap* is what shapes tomorrow's balance of power.
- **Peace by inequality**: the book's counterintuitive finding — a lopsided **hegemony** (one dominant power) keeps the peace *better* than a balanced, equal, multipolar world.
- **Bandwagoning beats balancing (sometimes)**: after WWII most states didn't gang up on the US — they **joined** it, puzzling pure balance-of-power theory.
- **Palmerston (1848)**: "*We have no eternal allies and we have no perpetual enemies. Our interests are perpetual*" — the realist view of alliances as marriages of convenience.

IR II: Liberalism (AUW)

Required reading: PG = Goldstein & Pevehouse, *International Relations* — ch. 3, §3.1 (*The Waning of War*) & §3.2 (*Liberal Theories*) + ch. 7 (*International Organizations, Law, and Human Rights*). • Lecturer: Ayça Uygur Wessel.

Theme of the lecture (AUW — deck). Liberalism as the **theoretical response to realism**. Realism explains rivalry, competition, security dilemmas and arms races — *but what about* European integration, IOs, international trade, arms-control agreements, and the democratic peace? **Liberalism's puzzle**: *if the international system is anarchic, why do states cooperate at all — and under what conditions is cooperation more or less likely?*

★ **The heart of the lecture**: liberalism keeps realism's starting point — **states are rational, self-interested actors under anarchy** — but reaches the opposite conclusion: **self-interest does not necessarily produce conflict**. Because some interests **overlap**, cooperation is often the rational choice: **self-interest → mutual benefits → reasoned cooperation → stable cooperation**. Two branches say how: **liberal institutionalism** — *institutions* make cooperation easier (information, reciprocity, monitoring, enforcement, the shadow of the future); and **liberal internationalism** — *domestic politics* shape what states want (the Kantian triangle: democracy + interdependence + IOs). *Liberalism ≠ being nice or naïve — it's "under what conditions is cooperation in states' own interest?"*

The red thread. For any case ask: *cooperation looks impossible under anarchy — so what makes it happen here?* Either the answer is **institutional** (rules/monitoring/reciprocity change the incentives) or it is **domestic** (regime type, interests, public opinion shape state preferences). Both keep the realist assumption of self-interested rational states.

Three things liberalism is NOT (deck). Liberalism in IR $\neq$ **economic liberalism** (free markets) $\neq$ **liberalism in domestic politics** (a left–right ideology). In IR it is a **theory of cooperation under anarchy**.

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The cooperation puzzle** — why cooperate under anarchy? (the question realism can't answer well).
- **Two branches: liberal institutionalism** (Keohane, Nye — international level) vs **liberal internationalism** (Kant — domestic/unit level).
- **Neoliberal institutionalism** — concedes realism's assumptions (unitary, rational, anarchy) but shows cooperation still pays.
- **Reciprocity & the shadow of the future** · **information/monitoring/transparency** · **enforcement** · **issue linkage**.
- **International regime** (Krasner) — "principles, norms, rules, and decision-making procedures around which actor expectations converge." (*An international institution $\neq$ an IO.*)
- **Complex interdependence** (Keohane & Nye) — multiple channels; disruption is costly for both sides (sensitivity vs vulnerability).
- **The Kantian triangle** — democracy + economic interdependence + international organizations.
- **Democratic peace** — democracies almost never fight *each other*.
- **Collective security** · IGOs/NGOs · the UN · international law · **just war** · **human rights** (ch.7).

Section-by-section main points

A. How liberalism sees the world (deck + §3.1–3.2 intro)

Core: liberalism is **more optimistic** than realism about peace and progress, but it is **not** starry-eyed: states are still **rational actors pursuing self-interest** — the liberal twist is that **self-interest often points to cooperation, not conflict**.

- **The chain (deck): self-interest** → **mutual benefits** → **reasoned cooperation** → **stable cooperation**. Cooperation is possible **without** becoming altruistic.
- **Realism vs liberalism on the "rules of IR":** realists see power politics as **timeless**; liberals see the rules as **slowly, incrementally evolving toward peace** — through the buildup of **international organizations + reciprocity** (and secondarily changing **norms/public opinion**). Liberalism draws on the **reciprocity and identity** principles, where realism draws on **dominance**.
- **§3.1 The Waning of War (the empirical backdrop):** contrary to the media impression, this is **one of the least warlike periods ever**. Battle-deaths have fallen sharply since WWII (tens of millions → millions → hundreds of thousands); the **last great-power war ended 60+ years ago**; today's conflicts (Syria, Yemen, Ukraine) are, by historical standards, **small wars**. → *This trend is what liberalism claims to explain and realism struggles to.*

B. The two branches of liberalism (deck)

Core: liberalism gives **two** answers to realism — one at the **international** level, one at the **domestic** level.

	Liberal Institutionalism	Liberal Internationalism
Key names	Keohane & Nye	Kant
Main question	How can states cooperate despite anarchy?	Why do states <i>want</i> different things?
Level of analysis	International (systemic)	Domestic / unit level
Core mechanisms	Information · reciprocity · monitoring · enforcement	Regime type · institutions · interests · public opinion
Simple claim	Institutions make cooperation easier	Domestic politics shape state preferences

(Deck aside: liberal internationalism's focus on the domestic level mirrors what neoclassical realism does on the realist side — both "open up" the state rather than treating it as a black box.)

C. ★ Liberal institutionalism — what makes cooperation possible (§3.2.2 + deck)

Core: neoliberal (institutionalist) thinking says to realists: "Even granting your assumptions — unitary, rational states under anarchy — your pessimism doesn't follow." States cooperate often because it's in their interest, and institutions help them do it by **changing the incentives**. The engine is **reciprocity**, which enforces rules without a world government.

- **International institution ≠ IO (Krasner 1983).** An international regime/institution = "principles, norms, rules, and decision-making procedures around which actor expectations converge" — not just the UN or EU, but monitoring arrangements, agreements, and platforms. Institutions structure repeated interaction.
- **The four mechanisms (the deck's core — how institutions enable cooperation):**
 1. **The shadow of the future.** In a **one-shot** game, cheating pays; in **repeated** interaction, cheating invites future retaliation. A **longer time horizon + more future interaction → higher cost of defection → cooperation more attractive**. (This is the repeated Prisoner's Dilemma — see IR I — solved by tit-for-tat: cooperate first, then mirror.)
 2. **Information changes the game.** **Reporting** (what parties say) + **monitoring** (what they actually do) → **transparency** → easier detection of violations → **less uncertainty, less fear of cheating**. (Ex: the European Semester — the EU monitors member states' budgets to deter "excessive deficits.")
 3. **Reciprocity & enforcement.** **Reciprocity = responding in kind** — meet **cooperation with cooperation** and **defection with punishment** (positive reciprocity rewards; negative reciprocity retaliates). It is liberalism's answer to "who enforces the rules when there is no world government?" — states police each other by making **defection cost you tomorrow's cooperation** (tit-for-tat: cooperate first, then mirror). So **cooperation ≠ harmony** — it needs bargaining and adjustment, and persists **only when defection has consequences**. Institutions supply the machinery: **detect** (monitoring) → **respond** (reciprocity) → **raise the cost** (enforcement) → plus **issue linkage** (cooperate across issues so a concession on one trades for another). (Ex: rule-of-law sanctions — the EU froze Hungary's funds.) **The double edge:** the same reciprocity can spiral into **runaway hostility** — endless mutual punishment (Israel-Palestine).
 4. **Interdependence makes conflict costly.** Complex interdependence (≠ friendship, ≠ one-way dependence): states are tied through **trade, investment, finance, supply chains, people, and communication** across *multiple channels*. Disrupting the relationship is **costly for both sides → stronger incentives to negotiate**. (But interdependence is often *asymmetric* — the textbook's *sensitivity* [you can find another supplier] vs *vulnerability* [you can't].)

- **The neoliberal PD argument:** each actor can gain by defecting, but both lose if both defect; in **repeated** play, **strict reciprocity (tit-for-tat)** brings mutual cooperation. **Danger:** reciprocity can also produce **runaway hostility** — a nasty tit-for-tat of punishments (**Israel–Palestine**).
- **The EU — "a liberal-institutionalism masterpiece" (deck):** European states have **shared interests and incentives to defect**; the institutional solution — **permanent forums, common rules, monitoring, courts/enforcement, issue linkage, repeated interaction** — makes cooperation **easier and more predictable**. After centuries of war, Europe now enjoys a **stable peace**. (*Yet members still "cheat" over the years — cooperation is managed, not automatic.*)

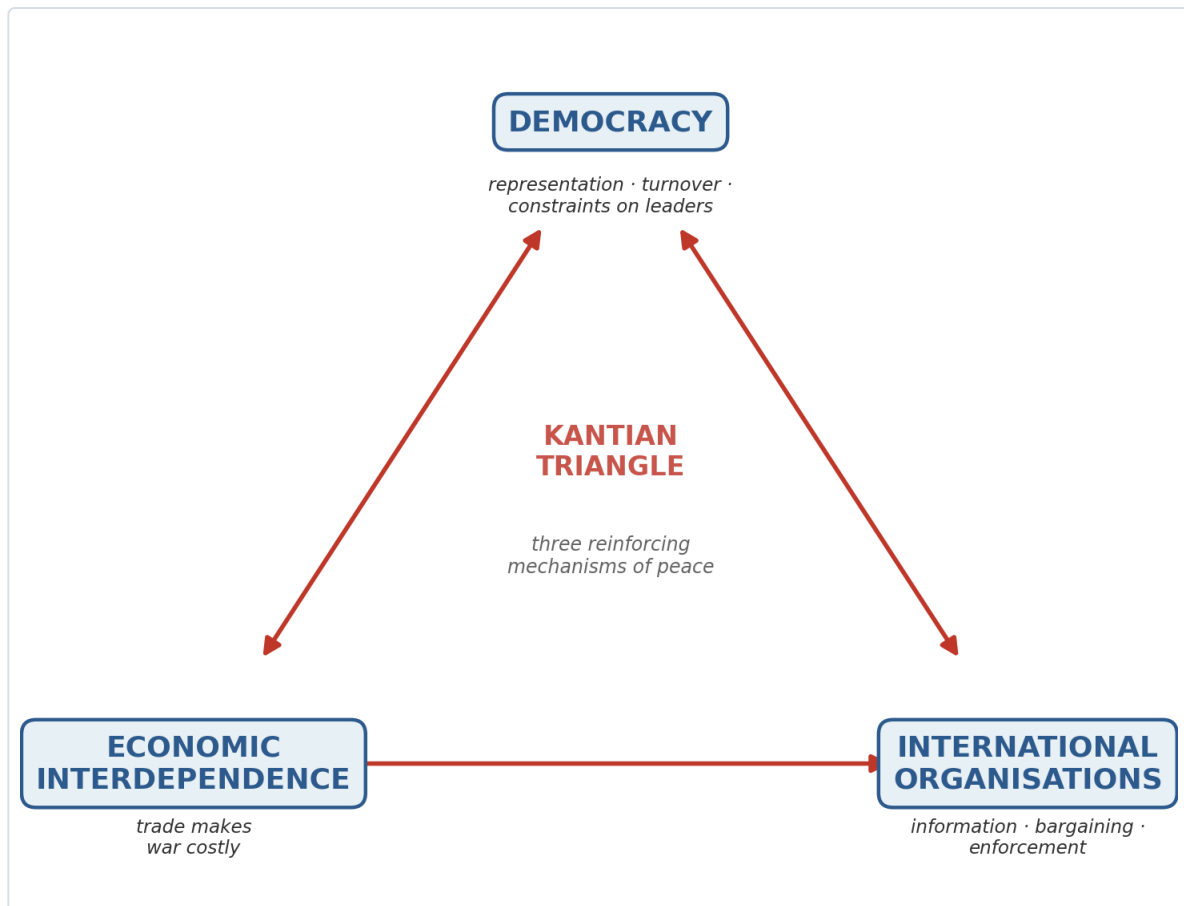
D. International regimes & collective security (§3.2.3–3.2.4)

Core: **regimes** are how liberalism operationalises cooperation in an issue area; **collective security** is the security-side application (all against any aggressor).

- **International regime** = rules/norms/procedures where expectations **converge** in an issue area (arms control, trade, oceans). Regimes **increase transparency** (cheating is riskier) and **facilitate/empower** states rather than constrain them — they "open up new possibilities with more favorable cost–benefit ratios."
- **Hegemonic stability (a realist–liberal blend):** regimes are often most effective when power is **concentrated** (a **hegemon** to enforce them) — but once expectations converge, regimes can **outlive the hegemon** ("take on a life of their own"; US economic regimes survived US relative decline in the 1970s). Regimes often **embed** in permanent institutions (**UN, NATO, IMF**).
- **Collective security** (grows out of liberal institutionalism; Kant's federation): a **broad alliance of most major actors** jointly opposing **aggression by any actor**. Success needs (1) members to **keep commitments** (no free-riding) and (2) agreement on **what counts as aggression**. It **fails against great-power aggression** (the veto).
 - **League of Nations** — failed (no US; members unwilling to bear costs → Japan, Italy in the 1930s). **UN** = its successor.
 - **Gulf War 1990–91** — collective security worked (Iraq's blatant conquest of Kuwait united the great powers). **Iraq 2003** — it *split* the great powers (France threatened a veto; US/UK/Australia acted anyway).

E. ★ Liberal internationalism & the Kantian triangle (§3.2.1 + deck)

Core: liberal internationalism opens the domestic "**black box**": what a state *wants* (its **preferences**) depends on **who has a say inside it**. Kant's three answers to "how is peace possible?" form the Kantian triangle.



How to read it (the Kantian triangle). Kant gave **three** routes to peace, and they **reinforce** each other:

- **Democracy** — republics with **legislatures that check the leader** are constrained from going to war lightly (representation, leadership turnover, accountability). (→ the democratic peace.)
- **Economic interdependence** — **trade increases wealth and mutual dependence**, so war becomes **costly** and less attractive. (Kant's "trade promotes peace"; realists are *skeptical* — interdependence was high before WWI, yet war came.)
- **International organisations** — a **federation of states** (Kant's proposal → today's UN) provides **information, bargaining, and enforcement**, letting states forgo short-term gains for long-term cooperation. (→ liberal institutionalism.)
- **The point**: each corner makes the others more effective; together they explain why, despite anarchy, the world has grown **more peaceful**.
- **The causal chain of liberal internationalism (deck)**: **domestic institutions + interests + incentives** (who benefits? who has influence?) → **state preferences** (what does the government *want*?) → **foreign policy** (which international choice follows) → **international outcome** (cooperation, conflict, or variation across states).
- **Who's in the black box**: president/PM/monarch, parliament, courts, bureaucracies, business & labour, elections, interest groups, media & public opinion. → *This is why liberalism sits at the **domestic level of analysis** (contra realism's systemic focus).*

F. The democratic peace (§3.2.5 + deck)

Core: the democratic peace = the strongly-supported empirical finding that **democracies almost never fight each other** — though they fight authoritarian states as much as anyone. (Democratic peace ≠ "democracies are

peaceful.")

- **Not true:** that democracies are *generally* more peaceful — they fight as many wars as autocracies (the most war-prone states of the past two centuries were **France, Russia, Britain**).
- **True:** no major historical case of two democracies going to war with each other.
- **Why (candidate mechanisms — the deck's exercise):** ① **public opinion & representation** (the public, whose support wars need, resists); ② **peaceful leadership turnover** (no need to fight to change rulers); ③ **transparency & mutual understanding** (democracies read each other's intentions); ④ **institutional constraints** (checks and balances slow the war decision). Also: democracies are usually **capitalist** with strong **trade interdependence**, and citizens **don't see other democracies as enemies**.
- **Why it matters theoretically:** the democratic peace is rooted in the **domestic level** → it **contradicts realism's** claim that the systemic level explains the most.
- **Caveats (don't oversell it):** **democratization/transition** may be *more* war-prone than stable regimes (e.g. Hamas elected 2006); and **democratic institutions can make cooperation harder** — legislatures raise **tariffs**, publics block IOs (US & the League of Nations; **Brexit**).

G. The institutions themselves — IOs, the UN, international law & human rights (ch. 7)

Core: ch. 7 is the **empirical "flesh"** on liberal institutionalism — the actual institutions through which states cooperate under anarchy. All of them are **limited by state sovereignty** (there is **no world government**), yet they **structure order** through norms, reciprocity, and legitimacy.

- **IGOs vs NGOs (§7.1):** **IGOs** = members are **states** (UN, OPEC, WTO, EU); **NGOs** = private/specialised (Amnesty, Greenpeace, Red Cross, religious bodies). The web of IOs has grown steadily → rising **interdependence**.
- **The UN (§7.2)** — "*the closest thing to a world government that has ever existed, but it is not a world government.*" It exists because **states created it to serve their needs** (membership = **indirect leverage**). Key organs:
 - **Security Council** — maintains peace; decisions **binding**; **5 permanent members (US, UK, France, Russia, China)** with the **veto** + 10 rotating members. A single permanent-member **veto** kills a resolution → **paralysis when great powers are involved** (Russia shielding Syria).
 - **Peacekeeping** ("Chapter 6½"; **blue helmets**) — serve at the **host's invitation**, neutral between combatants (Nobel Peace Prize 1988).
 - **General Assembly** — all **193 members, one vote each** — a "global town hall" (declarations are **not** binding law).
 - **Secretariat / Secretary-General** — administration + **neutral mediator** ("good offices").
 - **Specialised agencies** — WHO, ITU, ICAO; and the economic ones (**World Bank, IMF, WTO**).
- **International law (§7.3)** — derives **not** from a world legislature but from **tradition and agreement**. **Four sources:** **treaties** (most important; *pacta sunt servanda* — treaties must be kept), **custom**, **general principles**, **legal scholarship**. **Enforcement** has no world police → rests on **reciprocity + collective response** (sanctions, reprisals) → therefore **depends on power** (easy to cheat on small issues / if you're strong). The **World Court (ICJ, The Hague)** hears only **state-vs-state** cases (limited jurisdiction).
- **Law & sovereignty (§7.4):** **diplomatic law** (immunity; sanctity of embassies — the **Iran hostage crisis 1979**) is the bedrock. **Just-war doctrine:** **laws of war (*jus ad bellum*)** — when war is legal (**only in response to aggression**; intent must be just) — vs **laws in war (*jus in bello*)** — how it may be fought.
- **Human rights (§7.5):** the idea of universal human rights **clashes with sovereignty (universalism vs relativism**; China/Russia call criticism "interference in internal affairs"). Sources: **religion, natural-law philosophy (Locke, Kant, Rousseau)**, the **18th-c. revolutions**. **Civil-political ("negative") vs**

economic-social ("positive") rights. The UDHR (1948) sets norms (not binding law). R2P (responsibility to protect, 2005) — states must protect civilians from genocide/crimes against humanity (invoked for Libya 2011; failed in Syria). War crimes → the ICC (from Nuremberg's "crimes against humanity" → Yugoslavia/Rwanda tribunals → the International Criminal Court).

Cases & examples

- **Nixon–China rapprochement (1969–72).** The US relaxed its trade embargo; three days later China released detained US citizens, then reciprocated further, culminating in Nixon's 1972 visit. → *Illustrates: reciprocity eliciting cooperation between rivals with no world government to enforce it.*
- **Israel–Palestinian tit-for-tat.** Reciprocity works both ways — sustained mutual punishment instead of cooperation. → *Illustrates: reciprocity's runaway-hostility danger (cooperation ≠ automatic).*
- **The European Union.** Shared interests + incentives to defect → an institutional solution (forums, rules, monitoring, courts, issue linkage, repeated interaction). → *Illustrates: liberal institutionalism at full strength — a stable peace built from institutions.*
- **Gulf War (1990–91).** Iraq's blatant annexation of Kuwait united all the great powers behind a UN-authorized response. → *Illustrates: collective security working — clear aggression + willingness to bear costs.*
- **Iraq War (2003).** The Security Council split (France's veto threat); the US/UK acted without UN authorisation. → *Illustrates: collective security's limits when the great powers disagree.*
- **R2P: Libya (2011) vs Syria (2011–).** A UN-authorized NATO campaign protected Libyan civilians; Syria's civilians got no such protection (Russian vetoes). → *Illustrates: the norm shift toward protecting civilians — and how sovereignty + the veto still block it.*

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Cooperation puzzle	Why do states cooperate under anarchy? (liberalism's central question)
Liberal institutionalism	Institutions make cooperation easier (Keohane & Nye; international level)
Liberal internationalism	Domestic politics shape state preferences (Kant; domestic level)
Neoliberalism	Concedes realist assumptions (unitary/rational/anarchy) but shows cooperation pays
Reciprocity / shadow of the future	Repeated interaction makes cheating costly → cooperation rational (tit-for-tat)
International regime	Rules/norms/procedures where actor expectations converge (Krasner)
Complex interdependence	Multiple cross-border channels; disruption costly for both (sensitivity vs vulnerability)
Kantian triangle	Democracy + economic interdependence + international organizations → peace
Democratic peace	Democracies almost never fight <i>each other</i>
Collective security	Broad alliance opposing aggression by any actor (League → UN)
UN Security Council / veto	5 permanent members can each block any resolution
International law (sources)	Treaties · custom · general principles · scholarship (enforced by reciprocity)
Just war	<i>jus ad bellum</i> (when war is legal — response to aggression) vs <i>jus in bello</i> (how fought)
R2P	Responsibility to protect civilians from genocide/crimes against humanity (2005)

Exam pointers

- State **liberalism's puzzle** and its answer: keep the realist assumptions (rational self-interested states under anarchy) but show **cooperation is often rational** — and that liberalism is **not** "being nice/naïve."
- Distinguish the two branches (institutionalism = international/institutions; internationalism = domestic/preferences) and name their theorists (Keohane & Nye; Kant).
- Explain the four institutionalist mechanisms (shadow of the future, information/monitoring, reciprocity/enforcement, interdependence) — and define an international regime (Krasner) with the institution ≠ IO distinction.
- Draw the Kantian triangle and explain the democratic peace precisely (democracies rarely fight *each other*; the mechanisms; the caveats).
- Use ch.7 institutions as evidence: the UN/Security Council + veto, collective security (Gulf War vs Iraq 2003), international law (4 sources, reciprocity enforcement), just war, human rights/R2P.
- **Contrast with realism:** same actors, opposite conclusion — see the table below.

★ Realism vs Liberalism — the payoff

	Realism (IR I)	Liberalism (IR II)
Core principle	Dominance (power)	Reciprocity (+ identity)
View of anarchy	Forces <u>self-help</u> & competition	Doesn't make conflict inevitable
Human nature / progress	Pessimistic, timeless	More optimistic; rules evolve toward peace
Key actors & level	Unitary states; systemic level	States + domestic actors; institutions
Cooperation	Hard; fear of relative gains & cheating	Achievable via institutions & absolute gains
Central concepts	Power, <u>security dilemma</u> , <u>balance of power</u> , <u>polarity</u>	Institutions, regimes, interdependence, <u>democratic peace</u>
Both agree on	States are rational actors pursuing <u>self-interest</u> under anarchy	

The one-line contrast: realism asks "who has the power?"; liberalism asks "under what conditions is cooperation in states' own interest?"

★ Fun facts & memorable details (IR II: Liberalism)

Sticky bits from Liberalism.

- **Liberalism ≠ nice.** It keeps realism's rational, self-interested states — it just asks "**when does cooperation pay?**" The optimism is about **incentives**, not about human goodness.
- **We live in one of the least warlike periods ever** — the last **great-power war ended 60+ years ago**, and battle-deaths have fallen from *tens of millions* to *hundreds of thousands* since WWII (the "waning of war").
- **Tit-for-tat** — cooperate first, then simply mirror the other side — is enough to sustain cooperation in a repeated Prisoner's Dilemma. No world government required.
- **Kant distrusted democracy** (he feared "mob rule" after watching the French Revolution) — yet his *republics* argument became the democratic peace, liberalism's favourite finding.
- **Democracies fight plenty of wars** — just not against *each other*. The three most war-prone states of the last 200 years were **France, Russia, and Britain**.
- **The UN can't heat its own building:** in the 1990s members owed so much in back dues that the UN couldn't afford to heat its NYC headquarters — the campaign slogan became "**Great nations pay their bills.**"
- **UN peacekeeping isn't in the UN Charter** — Dag Hammarskjöld joked the **blue helmets** were authorised under "**Chapter Six and a Half.**"
- **Diplomats' parking tickets:** immunity means NYC is owed ~\$16 million in unpaid diplomatic parking fines — a tiny, vivid example of **sovereignty vs. law**.
- **Grotius returns:** the "**free seas**" principle became law when the **Dutch** (then the **British**) dominated trade and benefited from it — international law often codifies the **hegemon's** interest (cf. *Grotius, PET Module 2*).

IR III: Constructivism / Other Approaches (AUW)

Required reading: PG = Goldstein & Pevehouse, *International Relations* — ch. 3, §3.3–3.6 (*Social Theories* [constructivism + postmodernism] · *Marxism* · *Peace Studies* · *Gender Theories*). · Lecturer: Ayça Uygur Wessel.
Deck: "Social constructivism & critical IR."

Theme of the lecture (deck). After realism (power) and liberalism (cooperation), a third family shifts the question from **material facts to social meaning**. The deck's two questions: **(A) social constructivism** — *how do ideas, identities, norms and interaction construct interests and behaviour?* and **(B) critical IR theory** — *how do power and hierarchy shape those ideas and the international order itself?*

★ **The heart of the lecture:** for realism and (most) liberalism, states arrive with **interests already formed** and just pursue them. Constructivism denies this: **interests are not given — they are socially constructed** through **identities, norms and interaction** (social context → identity → interests → behaviour). Its slogan: "**anarchy is what states make of it**" (Wendt). **Critical theories** then add the question of **power**: they ask how a particular order comes to look "**natural**" — and **who benefits and who is silenced** (Marxism, Gramsci, world-systems, postcolonialism, feminist/queer IR).

The red thread. *Where do interests and "the way things are" come from?* Realism/liberalism take them as given; constructivism says they're **made through meaning**; critical theory says that meaning is **made through power and hierarchy**. For any event ask: *what identities and norms make this action thinkable — and whose interests does the "normal" order serve?*

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Constructivism** — interests/identities are **socially constructed**, not given; draws on the **identity principle**.
- **Social facts vs material facts** — a tank/border/nuke is *material*; its **meaning** (threatening? legitimate?) is a **social fact**.
- "**Anarchy is what states make of it**" (Wendt 1992) — anarchy doesn't dictate friend-or-enemy.
- **Norms + logic of appropriateness** (vs realism's **logic of consequences**); **norm entrepreneurs**, NGOs, IOs.
- **Postmodernism** — texts/discourse, **deconstruction**, **subtext**; states as "fictions."
- **Critical theory** — denaturalise the order; **hierarchy** not just anarchy; **power over ideas/knowledge**.
- **Marxism** — class struggle; **Marx (domestic) vs Lenin (imperialism)**; **Gramsci** (hegemony = consent); **Wallerstein** (core/periphery); **postcolonialism / Said** (Orientalism).
- **Feminist & queer IR** — difference · liberal · postmodern feminism; the **masculinity of realism**.
- **Peace studies** — conflict resolution/mediation, **positive peace**, **structural violence**, **nonviolence**, **militarism**.

A. Social constructivism (PG §3.3 + deck)

| The puzzle — why does the same world produce different "realities"? (deck)

Core: the system contains **material facts** (armies, territory, no world government) — but **material facts don't tell us what they mean**. Meaning is **socially constructed**.

- **The deck's puzzle:** why does the US treat **British** nuclear weapons utterly differently from **North Korean** ones? By raw military power **Britain is far stronger** than North Korea — yet no one calls British nukes a threat. Realism (capabilities) can't explain it; **shared history, alliance and identity** can. → *The identity of the other, not just its capabilities, decides whether it's a threat.*
- **A second puzzle:** why do practices once seen as **normal** (colonialism, racial hierarchy, conquest, piracy) later become **illegitimate**? Because the **norms** that give them meaning change.

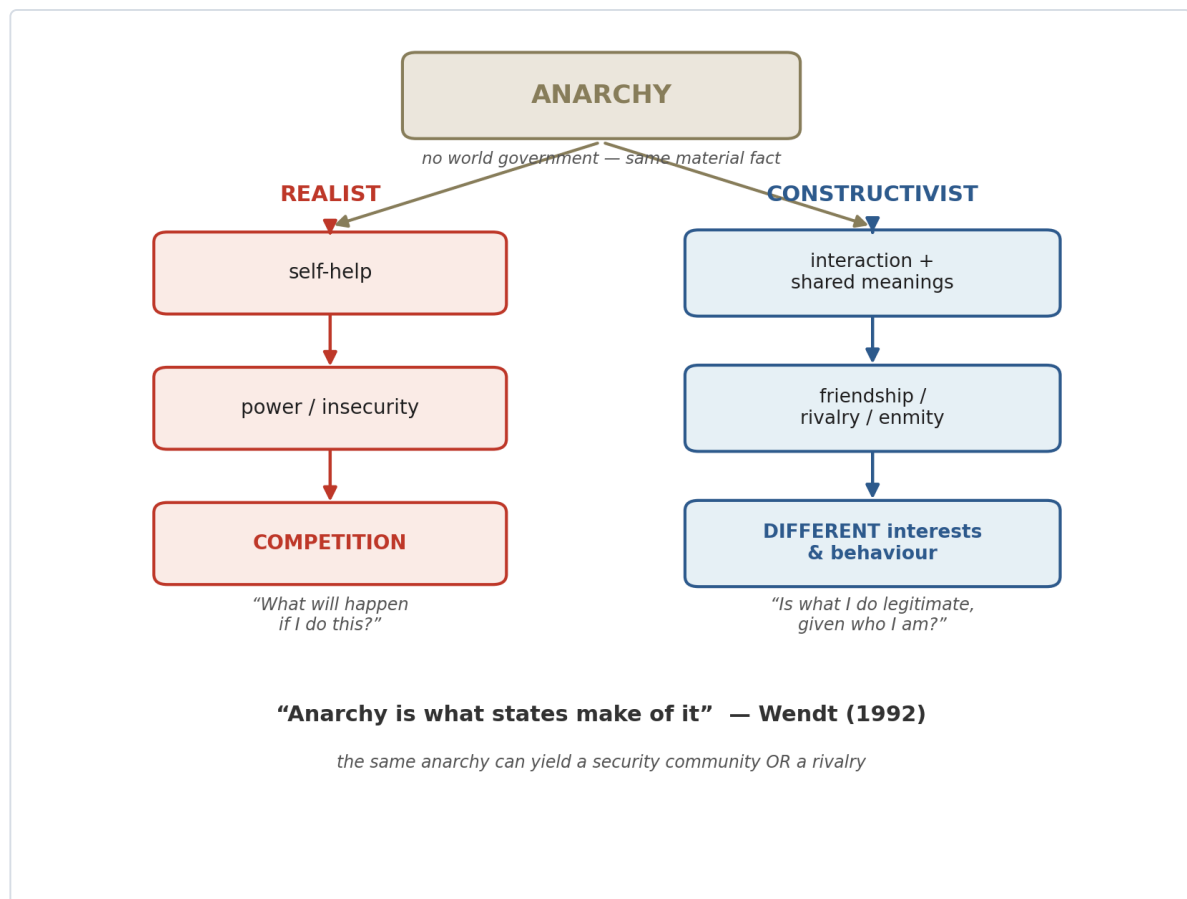
| ★ What constructivism is — interests are socially constructed

Core: **constructivism** asks *how states come to understand what their interests are*. Where realism/liberalism take interests as **given**, constructivism says interests are **constituted** by **social context + interaction** → **identities** → **interests** → **behaviour**. It's best called an **approach** (not a theory) built on the **identity principle**.

- **Material facts ≠ political meaning (deck):** a tank, a border, a nuclear weapon are material; **money, sovereignty, borders, diplomatic status, alliances, rights** are **social facts** — they exist only because actors **collectively recognise and act on them**. The question is never just "is there a tank?" but "*is the tank threatening? is the border legitimate?*"
- **Identity → interests (deck):** an **identity** is an actor's social understanding of **who it is in relation to others** (friend / ally / rival / enemy / neutral / "**rogue state**"). **Interests change when identities and relationships change**, and identities are **(re)shaped through interaction**. (*Chain: Who am I? → Who are you? → Are you one of us/them? → What kind of relationship? → What should I want/fear/do?*)
- **Logic of appropriateness vs logic of consequences:** realists/neoliberals assume a **logic of consequences** ("what will happen to me if I act this way?"); constructivists add a **logic of appropriateness** ("how *should* I behave, given who I am?"). *Example (PG):* the US intervened in **Somalia (1992)** — of minimal strategic value — because **norms about who deserves protection** had widened (from "Christians" in the 19th c. to a universal human-rights frame).
- **Identities change over time (PG):** **Europe** went from the continent of two world wars to a place where war became "**unthinkable**" (identities now tied to the EU); **pirates** went from the scourge of the seas to theme-park **mascots**; **Switzerland/Canada** value a *social* status (neutrality, peacekeeping), not just material power. (*What counts as "threatening" is neither universal nor timeless.*)

| ★ "Anarchy is what states make of it" (Wendt 1992)

Core: the signature constructivist claim — **anarchy has no fixed logic**. It doesn't *tell* a state whether another is friend or enemy; that meaning is built through **interaction and shared understandings**.



How to read it (the deck's slide 9). Both chains start from the **identical material fact** — anarchy. The **realist** (red) reads anarchy as forcing self-help → insecurity → **competition**; the **constructivist** (blue) says anarchy is filled in by **interaction + shared meanings**, which can produce **friendship, rivalry, or enmity**. Same structure, opposite outcomes — because the meaning is **made**, not given. The bottom-line question flips from "*what will happen to me?*" (consequences) to "*is this legitimate, given who I am?*" (appropriateness).

	Realist chain	Constructivist chain
Start	anarchy	anarchy
→	<u>self-help</u>	interaction + shared meanings
→	power / insecurity	friendship / rivalry / enmity
→	competition	different interests & behaviour
Question asked	"What will happen if I do this?"	"Is what I do legitimate, given who I am?"

- **Take-away:** for realists anarchy **forces** competition; for constructivists the **same anarchy** can produce a security community (allies who'd never fight) *or* a rivalry — depending on the meanings states build. (*This is the direct answer to realism's structural claim.*)

Norms — and how they change (the apartheid case)

Core: a **norm** is a **shared expectation of appropriate behaviour** for an actor with a given identity (e.g. "states should not use certain weapons"; "respect sovereignty"; "governments should not openly defend racial supremacy"). Norms **shape legitimacy, identities, interests and behaviour** — and actors in turn **reproduce, contest and change** them.

- **How norms spread (PG): norm entrepreneurs** (individuals who travel, write, lobby elites); **social movements & NGOs** (e.g. the anti-apartheid movement building a global norm of racial equality); **IOs** (UN, NATO) diffusing standards of appropriate conduct.
- ★ **South African apartheid (deck's worked case)**. Racial hierarchy was once embedded in domestic *and* international order → **norm entrepreneurs/movements** challenged it → a **global norm of racial equality** strengthened → racially discriminatory rule became **hard to justify** → NGOs + IOs + states mobilised **boycotts, sanctions, diplomatic isolation**. **Constructivist claim:** *changing ideas about legitimate rule changed the political environment in which states calculated their interests* — power politics alone can't explain the fall of apartheid.
- A **"natural experiment" (PG)**: Britain barely funded the Yugoslavia war-crimes tribunal — realists said "Britain sides with Serbia"; liberals said "free-riding." Then **Blair** replaced **Major (1997)** with *no change* in Britain's strategic interests — yet policy **flipped** (arrests, funding). → the change in **identity/leadership ideas** drove the outcome, supporting constructivism.

Postmodernism (PG §3.3.2)

Core: postmodernism denies a **single objective reality** and studies **texts and discourse** — how we *talk and write* about IR. It **deconstructs** realism's key move (the **unitary state actor**) and hunts for the **subtext** (hidden meanings, omissions).

- **States as "fictions":** postmodernists say states have no tangible reality — they're **stories** we tell to organise the actions of millions. Realists were **amazed** when the "unitary" **Soviet Union split into 15 pieces** — the label had masked divergent internal experiences.
- **Deconstruction & subtext:** to *deconstruct* a text is to tease apart its words to reveal what's **omitted or implicit**. Realism's subtext **omits** women/gender, classes, poor countries, non-military power — a "narrow, one-sided story" that (postmodernists say) serves **powerful actors**. (*Postmodernism set the stage for, and was largely absorbed into, constructivism.*)

★ **Exercise (deck)** — build a constructivist explanation of Putin's war on Ukraine. *Don't ask whether Putin's claims are true; ask how Russia's leadership constructs the meaning of the situation, using the chain IDENTITY → THREAT PERCEPTION → LEGITIMACY → BEHAVIOUR. Who is "Russia" in the narrative? Who are Ukraine / NATO / "the West"? What is presented as the threat? Which norms are invoked to make force look legitimate? How does this construction make invasion representable as defence/protection rather than aggression? → the point: identities and norms make some actions thinkable and legitimate and others not.*

- **Critics (PG):** realists say norms are just **covers for interests**; liberals say constructivists neglect **formal institutions**; both note it's hard to tell a **genuine** identity from one **adopted strategically** for material gain (aid, trade, membership).

B. Critical IR theory — adding power & hierarchy (deck + PG §3.4)

Core (deck): constructivism asks *how* realities are constructed; **critical approaches** add the question of **power** — *how are particular realities made to appear natural, and who benefits?* Critical theory refuses to take existing institutions, categories and power relations **for granted**: it aims to **expose domination** → **denaturalise the order** → open possibilities for change.

- **The major shifts (deck):** anarchy → also examine **hierarchy** · state interests → ask **how interests are produced** · power-as-capabilities → also **power over ideas & knowledge** · "who acts?" → **who is marginalised/silenced?** · "how does order work?" → "**whose order is it?**"

Marxism & global capitalism (PG §3.4)

Core: Marxist approaches see **both** IR and domestic politics as arising from **unequal relations between economic classes** — shifting the unit of analysis from **state ↔ state** to **class, capital, labour, production, the global economy**. Key question (deck): **who produces value, and who captures it?**

- **Class struggle:** more powerful classes **exploit** the less powerful by denying them their fair share of the **surplus** they create; ultimately this scales up to **richer vs poorer world regions** (North–South).
- ★ **Marx vs Lenin (the exam distinction — LO 3.4):**
 - **Marx = a domestic theory of class struggle.** In industrialising Europe, labour creates the surplus; workers (the **proletariat**) should recapture it through struggle. Marx expected revolution in the **advanced** capitalist countries.
 - **Lenin = a theory of imperialism (the international extension).** European capitalists invest in **colonies** for big profits, then use part of those profits to "**buy off**" the **working class at home** (so no revolution there). Once the world was carved up, imperial expansion could only come at rivals' expense → **inter-imperialist war (WWI)**. So revolution comes in the **poor/"backward"** periphery (Russia 1917, China 1949), not the rich core.
- **Peasants (not just proletariat):** contrary to Marx, the great 20th-c. revolutions were **peasant** rebellions (China the largest). **Trotsky** (spread revolution worldwide) lost to **Stalin** ("socialism in one country").

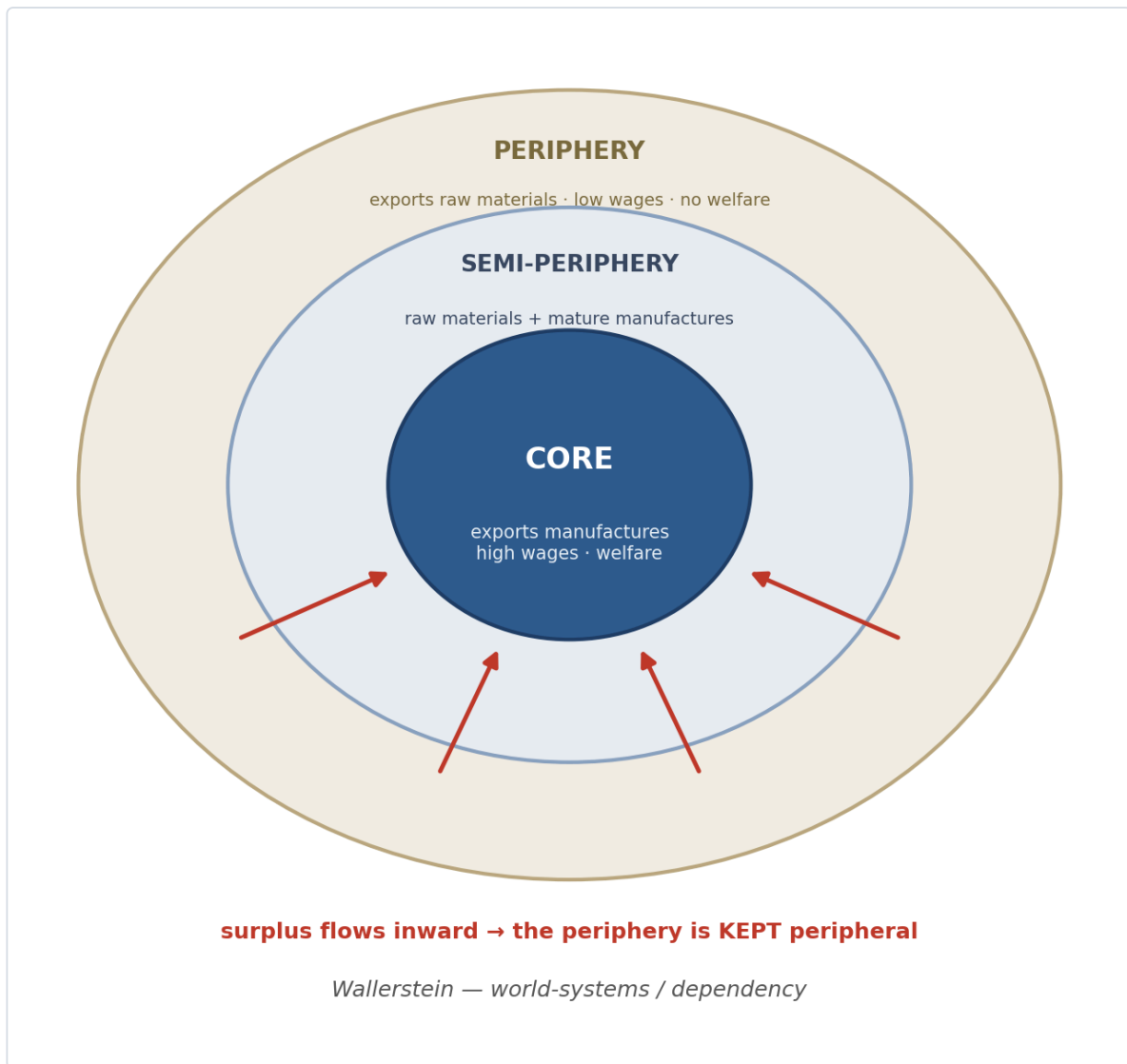
The critical-theory strands the deck adds — Gramsci · Wallerstein · postcolonialism/Said

Core: the deck bundles several **critical** approaches that extend the Marxist insight from *material* class to **ideas, structure and identity**.

- **Gramsci — hegemony as consent, not just coercion.** **Hegemonic power** is bigger than force: it rests on **consent** — dominant ideas and institutions make a particular order look "**normal, legitimate, universal, common sense**" ("this is simply how the world works"). **Critical question:** when the "rules of the game" go unchallenged, ask "**who got to write the rules?**"
- **Wallerstein — world-systems / dependency.** The global economy is a **single hierarchy** of three zones (the deck's diagram):

Zone	Government	Production role	Wages / welfare
Core	democratic	imports raw materials, exports manufactures ; high investment	high wages, welfare services
Semi-periphery	authoritarian	exports raw materials & mature manufactures ; imports advanced manufactures	low wages, little welfare
Periphery	non-democratic	exports raw materials , imports manufactures	low wages, no welfare

→ *dependency theory's claim: the periphery isn't "not yet developed" — it is **kept** poor by its structural position, which channels surplus to the core (cf. **Lenin**).*



How to read it (Wallerstein). The world economy is **one hierarchy**, not a ladder every country climbs. The **core** (rich democracies) exports high-value **manufactures**; the **periphery** exports **raw materials** at low wages; the **semi-periphery** sits between. The red arrows are the key claim: **surplus flows inward**, so the periphery is not "behind" — it is **structurally kept peripheral** (the dependency/Lenin point).

- **Postcolonial theory** — colonialism created *enduring hierarchies (deck)*: **material** (wealth, trade, borders, institutions), **knowledge** (whose history/concepts count?), and **social** (civilised/backward · developed/underdeveloped · modern/traditional · "West / Rest"). **Core question**: *how does the colonial past keep structuring the international present?*
- **Said — Orientalism & "othering."** Power works by **representation**: the West constructs "the Other" through recurring **binaries** — **Self** (modern, rational, civilised, orderly) vs **Other** (backward, irrational, uncivilised, chaotic). The mechanism: **represent difference → essentialise groups → produce hierarchy → make unequal treatment seem reasonable**. "*Representation constitutes the subjects we then act upon.*"

Feminist & queer IR (PG §3.6 + deck)

Core: gender and sexuality aren't just traits of individuals — they structure the ideas, roles and hierarchies of IR. Feminists ask what becomes **visible** once we stop treating *the state, war, security* as gender-neutral: **whose** security, **whose** labour, **whose** experiences, **whose** voices? All strands agree **gender matters**; they split on **how**.

Strand	Core claim	On women in IR
Difference feminism	Realism reflects a masculine worldview (autonomy, separation, force = "manly"); women, on average, are less warlike / better at connection & peacemaking	Real change needs many women → would transform ("feminise") the system
Liberal feminism	Men and women are equal ; "essential" differences are trivial/nonexistent	Include women in male preserves (leaders, soldiers) — they play the game the same way ; exclusion just wastes talent
Postmodern feminism	Gender is real but arbitrary & flexible (not fixed); deconstruct the subtext of realist language	Reject both: don't glorify "feminine virtue" or just add women to war

- **The masculinity of realism (difference feminism):** realism's **autonomy/sovereignty/anarchy** mirror a "masculine psyche" (separation over connection); the public(masculine)/private(feminine) split maps onto the international(anarchic)/domestic(ordered) split → *realism constructs IR as "a man's world."*
- **Evidence both ways:** the **overlapping bell curves** — genders differ *on average* but overlap hugely (liberal feminists stress the **overlap**: individual women perform like men; difference feminists stress the **shift**: women *as a group* differ, e.g. the ~10-point **gender gap** in support for military action). **Women state leaders** (Thatcher, Gandhi, Meir, Merkel...) were **not** more peaceful — supporting liberal feminism. **Postmodern feminists** deconstruct the sexual **subtext** of weapons talk ("It's a boy" for the H-bomb; "power/potency").

Peace studies (PG §3.5)

Core: peace studies shifts IR from the **systemic** level to **individual/domestic/transnational** social relations, and openly **rejects "objectivity"** (knowledge through **action/participation**). It reconceives both peace and war.

- **Conflict resolution — the mediation toolkit (LO 3.5):** **mediation** = a **third party** helps two sides settle short of violence (the **UN** is the biggest mediator). Forms: **good offices** (a neutral channel — e.g. Pakistan passing messages between the US & China, 1971); **arbitration** (both sides agree in advance to accept a third party's binding decision — e.g. the city of **Brčko** in the Dayton process); **confidence-building measures** (gradually build trust); **linkage** (bundle issues so a concession on one trades for another — Yalta 1945).
- **Positive vs negative peace:** realism recognises only **negative peace** (the temporary **absence of war**); **positive peace** removes the **underlying causes** — including **structural violence** (poverty, hunger, oppression *built into* social structures, which kill more than direct violence).
- **Militarism** = the **glorification** of war (through films, toys, sport, speeches) and the **structuring of society around war** (the military-industrial complex). Less-militarised cultures (Costa Rica — **no army for 70 years**; post-war Japan) show realism's stress on force isn't **universal**.
- **Nonviolence:** a unilateral refusal of violent leverage — **Gandhi** (Indian independence), **MLK** (US civil rights), and **Gene Sharp's** strategies (taught to **Arab Spring** activists). Practical as well as moral — often the **cost-effective** tool of the powerless.

★ The four theories compared — "theory changes what we see" (deck capstone)

Core: each theory is a different **pair of glasses** — it makes different things visible and asks a different core question.

Theory	Core question	Interests are...	Key concepts
Realism	Where is the power ?	given (survival, power)	anarchy, self-help, balance of power, security dilemma
Liberalism	What enables cooperation / shapes preferences?	given (peace, prosperity)	institutions, reciprocity, interdependence, democratic peace
Constructivism	How did actors come to understand their interests this way?	socially constructed	identity, norms, social facts, "anarchy is what states make of it"
Critical theory	How did this order become normal — who benefits, who is marginalised?	produced by power/hierarchy	hegemony, class, core/periphery, colonial & gendered hierarchies

The move across the row: realism & liberalism take the world's actors and interests as **given** and ask how they behave; **constructivism** asks where those interests **come from** (meaning); **critical theory** asks whose **power** made that meaning look natural. (This is the deck's — and the exam's — payoff: pick an event and show what each lens sees and misses.)

Cases & examples

- **British vs North Korean nukes.** The US fears NK's bomb, not Britain's far larger arsenal → **identity/alliance**, not capabilities, defines the threat. → Illustrates: **constructivism** vs **realism** — the meaning of a material fact.
- **South African apartheid.** Norm change (racial equality) → delegitimation → sanctions. → Illustrates: **norms & norm entrepreneurs** reshaping states' interests.
- **Blair's Bosnia U-turn (1997).** Same interests, new leadership/identity → opposite policy. → Illustrates: a "natural experiment" favouring **constructivism** over **realism/liberalism**.
- **US in Somalia (1992).** Intervention with no strategic payoff → the **logic of appropriateness** + widened norms of who deserves protection. → Illustrates: **norms over cost-benefit**.
- **Lysistrata / women's peace movements.** From Aristophanes to WILPF to UNSC Res. 1325 — the long "women as peacemakers" thread (and its limits: female leaders weren't more peaceful). → Illustrates: the **difference-vs-liberal-feminist debate**.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Constructivism	Interests/identities are socially constructed through norms & interaction (identity principle)
Social fact vs material fact	Meaning collectively recognised (sovereignty, alliance) vs brute matter (a tank)
"Anarchy is what states make of it"	Wendt — anarchy has no fixed logic; friend/enemy is constructed
Norm / norm entrepreneur	Shared expectation of appropriate behaviour; actor who spreads it
Logic of appropriateness vs consequences	"How <i>should</i> I act?" vs "what will happen to me?"
Postmodernism / subtext	Denies single reality; studies discourse; hidden meanings/omissions
Marxism (Marx vs Lenin)	Domestic class struggle vs imperialism (buying off the core's workers)
Hegemony (Gramsci)	Rule by consent — dominant ideas made to seem common sense
World-systems (Wallerstein)	Core / semi-periphery / periphery hierarchy
Orientalism (Said)	Power through representation — Self/Other binaries → hierarchy
Difference / liberal / postmodern feminism	Women differ & would transform IR / women are equal, just include them / gender is real but arbitrary
Positive peace / structural violence	Removing the causes of war / violence built into social structures
Mediation / arbitration	Third party assists a settlement / third party's binding decision

Exam pointers

- Explain what constructivism adds to realism/liberalism: **interests are constructed** (social context → identity → interests → behaviour), with the UK-vs-NK-nukes puzzle.
- State and use "anarchy is what states make of it" — contrast the realist and constructivist chains.
- Show how norms change via norm entrepreneurs/NGOs/IOs — the apartheid case, and the logic of appropriateness (Somalia).
- **Distinguish Marx from Lenin** (domestic class struggle vs imperialism) — the LO 3.4 distinction.
- Lay out the critical shift (anarchy→hierarchy, "whose order?") and one strand in depth — **Gramsci**, Wallerstein's core/periphery, or Said's Orientalism.
- Compare the three feminisms and the **masculinity-of-realism** critique.
- Describe the mediation toolkit (good offices, arbitration, confidence-building, linkage) and **positive vs negative peace** (LO 3.5).
- **Run all four lenses** on one event using the comparison table.

Bridge. IR III completes the theory arc: **realism** (power) → **liberalism** (cooperation) → **constructivism** (meaning) → **critical theory** (power *behind* meaning). Realism and liberalism debate *how given actors behave*; constructivism and critical theory ask *where the actors, interests and "normal" order came from* — and who they serve.

★ Fun facts & memorable details (IR III: Constructivism & Critical Theory)

Sticky bits from constructivism & critical IR.

- "Anarchy is what states make of it" — Alexander **Wendt's** 1992 line is the single most-quoted sentence in constructivism: the *same* anarchy can produce NATO or a knife-fight.
- **Britain's nukes don't scare Washington, North Korea's do** — even though Britain's arsenal is far bigger. Proof that in IR, **identity beats capability**.
- **Pirates went from the terrorists of their day to theme-park mascots** — the textbook's vivid reminder that "what counts as a threat" is **not timeless**. (Imagine your great-grandkids on a *terrorist*-themed ride.)
- **A natural experiment**: Tony **Blair** replacing John Major flipped Britain's Bosnia policy with **no change in national interest** — a rare "clean test" that favoured constructivism.
- **Marx vs Lenin in one line**: Marx expected revolution in the **rich** countries; **Lenin** explained why it came in the **poor** ones — the rich bought off their workers with **colonial** profits.
- **Gramsci's hegemony** = getting people to say "*this is just how the world works*" — power that never has to draw its sword.
- **Wallerstein's world-system**: you're not "**not yet developed**" — the periphery is **kept** peripheral so surplus flows to the **core**.
- **Said's Orientalism**: the West "knows" the East by inventing it — **representation** becomes a tool of domination.
- **Lysistrata (411 BC)** — Aristophanes had the women withhold sex to end the Peloponnesian War; it was **read aloud in 1,000 venues in 56 countries** in 2003 to protest the Iraq War.
- "**It's a boy**": the coded cable confirming the first **H-bomb** worked — postmodern feminists' favourite example of the **gendered subtext** of weapons.
- **Costa Rica has had no army since 1948** — a living rebuttal to realism's claim that military force is universal and necessary.

IR IV: International Security (AUW)

Required reading: PG = Goldstein & Pevehouse, *International Relations*, ch. 5 (*International Conflict*) · Bilgin, Pinar, "Security," in Berenskötter (ed.), *Concepts in International Relations* (2025), ch. 14. · Lecturer: Ayça Uygur Wessel. Deck: "*International security*."

Theme of the lecture (deck). Two moves. First, **unpack the concept of "security"** — it is *contested* and its real-world use is *political* (who gets to call something a "security" issue, and why). Then turn to **conflict and war** — how and why international (and internationalised) conflicts occur, read through the levels of analysis.

★ **The heart of the lecture**: "security" is not a neutral fact about the world but a **contested, political concept**. Three questions are always in play — **whose security?** (the *referent*: state · society · individual · humanity), **which threats?** (military vs non-military), and **is the state the protector or the threat?** Calling something a "security issue" is itself a **political act (securitisation)** that moves it out of normal politics. The different **IR theories** each answer "what is security?" differently, and **war** has causes at three **levels** — the individual, the state/domestic, and the anarchic system.

The red thread. *Security for whom, from what, and provided by whom — and who decides?* Hold those questions through the concept (Bilgin), the theories, and the causes of war (PG ch.5).

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Security = a contested concept** — thin agreement ("freedom from threats to core values"), deep disagreement on referent, threats, the state's role.
- **Referent object** ("whose security?") — **national/traditional** (state) · **societal** (community/identity) · **human** (individual) · **global** (humanity).
- **The state: protector (Hobbes) vs war-maker (Tilly)** — the four activities: war-making, state-making, protection, extraction ("protection racket").
- **Securitisation** (Wæver) — security as a **speech act**; framing an issue as an existential threat moves it beyond normal politics.
- **The security dilemma** (Herz) — self-help defence can be self-defeating.
- **IR theories & security** — realism (power under anarchy) · liberalism (cooperation/institutions) · constructivism (threats are constructed) · critical (security is political).
- **Causes of war** — levels of analysis (Waltz's *three images*): individual · domestic · systemic.
- **Types of war** (hegemonic/total/limited/civil/guerrilla) and **types of conflict** (ideas: ethnic/religious/ideological · interests: territorial/governmental/economic).

A. Unpacking "security" (Bilgin ch.14 + deck)

★ Security is a contested — and political — concept

Core: there is **thin agreement** (security = *freedom from threats to core values*, for individuals and groups) but **deep disagreement** on almost everything else. And crucially, **defining something as a security issue is a political act**.

- **What's contested (deck):** the **focus of inquiry** (whose security — individual, national, international, global?); the **types of threat** (military vs non-military); the **role of the state** (security *provider*, or a *threat* to security?).
- **★ The Kilis example (Bilgin's opener).** In 2016, rockets from IS-held northern Syria hit **Kilis, Türkiye**, killing 20+ over five months — yet the government did **not** officially call it a security threat (it portrayed the rockets as merely "falling from the sky"). This changed only in August 2016, when the government prepared a **ground incursion** into Syria and *then* declared the rockets **acts of terrorism threatening national security**. Why the change? **Politics** — initially it didn't want to be seen fighting a group with "Islamic" in its name; once ready to act, it named the enemy "DAESH." → *Politics is key to how — and whether — governments use the concept of security.*
- **Etymology:** "security" ← Latin *securus* ("without worry/concern"). Ironically, early usage saw feeling too secure as **bad** (breeds carelessness). **Hobbes** gave it its modern political shape (a strong authority as the condition for security).

Whose security? — the referent object

Core: the biggest disagreement is over the **referent object** — *who or what is to be secured?* The answer is **not fixed**; it changes with which threats which actors prioritise, and **the same event looks different depending**

on whose security you centre.

Referent	"Security" asks...	Threat =
National / traditional (the STATE)	Is the state safe from external threats?	invasion, rival great powers
Societal (the COMMUNITY)	Can the group keep its identity & way of life ?	migration, cultural erosion
Human (the INDIVIDUAL)	Are people safe in their survival, well-being & rights ?	poverty, disease, their <i>own</i> government
Global (HUMANITY)	Are threats addressed at the level of humanity/the planet ?	climate change, pandemics, nuclear war

- **Worked example (deck):** global warming looks like an economic issue to one actor, an existential threat to a low-lying island state, a human-security issue to the displaced. *Whose security you centre changes what you see.*

Types of threat — military vs non-military (and how they overlap)

Core: the traditional focus is **military** threats (invasion/territorial aggression, conventional war, nuclear escalation, interstate & civil conflict, coercion/shows of force, armed rebel groups) — but real-world threats are increasingly **non-military** (health, climate, migration), and the categories **overlap**.

- **South China Sea (deck's overlap case).** A **territorial** dispute (sovereignty, Spratly Islands, Exclusive Economic Zones) is *also* **economic** (oil, gas, fisheries), **strategic** (sea lanes — $\sim\frac{1}{3}$ of **global shipping** passes through), and **military** (bases, radar, missile shelters — e.g. China's runways on **Fiery Cross Reef**; "show-of-force" behaviour to assert dominance **without declaring war**). → *Analytical distinctions (military/economic/strategic) are tightly knotted in the real world.*

The state — security provider or war-maker?

Core: two opposed readings of the state's relation to security.

- **Provider (Hobbesian tradition):** the individual **gives up freedom** to be more secure, handing the **monopoly of violence** to the state, which embodies **national sovereignty**. A "security threat" = something posing an **existential threat to the state** (handled by defence, intelligence, law enforcement). (*This is the classic-realist starting point.*)
- **War-maker (Charles Tilly, 1985/1992):** states **earned their statehood through war-making** — "*war made the state and the state made war*" (cf. PET/PS on Tilly); war is the state's *modus operandi*; "**no war = no modern state**." Tilly's **four activities** (he likens the early state to a **protection racket** — the deck's "Don Corleone" joke):

Activity	= eliminating / neutralising...
War-making	rivals outside the territory
State-making	rivals inside the territory
Protection	the enemies of its clients
Extraction	acquiring the means (tax, men) to do the first three

The concept's real-world history — from national → international → human security (Bilgin)

Core: the meaning of security was **never fixed**; different uses served different **political agendas**, and the "myth of origin" (US national security) is only one strand.

- **The "myth of origin" — US national security (post-1945).** "National security" rose to prominence in US debates over the post-war role of the US (rivalry with the USSR). Policymakers found it **flexible and catchy** — useful against isolationist/small-government opponents, to keep the US globally engaged and investing in the military. **Arnold Wolfers (1952):** national security as a form of **national interest**. Embedded institutionally via the **National Security Council** and **NSC-68 (1950)** → Truman's massive military build-up (peacetime military spending, newly justified by "national security"). *Contrary to realist assumptions*, US national security was **never only** about external military threats — "**making the world safe for US economic interests**" was central (the World Bank, IMF, GATT as "part and parcel of the security project") → a **creative repackaging** of economic interest as national security.
- **National vs international vs collective security.** The **referent** distinguishes them: US "national security" → the **state** is referent (threat = the USSR); UN "international security" → the **society of states** is referent (threat = another world war). **Collective security** = aggression against one is aggression against all (global in scope; regulates relations *between* members) — *not* the same as an **alliance** like NATO (which defends *against* external threats). The League of Nations' **collective security** was paralysed by the **unanimity** rule; the UN fixed it with **majority** voting — but protected great powers with the **P5 veto** (so the US never has to act against its will — but any P5 can also block it). First real test: **North Korea's 1950 invasion** (the USSR was boycotting the Council, so it couldn't veto). → the "**Uniting for Peace**" mechanism lets the General Assembly recommend when the Council is deadlocked.
- **Human security — the alternative from outside the US.** Newly independent states, wary of superpower pacts (Nehru: "*every pact has brought insecurity*"), sought a "**third way**" focused on **sovereignty and development**, *not* a security frame (**Bandung Conference 1955**; Non-Aligned Movement; **New International Economic Order**). (Box: **Iran 1953** — **PM Mosaddegh**, who nationalised the oil industry, was toppled by a **CIA-MI6 coup**: the UK/US defended their **economic interests in the name of international security** against Iran's search for development.) When the NIEO stalled, **non-state actors** took up the cause and made **human beings the referent** → "**human security**," coined by **Mahbub ul Haq** ("secure human development"), embraced by the **UNDP in 1994**. Landmark: the **International Campaign to Ban Landmines (ICBL)** framed landmines as a human-security harm → the **1997 Mine Ban Treaty** + a Nobel Peace Prize (the **agency of non-state actors**).
- **The military-state frame returns (21st c.):** after 9/11, NATO's collective-defence clause + the UN's collective-security mechanism let US national security be framed as *international* security → the **Global War on Terror**. Its flexibility let many governments re-label domestic opponents as "terrorists" (e.g. China and Xinjiang). And the **privatisation of security** — **Private Military Companies** like the **Wagner Group** (Russia in Ukraine) — sell security as a marketable good ("we sell a *concept* of security").

B. IR theories & security (deck)

Core: each theory family answers "*what is security, and how do states pursue it?*" differently — and in a crisis, each looks for different things.

Theory	Security is...	The chain	In a crisis, it asks...
<u>Realism</u>	surviving under anarchy	anarchy → <u>self-help</u> → power/capabilities → security competition	military capabilities, alliances, relative power, strategic incentives
<u>Liberalism</u>	achieved through cooperation	<u>self-interest</u> → interdependence → institutions (info, monitoring, reciprocity) → cooperation	what blocked the mutual gains from cooperation? (+ domestic politics → preferences)
<u>Constructivism</u>	what states make of it	material capabilities → (<i>interaction + shared meanings</i>) → identity → threat perception → behaviour	how did actors come to understand something as a threat?
Critical IR	political	power shapes which threats/referents count	whose security? who defines the threat, and with what power? who is protected vs marginalised ?

- (Deck exercise: how would each theory explain *the USA's threats against Greenland*? Realism → strategic/Arctic position & relative power; liberalism → institutional/allied damage; constructivism → identity & how "threat" is framed; critical → whose security, whose Arctic, what hierarchy.)

★ Securitisation — security as a "speech act" (Wæver / Copenhagen School)

Core: critics argue security **does not exist outside discourse** — an issue becomes a "security" issue only because an actor **frames** it as one. Ole Wæver calls this **securitisation**: *saying* something is an existential threat is also *doing* something. It is **not politically innocent** — it **removes the issue from normal political deliberation** ("beyond closed doors where experts decide"), lets governments claim **more resources** and **silence critics** in the name of unity against an "existential threat," creates an "**us vs them**" mindset, and often **militarises** the problem.



How to read it. The move that matters is **step 2 → 3**: a **securitising actor** *claims* existential threat, and the **audience** must **accept** it. Only then does the issue "become" security — and the payoff (step 5) is **exceptional powers** outside normal debate. Example (deck): "*increased irregular migration*" (a policy problem) vs "*immigration crisis*" (a securitised threat). **Climate change** is the live debate: securitising it could mobilise resources — but critics warn it creates a false "us vs them" (there is no "them" — *we* are the problem) and risks **militarising** a non-military issue.

Critical Security Studies — the academic critique of realism (Bilgin)

Core: IR's understanding of security was long dominated by a **realist** outlook (military threats *to states* from *outside*, met by military means; the state is both **referent** and **agent**). Critics — drawing on **Feminism**, **Frankfurt-School critical theory**, **post-structuralism**, **postcolonialism** — showed security is **socially constructed** and **political**, and re-opened *whose* security counts.

- **Wolfers' warning (1952):** national security is an "**ambiguous symbol**" — used without specification it "leaves room for more confusion than sound political counsel can afford." He split **objective** security (absence of threats to acquired values) from **subjective** (absence of *fear*) — both require judgement.
- **Common security** (Palme Commission, 1982): since there's **nowhere to hide from nuclear catastrophe**, the referent should be "**us all**" — pursue security *with* others, not against them. Rests on the **security dilemma** (Herz 1950): self-serving defence can be **self-defeating** (your build-up scares the other side → arms race → everyone less safe).

- **Gusterson:** realist security scholars not only **failed to predict the fall of the Berlin Wall (1989)** but "were unable to even entertain the possibility" — a blow to realism's authority (too much focus on military capabilities, too little on socio-political context).
- **Eurocentrism** (Barkawi & Laffey): security studied in Euro/Anglo-centric ways — **normative** (privileging EU/Western security — e.g. studying the 2015–16 Mediterranean "refugee crisis" only from Europe's side), **analytical** (Europe at the centre of the framework), **epistemological** (drawing only on the "European experience" as knowledge).
- **Feminist IR — Carol Cohn:** nuclear experts coded attention to the human costs of weapons as "**feminine**" and military might as "**strength**"; "**nuke-speak**" is abstract, gendered language that lets experts discuss weapons **without** confronting their human consequences. Realist security assessments are **not objective** but shaped by ideas of masculinity/femininity (cf. IR III).
- **Ontological security** (Mitzen, Rumelili): people/groups need a **stable identity**; a protracted conflict that threatens your *body* can **stabilise your identity** → actors whose identity is tied to fighting may **block peace** to preserve their "ontological security."
- **Relational approaches** (Bilgin): a state's "failure" to provide security is often a product of **international relations** (esp. the **colonial** legacy and the differential recognition of European vs African sovereignty), not just internal traits — so study security **relationally**.

(Bilgin's concept web: **security** sits between its **contrast** — violence, war, insecurity, instability; its **cognate** — peace, stability; and its **supporting** concepts — threats, power, deterrence, development, and the physical/material/identity dimensions.)

C. Causes of war (PG ch.5 + deck)

| Types of war

Core: "war" (usually defined as $\geq 1,000$ battle deaths) covers very different things:

Type	What it is
Hegemonic war	for control of the entire world order (a.k.a. world/global/systemic war) — last one was WWII ; now probably impossible without destroying civilisation
Total war	to conquer & occupy another state (reach the capital, replace the government) — born with the Napoleonic Wars ; the whole enemy society becomes a legitimate target
Limited war	objectives short of surrender/occupation (e.g. 1991 Gulf War retook Kuwait, didn't take Baghdad); raids = single-action limited wars
Civil war	factions within a state fighting to create/prevent a government or secede — often the most brutal
Guerrilla war	warfare without front lines ; irregular forces hidden among civilians — harass rather than confront; civilians suffer most

| ★ Why does war break out? — the levels of analysis (Waltz's *three images*)

Core: most wars have **multiple causes at different levels**. The deck uses Waltz's *Man, the State, and War* (1959) "three images" — the **individual**, the **state/domestic**, and the **international system** — with **anarchy** as the *necessary* condition.

Level	The explanation	Key names
Individual	human nature (power-seeking) <i>and</i> rational cost-benefit calculation — war can be a <i>reasoned</i> choice (leaders may not bear its full cost); " bad decision ≠ irrational decision "; also deviations from rationality (bias, groupthink)	Thucydides, Machiavelli, Hobbes; Fearon (rationalist explanations)
Domestic	regime type & decision-making structures; powerful domestic actors, norms & ideologies (nationalism, religion); support for irredentism/secession ; leaders playing to two audiences at once	Putnam (<i>two-level games</i>); <u>democratic peace</u>
Systemic	not human nature but the anarchic system that breeds fear & suspicion: " <i>wars occur because there is nothing to stop them from occurring</i> "; power-transition; deterrence vs arms races; long cycles	Waltz (1959); power-transition theory

- **Descriptive vs theoretical (PG):** a historian says "*the assassination of Franz Ferdinand caused WWI*"; a political scientist says the assassination was only the **catalyst** — the cause was **shifts in the balance of power**. The levels-of-analysis frame reminds us both (and more) operate at once.

What states fight about — conflicts of ideas & of interest (PG §5.2–5.3)

Core: PG sorts conflicts into six overlapping types — three over **ideas** (intangible: *who someone is*) and three over **interests** (tangible: *what someone has*).

- **Conflicts of IDEAS:**
 - **Nationalism** — devotion to one's nation over others; the link between **identity** and statehood. **Self-determination** (a nation should have its own state) constantly collides with **sovereignty/territorial integrity**.
 - **Ethnic conflict** — hatred between **ethnic groups**; based not on what someone *does* but **who they are**. Driven by **ethnocentrism** (in-group bias) and, at its worst, **dehumanisation** of the out-group (the step that removes the restraints on violence — e.g. animal names, WWII propaganda).
 - **Genocide** — the systematic extermination of a group; the extreme of dehumanisation.
 - **Religious conflict** — sharpest where **fundamentalist** movements reject **secular** rules (of the state and the international system) as subordinate to divine law.
 - **Ideological conflict** — often **less durable** than it looks (interests frequently drive the "ideological" clash).
- **Conflicts of INTEREST:**
 - **Territorial disputes** — over where **borders** run; especially intractable (states value home territory "fanatically"). **Irredentism** = regaining lost territory; **secession** = drawing a border around a *new* state (Kosovo 2008; South Sudan 2011).
 - **Control of governments** — over who runs an existing state.
 - **Economic conflict** — over trade, resources, money (often underlies the others — e.g. "conflict diamonds," the **Kimberley Process**).
 - (PG's *Russia–Ukraine* example shows all of these at once: *ethnic, religious, territorial (Crimea), and economic* — combining rather than separate.)

★ Synthesis — the two halves in one line

Core: the lecture's arc: **security is a political construction** (whose? from what? decided by whom — and *securitised* by whom), and **war has layered causes** (individual · domestic · systemic). The theories connect the halves: how you define **security** shapes what you count as a **cause of war** — a realist sees anarchy & power; a liberal sees failed cooperation; a constructivist sees threat-perceptions built through identity; a critical scholar asks whose security the whole conversation serves.

Cases & examples

- Kilis, Türkiye (2016) — a lethal cross-border military attack **not** called a "security" issue until it was politically useful. → *Illustrates: securitisation is political; naming a threat is a choice.*
- South China Sea — territorial + economic + strategic + military threats knotted together. → *Illustrates: threats overlap; the referent/threat you pick shapes the analysis.*
- Iran 1953 (Mosaddegh) — a coup to defend Western oil interests **framed as international security**. → *Illustrates: security as a creative repackaging of economic interest; the case for human security.*
- ICBL / landmines — non-state actors reframed landmines as a **human-security** harm → treaty + Nobel. → *Illustrates: the agency of non-state actors and the shift of referent from state to individual.*
- The fall of the Berlin Wall (1989) — realist security scholars couldn't even imagine it. → *Illustrates: the limits of a purely military, state-centric security lens (Gusterson).*

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Security (contested)	"Freedom from threats to core values" — but referent, threats & the state's role are all disputed
Referent object	Whose security: national/state · societal · human/individual · global
Securitisation (Wæver)	Framing an issue as an existential threat (a speech act) → moves it beyond normal politics
Security dilemma (Herz)	Self-help defence can be self-defeating (your build-up frightens others → arms race)
Human / common security	Referent = the individual / "us all" (vs the state)
Collective security vs alliance	Aggression against one = aggression against all (global) vs defence against an external enemy (NATO)
Tilly's four activities	War-making · state-making · protection · extraction ("the state as protection racket")
Levels of analysis / three images	Individual · domestic · systemic causes of war (Waltz 1959)
Irredentism / secession	Regaining lost territory / drawing a border around a new state
Ethnocentrism / dehumanisation	In-group bias / stripping the out-group of humanity (removes restraints on violence)

Exam pointers

- Explain why security is "contested" and **political** — use Kilis to show that *calling* something security is a choice.
- Lay out the referent-object table (national/societal/human/global) and show the **same event** looks different by referent.
- Define securitisation as a **speech act** and run the 5-step chain; give the **migration** or **climate** example and the *dangers* (beyond normal politics, "us vs them", militarisation).
- Contrast the **state as protector (Hobbes) vs war-maker (Tilly)** — reproduce Tilly's four activities.
- Run the four IR theories on security (realism/liberalism/constructivism/critical) on one crisis.
- Use the levels of analysis / three images to explain the outbreak of a war (individual **Fearon** · domestic **Putnam** · systemic **Waltz/anarchy**), and the **descriptive-vs-theoretical** (Franz Ferdinand = catalyst, not cause).
- Distinguish the types of war and the six conflict types (ideas vs interests) — with **Russia-Ukraine** as the "all at once" case.

Bridge. IR IV pulls the theory lectures (I–III) onto a single problem — **security & war** — and shows the payoff of theory choice: your theory decides *whose* security matters, *what* counts as a threat, and *why* war happens. It also links back to Tilly (the war-made state, PS Lecture 2) and forward to the **use of force** (PG ch.6).

★ Fun facts & memorable details (IR IV: International Security)

Sticky bits from international security.

- "**Security**" once meant *carelessness* — from Latin *securus* ("without worry"), and feeling **too** secure was considered a **flaw** (it made you drop your guard).
- **The rockets that "fell from the sky":** Türkiye refused to call a 5-month rocket barrage on **Kilis** a security threat — until it wanted to invade Syria. Same rockets, opposite label. Politics decides.
- **Tilly's one-liner:** "*war made the state, and the state made war*" — and his image of the early state as a **protection racket** (the deck jokes: not so different from **Don Corleone**).
- **The P5 veto exists because the US wanted one** — so the UN could never force it into an action it hadn't approved (the catch: any P5 can also block the US).
- **Collective security's first run was an accident:** the UN could act on **Korea (1950)** only because the **USSR was boycotting** the Security Council and wasn't there to veto.
- "**It's a boy**" and "**nuke-speak**" — Carol Cohn's evidence that even nuclear strategy is written in a **gendered** language that hides the human cost.
- **Realists didn't just miss the Berlin Wall — they couldn't imagine it** (Gusterson), which cracked realism's claim to "objective" security knowledge.
- **Climate change is "hard to securitise"** on purpose: there's **no "them"** — *we* are the threat, so the "us vs them" security reflex backfires.

Foreign Policymaking (EA)

Required reading: Ashbee, E. & Hurst, S. (2020), "*The Trump foreign policy record and the concept of transformational change*," *Global Affairs* 6(1): 5–19 · Putnam, R. (1988), "*Diplomacy and Domestic Politics: The Logic of Two-Level Games*," *International Organization* 42(3): 427–460 (to p.435). · Lecturer: Eddie Ashbee. (Putnam is CBS-library-only, not in the folder — the two-level-game section below is built from the deck + the standard framework; the win-set detail is the assigned part.)

Theme of the lecture. The IR theory lectures (I–IV) work mostly at the **international / state level** and treat what goes on *inside* a state as a "**black box**." This session **opens the box**: foreign policy is shaped by **domestic** as well as international variables, and the two **interact** — theorised through **neoclassical realism**, **Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA)**, and Putnam's "**two-level game**." The running case study is **US foreign policy since January 2017** — Trump and "Trumpism."

★ **The heart of the lecture:** foreign policy is **not** just a state responding to the international system — it is the **product of domestic politics interacting with international pressures**. IR's grand theories black-box the domestic; **FPA / neoclassical realism** open it, showing how **individuals, ideas, bureaucracies, interest groups and public opinion** shape policy. Putnam's **two-level game** models the interaction: a leader bargains **internationally (Level I)** and must get the deal **ratified at home (Level II)** at the same time. The **Trump** case tests whether a foreign-policy shift is "**transformational**" — a lasting change in **paradigm, interests, institutions and logics**.

The red thread. For any foreign-policy episode ask: *which domestic variables are in play, how do they interact with the international situation — and is the change transformational or just a passing shift?*

Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The "black box"** — why grand IR theory sidelines domestic politics.
- **Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) / neoclassical realism** — systemic pressures **filtered through** domestic intervening variables.
- **Domestic variables** — individuals · ideas/ideologies · bureaucratic cultures · interest groups & constituencies · public opinion (+ **salience**).
- **Transformational change** (Ashbee & Hurst) — a lasting shift in **paradigm · interests · institutions · logics**.
- **Embeddedness** — ideas rooted in supportive **interests + institutions** (weak embeddedness → only "proto-transformational").
- **Two-level game** (Putnam) — Level I (international bargaining) + Level II (domestic ratification); **win-sets**; the **Schelling conjecture**.

Opening the "black box" — why Foreign Policy Analysis? (deck)

Core: the main IR theories are **international- or state-level** — they largely **relegate or disregard** domestic processes, treating the state as a "**black box**" that responds to the system.

- **Structural realism (Waltz):** international relations are **anarchic**, trust is limited, so **any** state (autocracy or democracy) must **prioritise its own security & survival** and will act **if it has the capacities**. (*Domestic type*

barely matters.)

- **Liberal internationalism (Ikenberry)**: looks a little more inside — it cares about the **character of political systems** (democracies tend to avoid offensive wars — answerable to the public, tied by trade interdependence, cooperating through IOs; the tongue-in-cheek "**Golden Arches theory**" — no two countries with McDonald's fight). But it still doesn't examine **internal processes** closely.
- **Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) & neoclassical realism** open the box: foreign policy = the **interaction of international structure and domestic processes** — not one or the other.

Neoclassical realism — the bridge

Core: neoclassical realism keeps realism's **systemic** starting point (relative power, anarchy) but says those pressures are **filtered through domestic "intervening variables"** — leaders' perceptions, state–society relations, institutions — before they become policy. (*This is the neoclassical row of the realism family: "structure pushes, but domestic politics filters the push."*) → so **the same international pressure produces different policies** in different states, depending on the domestic filter. This is the theoretical warrant for spending the rest of the lecture on **domestic variables**.

★ Domestic variables that shape foreign policy (deck)

Core: five families of domestic variable — each a lens, none sufficient alone.

Variable	What it captures	Watch-outs / examples
Individuals / core actors	the " great man theory of history " (Carlyle: " <i>the history of the world is but the biography of great men</i> ") — leaders' beliefs, style, psychology	Trump (impulse control, short attention span). <i>But</i> focusing on individuals neglects structural forces (see below)
Ideas & ideologies ("belief systems")	the paradigm guiding policy — what problems/goals/instruments seem legitimate	Was Trump-I "standard Republican fare" (Reagan's "peace through strength") or a genuine break? (<i>the debate the reading settles</i>)
Bureaucratic cultures & sub-cultures	agencies' standing operating cultures; coalitions & factions inside the executive	State Dept vs Defense vs intelligence — "trade hawks" vs finance factions under Trump
Interest groups & constituencies	lobbying, campaigning, campaign contributions, the "revolving door" — and geographic constituencies (e.g. rust-belt states)	note instrumental power (direct lobbying) vs structural power (business's leverage over investment/jobs)
Public opinion	mass attitudes constraining leaders (e.g. Vietnam disengagement blamed on unpopularity)	★ salience : except in acute crisis or heavy losses , public engagement with foreign policy is usually LOW (Durant & Diehl 1989)

- **The structural counterweight (deck)**: an individual-only focus **underestimates context**. Trump's mercurial style was *enabled* by the **relative weakness of checks & balances** in the foreign-policy arena — plus deeper trends: **party polarisation, party homogenisation**, and a **populist shift**. (*Cf. Truman (1945–53) leading the US into international engagement — a mix of individual commitment + shifts in economic elites + strategic pressure from the USSR: several variables at once.*)

★ Case study — US foreign policy since 2017 (Ashbee & Hurst 2020)

| The paradigm Trump inherited

Core: to judge whether Trump is a *break*, you must know what he broke *from*. US foreign policy ran on Liberal Internationalism (LI) — itself the product of the **1940s transformation** — which then fragmented.

- Liberal Internationalism (LI) — after WWII the US committed to **open-ended international engagement + global leadership**, building the **UN, IMF, World Bank, GATT, NATO** and a domestic **national-security state** (National Security Act 1947 → DoD, Joint Chiefs, NSC, CIA). (*This is the reading's model of a completed transformation — see below.*)
- **Fragmentation from the 1970s:** LI split. Some (mainly **Democrats**) rejected the **use of force**; another grouping (mainly **Republicans**) rejected LI's **cooperative** side → **militant / conservative internationalism = primacism** (US primacy, "hard" power used **unilaterally** or in **coalitions of the willing**, sidelining the UN/multilateralism) **but** keeping a **moral purpose** — faith in **democracy & freedom** (Bush's Iraq war, democracy promotion, nation-building, regime change) and trade liberalisation. This paradigm **weakened from ~2006**.
- **2016 — MAGA:** a populist reaction to "**elite projects**" and perceived **US decline**, addressing both domestic and foreign policy.

| Trump's first term (2017–21) — the populist-nationalist break

Core: Trump = **primacism + economic nationalism + "principled realism"** — i.e. conservative internationalism **minus the moral purpose**. The reading distils a **populist-nationalist paradigm** of **five propositions**:

1. **The nation is core** — defined by **ethnicity/culture**, not ideals/principles (Bannon: "a nation with a culture — and a reason for being").
 2. **Zero-sum competition** — nations are locked in a **struggle for hegemony**; limited scope for cooperation (the 2017 National Security Strategy used "competition" **18 times**); the US has been "losing."
 3. **Anti-"globalism"** — the nation & its people have suffered from **globalism** and global elites ("the party of Davos").
 4. **Trade subordinated to the nation** — markets should serve national purposes; hostility to **NAFTA/TPP**; prefer **bilateral ("one-on-one") deals** where US preponderance wins; reject **multilateral** trade liberalisation.
 5. **Moral vision abandoned** — no more Reagan's "shining city" or Bush's freedom agenda; **rejects regime change / democracy promotion** ("we are not here to lecture").
- **In practice:** challenging **China**; **transactionalism**; negotiations with **Russia & North Korea**; **unilateralism**; **burden-sharing** demands on allies; doubts about collective security (NATO); **protectionism**.

| ★ Was it *transformational*? — the Ashbee & Hurst framework

Core: the paper's real contribution is a **precise definition of transformational change** (drawing on Polanyi, historical institutionalism, Skowronek). Transformational change = a **lasting** shift across **four** linked elements — not just dramatic-but-passing change.

Element	What must shift	LI (1940s) — the model	Trump (2017+) — the "first cut"
Paradigm	the framework of ideas/goals/instruments (Hall) — until new ideas become "common sense"	open-ended engagement & liberal world order	populist-nationalist paradigm (anti-globalism, bilateralism, no moral purpose) — but only "common sense" to the base
Interests	new interests grip power; new coalitions (Skowronek)	New-Deal coalition + "Wall Street" Republicans sideline isolationists	FP "establishment" & peak business sidelined ; GOP base shifts to non-college white workers
Institutions	formal & informal institutional re-ordering	UN/IMF/NATO + the national-security state	withdrawals (Paris, TPP, UNESCO, UN HR Council), undermining the WTO , gutting the State Dept/IC — <i>but</i> core alliances remain intact
Logics	new chains of events /incentives that endure (path dependence)	enduring collective-security commitments	weakened trans-Atlanticism; allies edge toward self-reliance ; TPP revived without the US

- ★ **The verdict:** applying the framework gives a **mixed picture** — the **beginnings of transformational change**, but **"incipient, partial and variegated."** The **ideational** shift is the most dramatic; institutional/interest shifts are real but **incomplete**; logics are hardest to read this early.

★ Embeddedness — why "proto-transformational"

Core: ideas only become a *lasting* transformation when they are **embedded** — i.e. **rooted in supportive interests and institutions** (so they outlive the leader). Trump's first-term primacism was **pursued inconsistently and weakly embedded** (he **marginalised** the national-security bureaucracy but did **not rebuild** it into a self-sustaining machine for the new paradigm) → only **"proto-transformational."**

- Two reasons it may not stick (reading):** (1) **populism is a "thin" ideology** (Mudde) — a **crust** on top of other ideologies, so the administration could be pulled **back** toward conservative/militant internationalism; (2) the US remains **locked into** its key post-war security institutions.

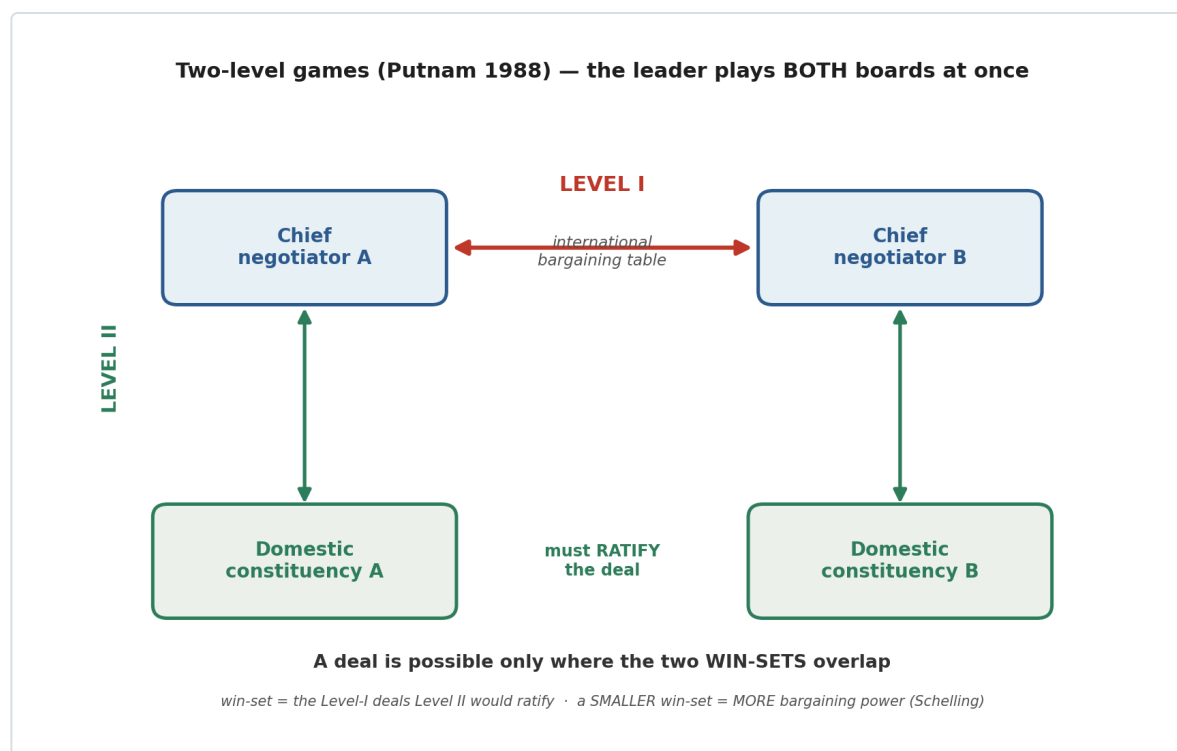
Second term (2025+) & the Democrats (*deck*)

- Trump II / the GOP:** no single guiding ideology — pulled between rival **ideational clusters**. But some **constants** ("floating ideas") cut across the divisions: **support for Israel** (note the role of **religious conservatism** in the party), **disdain for Europe** + support for "patriotic" forces; **2026** sees growing divisions (e.g. **Iran**).
- Democrats:** no clear foreign-policy orientation; Biden's "alliance of democracies" gained limited traction; continued **opposition to China** + **support for Ukraine**; increasingly **divided over Israel/Palestine (Gaza)** (DNC vs DSA); 2028 wide open.

★ How do domestic & international variables interact? — the two-level game (*Putnam 1988*)

Core: domestic and international variables clearly interact — but *on what terms?* (avoid analytical "ad-hocery"). Putnam's answer: an international negotiation is a **single game played simultaneously at two interconnected levels**.

- **Level I** = bargaining between the negotiators at the international table.
- **Level II** = separate discussions inside each country about whether to **ratify** what the negotiator brings home.
- The leader sits at **both boards at once**: a deal must be **struck internationally and ratifiable domestically**.



How to read it. The key concept is the win-set = *the set of all Level-I deals that would win ratification at Level II*. Two consequences:

- A deal is possible only where the two win-sets **overlap** — bigger win-sets make agreement **more likely** (but risk a deal your public dislikes).
- ★ **The Schelling conjecture (the counter-intuitive bit):** a smaller win-set can give a negotiator **more bargaining power** — "I'd love to accept, but my parliament will never ratify that" forces the other side to move. Being tied down at home is a **bargaining asset** abroad.
- **Defection:** a deal can fail through **voluntary** defection (a rational leader reneges) or **involuntary** defection (the leader *can't deliver* because ratification fails at home). → *domestic and international politics are **entangled**, not separate*.

| Or does the balance *vary*? (*deck*)

Core: an alternative to "it's always a two-level game" is that the **weight** of domestic vs international variables **varies systematically** — by:

- **Time-period** — domestic variables matter **less in acute crisis** (power centralises, the public rallies).

- **State size** — small states may have **fewer foreign-policy options** (more constrained by the system).
- **Regime type** — liberal democracies are arguably **more exposed to domestic pressures** than illiberal/authoritarian states.
- **Policy arena** — some issues draw **much more domestic engagement** — most notably **trade**.

Cases & examples

- **The 1940s Liberal-Internationalism transformation.** Paradigm (global leadership) + interests (New-Deal/Wall-Street coalition) + institutions (UN/IMF/NATO + national-security state) + enduring logics. → *Illustrates: a **completed** transformational change — the model Trump is measured against.*
- **Trump-era US foreign policy (2017+).** Populist-nationalist paradigm, sidelined establishment, withdrawals from agreements, gutted State Dept — but intact alliances. → *Illustrates: "**incipient, partial and variegated**" transformation; **weak embeddedness** → proto-transformational.*
- **Vietnam disengagement.** Blamed on rising unpopularity — but note **salience** (opinion bites mainly under heavy losses). → *Illustrates: **public opinion** as a domestic variable, and its limits.*
- **Truman & international engagement (1945–53).** Individual commitment + elite shifts + USSR pressure. → *Illustrates: foreign policy as several domestic + international variables interacting.*

Key terms

Term	Meaning
"Black box"	Grand IR theory treats the state's internal politics as unopened — inputs (system) → outputs (policy)
Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA)	The study of foreign policy as a product of domestic processes + international structure
Neoclassical realism	Systemic pressures filtered through domestic intervening variables (leaders, institutions)
Salience	How much the public actually attends to an issue (usually low for foreign policy)
Instrumental vs structural power	Direct lobbying vs business's leverage from control over investment/jobs
Transformational change	Lasting shift in paradigm · interests · institutions · logics (Ashbee & Hurst / Polanyi)
Embeddedness	Ideas rooted in supportive interests + institutions → they endure beyond the leader
Primacism	US primacy /preponderance as the organising aim of foreign policy
Two-level game (Putnam)	A negotiation played simultaneously at Level I (international) + Level II (domestic ratification)
Win-set	The set of Level-I deals that would be ratified at Level II; deals need overlapping win-sets
Schelling conjecture	A smaller win-set (tied hands at home) can mean more bargaining power abroad

Exam pointers

- Explain the "**black box**" critique and how **neoclassical realism** / **FPA** open it (systemic pressure **filtered through** domestic variables).
- List and apply the **five domestic variables** — and the **salience** caveat on public opinion.
- Define **transformational change** by its **four elements** (paradigm/interests/institutions/logics) and run it on **Trump** — verdict: "**incipient, partial and variegated**"; explain **embeddedness** and why Trump-I was only **proto-transformational**.
- Set out the **two-level game** (Level I/II, **win-sets**, the **Schelling conjecture**, voluntary vs involuntary defection).
- Give the **four ways the domestic–international balance may vary** (time/crisis, state size, regime type, policy arena — esp. **trade**).

Bridge. This lecture is the **hinge** between IR theory (I–IV) and real foreign-policy **practice**: the grand theories set the *international* stage, but **who a state actually is at home** — its leaders, ideas, bureaucracies, interests and publics — decides how it plays. The **two-level game** is the model of that interaction; **transformational change** is the yardstick for whether a shift will last.

★ Fun facts & memorable details (Foreign Policymaking)

Sticky bits from the foreign-policymaking lecture.

- **The "Golden Arches" theory of peace:** no two countries that both have **McDonald's** had ever fought a war (a jokey stand-in for the liberal claim that **trade interdependence** deters war).
- **"The history of the world is but the biography of great men"** (Carlyle, 1840) — the **great-man theory** the lecture uses to *set up* why leaders alone aren't enough.
- **Tied hands are a bargaining chip:** Putnam/Schelling's counter-intuitive point — "*my parliament will never ratify that*" can win you a **better** deal. Weakness at home = strength abroad.
- **The 2017 US National Security Strategy used the word "competition" 18 times** — the reading's neat evidence of the zero-sum, nationalist paradigm shift.
- **A "hostile takeover":** a departing senior diplomat described Trump's first-year State Department — "*you decapitate the leadership, you compartmentalize the power centers, you engender fear and suspicion.*"
- **Populism is a "thin" ideology** (Mudde) — a **crust** on top of other ideologies, which is why Ashbee & Hurst call Trump-I only "**proto-transformational**."
- **Japan revived the TPP *without* the US** after Trump pulled out — a real "changed logic": the world starts building around, not through, Washington.

PART III · THE EUROPEAN UNION AS A POLITICAL SYSTEM

EU I: The Evolution of the EU (AUW)

Required reading: McCormick, J. (2021), *Understanding the European Union: A Concise Introduction*, Palgrave Macmillan (pp. 45–66) · Wiener, A., Börzel, T. & Risse, T. (eds) (2019), *European Integration Theory*, 3rd ed.,

OUP (pp. 44–49 = neofunctionalism; pp. 64–70 = liberal intergovernmentalism).

Theme of the lecture. How did **six states cooperating after WWII** become a **deeply integrated regional political system** of (up to) 28? The lecture does two things: **(1)** tells the **story** — the twin processes of **deepening** (more policy areas, more shared authority) and **widening** (more member states), through treaties, bargains and crises; and **(2)** asks the **why** — explaining that story through the two great rival theories of integration, **neofunctionalism** (integration is driven by *spillover*) and **liberal intergovernmentalism** (integration is what *states bargain for*). It opens a new Part: the EU as a **political system** in its own right — neither an ordinary international organisation nor a state.

★ **The heart of the lecture:** European integration has advanced along **two dimensions** — **DEEPENING** (authority moves to the European level in more and more policy areas) and **WIDENING** (more states join). The **central question** is *why it developed this way*, and there are two rival answers: **neofunctionalism** — integration has an **autonomous, expansive logic** (*spillover*: integrating one area creates pressure to integrate the next); vs **liberal intergovernmentalism** — integration is a **controlled series of rational state bargains** (states form domestic preferences, bargain over the gains, and build institutions to lock in the deal).

Red thread: is integration a runaway process that outgrows what states intended (NF), or exactly what powerful states chose (LI)?

Key concepts to apply: *European integration* (Haas's definition) • *supranational vs intergovernmental* • *deepening vs widening* • *the Community method* • *the four freedoms / common market* • *spillover* (functional • political • cultivated) • *permissive consensus* → *politicization* • *national preferences* • *asymmetrical interdependence* • *credible commitments* • *pooling vs delegating sovereignty*.

What is European integration?

Core: integration is a **process** by which states **increasingly cooperate, create common rules and institutions, and exercise some authority jointly** — changing **where decisions are made, what states can do alone, and what they do together**. It is at once an **institutional** process (building common bodies) and a **political** one (contested, driven by interests and bargaining).

- **The classic definition — Haas (1958):** integration is "*a process whereby political actors in several distinct national settings are persuaded to shift their **loyalties, expectations and political activities toward a new centre, whose institutions possess or demand jurisdiction over the pre-existing national states.***" → Note the three things that move to the "new centre": **loyalties, expectations, activities**. (This definition is itself *neofunctionalist* — hold that thought for the theory section.)
- **Two faces of the process:** it is **institutional** (creating shared bodies with real authority) *and* **political** (about who wants what, and who bargains hardest). The EU is "the most developed example of this process in Europe."

| The EU: neither a typical international organization nor a state (*sui generis*)

Core: the EU is a **new kind of political animal** — it combines **supranational** and **intergovernmental** governance, so it fits neither box.

	Like this...	...but unlike this
vs an international organization	member states remain sovereign ; national governments keep major areas of authority	EU institutions exercise real authority where states have transferred or pooled it — ordinary IOs can't bind members this way
vs a state	it makes binding rules across a territory	there is no single European sovereign government replacing the member states

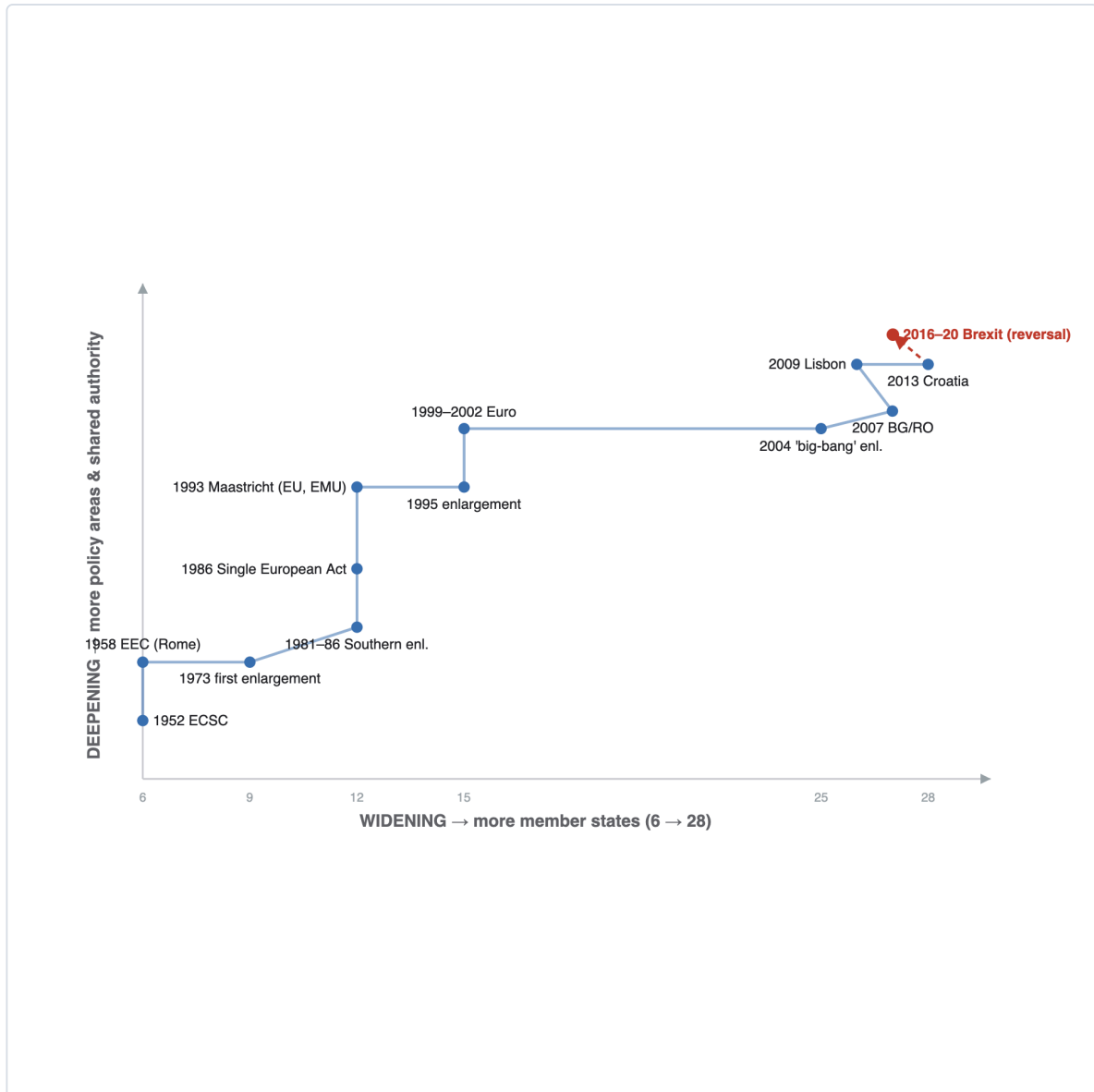
- The two logics it combines (the whole Part III in one distinction):
 - **Supranational** = authority **above** the states: common institutions (Commission, Court, Parliament, ECB) can make and enforce rules that bind members, sometimes by **majority** (so a state can be **outvoted**).
 - **Intergovernmental** = authority **between** the states: decisions taken by governments bargaining as sovereign equals, each keeping a **veto**.
 - *In plain terms*: in some policy areas Europe acts like a would-be federation (supranational); in others it's a club of sovereign states (intergovernmental). The EU is the **mix** — which is exactly why the two theories fight over how to read it.

★ Deepening & widening — the two dimensions of integration

Core: integration grows in **two directions at once**, and keeping them apart is the key analytical tool of the lecture (and the take-home exercise).

	DEEPENING	WIDENING
What grows	the scope & depth of integration — more policy areas become European; common institutions/rules gain more authority	the territory — more states join , so EU rules cover more ground
Direction	" vertical " — authority moves <i>upward</i> to the European level	" horizontal " — the club gets <i>bigger</i>
Examples	ECSC → EEC → single market → euro; each treaty pooling more	6 → 9 → 12 → 15 → 25 → 27 → 28 members

- They often happen together — e.g. the **Single European Act** (deepening: the single-market push) coincided with **Southern enlargement** (widening). And they can pull against each other: a **wider** EU of very diverse members is harder to **deepen** (more vetoes, more varied interests) — which is why treaties like **Nice (2001)** had to *reform the institutions* so a larger Union could still function.
- Integration can also go *backwards* — **Brexit is widening in reverse** (a member leaves). So the full set of possibilities is: **deepening · widening · both · contestation · disintegration**.



How to read it. Each dot is a milestone plotted by **how many members** the club had ($\rightarrow$ right = wider) and **how much authority** had moved to the European level ($\uparrow$ up = deeper). The path climbs **up-and-to-the-right**: the EU got **both deeper and wider** over 60 years — but not smoothly. Long **horizontal** stretches (e.g. 2004 "big-bang" enlargement) are *pure widening* — lots of new members, no new depth that year. **Vertical** jumps (**Maastricht 1992**, the **euro**) are *pure deepening* — same members, much more shared authority. The **red arrow** is **Brexit**: for the first time the path moves **left** — integration reversed. *Use this map to answer the take-home exercise: classify each event as deepening, widening, both, or reversal.*

Why did integration begin after WWII? (McCormick, ch. 3)

Reading: McCormick, *Understanding the European Union*, ch. 3 "The Evolution of the EU" (pp. 45–66).

Core: the EU was "**born out of the ruins of the Second World War**." Three post-war needs drove it — **economic reconstruction**, **security in the Cold War**, and **stopping European nationalism from causing a third war** — and the linchpin of the whole project was **Franco-German reconciliation**.

- **The three needs** (McCormick's frame): (1) rebuild shattered economies (agricultural output had **halved**); (2) provide **security** as the USSR loomed and the Cold War set in; (3) **tame nationalism** — the nation-

state was "discredited by the war."

- **Franco-German reconciliation = the master key.** The belief: if the two historic enemies could be bound together, broader integration could follow. This is why the first step was **coal and steel** — "the building blocks of industry" and the base of German (Ruhr) power: pooling them made West Germany **reliant on trade with its neighbours** and eased **French fear** of German industrial revival.
- **The American scaffolding** (integration was "underwritten by the US"):
 - **Marshall Plan (1948–51):** ~\$12.5 bn (~\$132 bn in 2020 money) of US aid via the **OEEC (Paris)** — it "encouraged European governments to work together" and highlighted their economic interdependence.
 - **NATO (1949):** the security shield ("an attack on one = an attack on all") under which integration could safely proceed.
- **The false start — defence first (and why it failed).** An ambitious **European Defence Community (EDC)** + political community was proposed (1950) but **the French National Assembly rejected the EDC in 1954** (no British support; French fear of German rearmament; national humiliation at **Dien Bien Phu**).
→ *Lesson the founders learned: integrate through low-politics economics first* (Monnet's "step by step through concrete achievements"), not high-politics defence. (*This is exactly the sequence neofunctionalism theorises.*)
- **Suez (1956)** hammered the point home: Britain and France discovered they were **no longer world powers**, and Britain began to "look to Europe."

★ The evolution timeline — deepening & widening in action

Core: the whole story on one page. Read each row as **deepening** (authority moves up) or **widening** (members join) — the diagram above plots it.

Year	Milestone	D/W
1950	Schuman Declaration (9 May; now <i>Europe Day</i>) — pool Franco-German coal & steel	—
1951/52	Treaty of Paris → ECSC (the Six); first supranational transfer of powers	Deepen
1957/58	Treaties of Rome → EEC + Euratom ; goal of a common market in 12 yrs	Deepen
1968	Customs union declared; Common Agricultural Policy (CAP)	Deepen
1965–66	Empty-chair crisis (de Gaulle) → Luxembourg Compromise affirms the national veto	(<i>stall</i>)
1973	First enlargement : UK, Ireland, Denmark (Norway says no)	Widen
1979	Direct elections to the European Parliament	Deepen
1981 / 1986	Southern enlargement : Greece (1981); Spain & Portugal (1986)	Widen
1986/87	Single European Act — complete the single market by 1992	Deepen
1992/93	Maastricht Treaty → the " European Union " (pillars, EMU, citizenship)	Deepen
1995	Austria, Finland, Sweden join	Widen
1999 / 2002	The euro — electronic 1999, notes & coins 2002	Deepen
1997 / 2001	Treaties of Amsterdam (Schengen into EU law) & Nice (institutional prep)	Deepen
1993 / 2004 / 07 / 13	Copenhagen criteria (1993); " big-bang " East (2004, 10 states); Bulgaria/Romania (2007); Croatia (2013 → 28)	Widen
2005 → 2009	Constitutional Treaty rejected (France, NL) → salvaged as the Treaty of Lisbon (2009)	Deepen
2016 / 2020	Brexit referendum (2016) → UK leaves (2020)	Reverse

From coal & steel to a common market (1950–68)

Core: integration began **narrow and sectoral** (coal + steel) and **expanded outward** into a general common market — the pattern neofunctionalists call spillover.

- **The Schuman Declaration (9 May 1950)** — drafted with **Jean Monnet**, announced by foreign minister **Robert Schuman**: place French & German coal and steel under a **common High Authority**, "a first step in the federation of Europe," making war between them "not merely unthinkable, but **materially impossible**."
- **ECSC (Treaty of Paris 1951; began 1952)**. The **Six** — **France, West Germany, Italy, Belgium, the Netherlands, Luxembourg** — created the **first supranational** body (High Authority under Monnet, + Council, Assembly, Court). Modest powers, but it "**proved a point about the feasibility of integration**."
- **Treaties of Rome (1957) → EEC + Euratom (1958)**. The same Six commit to a **common market** within 12 years (free movement of **people, money, services** + common external tariff), plus common **agriculture, trade, transport** policy. The Assembly becomes the **European Parliament** (1962).
- **The customs union (1968)** formed *ahead* of schedule, and the **CAP** created a single agricultural market with guaranteed farm prices. → *This early momentum looked like a vindication of neofunctionalism.*
- **But the state struck back:** the **1965–66 empty-chair crisis** — **de Gaulle** boycotted the Council over Commission power, voting and the budget — was resolved by the **Luxembourg Compromise**, which **affirmed the national veto**. → *The first big evidence for the intergovernmental side.*

| The enlargements — widening from 6 to 28

Core: the club grew in **waves**, each changing the EU's character; from the East it came with **conditionality** (the Copenhagen criteria).

- **1973 — first enlargement: UK, Ireland, Denmark.** Britain had stayed out (championing the looser **EFTA**, 1960), applied late, and was **vetoed twice by de Gaulle** (1963, 1967) — who feared British membership meant **US influence** — before finally joining after he resigned. **Norway's** electorate said no (as it would again in 1994).
- **1981/86 — Southern enlargement: Greece, then Spain & Portugal**, anchoring their **new democracies** after dictatorship. Doubling to **12 members reduced Franco-German dominance** and shifted the internal economic balance.
- **1995 — Austria, Finland, Sweden** (rich EFTA states).
- **The Copenhagen criteria (1993)** — the conditions for (mainly Eastern) applicants: (a) stable **democracy**, human rights, rule of law; (b) a functioning **market economy**; (c) capacity to adopt the **acquis communautaire** (the whole existing body of EU law). → *Enlargement wasn't just adding territory; it drove domestic change in applicants — "conditionality."*
- **2004 "big-bang" — 10 states** (Cyprus, Malta + 8 post-communist: Czechia, Estonia, Hungary, Latvia, Lithuania, Poland, Slovenia, Slovakia); **2007** Bulgaria & Romania; **2013** Croatia → **28 members, ~500 m people**. Symbolically, the **end of the Cold War division of Europe**. (Candidates today: Albania, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Serbia, Turkey.)

| Deepening: the single market, Maastricht & the euro

Core: from the mid-1980s integration went **political**, not just economic — the single market, then a genuine Union with a **single currency**.

- **Single European Act (1986/87)** — the first big treaty change since Rome: complete the **single market by 31 Dec 1992** (scrap customs/passport controls, harmonise standards, mutual recognition of qualifications), new powers on **environment, R&D, regional** policy, and made **EMU an objective**. (*Related but separate: the Schengen Agreement (1985) abolished internal border controls — folded into EU law by Amsterdam.*)
- **Maastricht Treaty (1992/93) → "the European Union."** The turning point from *Community* to *Union*:
 - a **three-pillar** structure — (1) the European Community; (2) **Common Foreign & Security Policy**; (3) **Justice & Home Affairs** (*pillars 2–3 = intergovernmental; abolished by Lisbon*);
 - the **Delors plan for Economic & Monetary Union** confirmed;
 - **EU citizenship** created; new EP powers (**codecision**).
 - Integration was now **"increasingly political as well as economic."**
- **The euro** — electronic **1999**, notes & coins **2002**; adopted by all but **Denmark, Sweden, the UK**. Members give up **national monetary policy** and become deeply interdependent — "a clear example of **deepening**."
- **Amsterdam (1997/99)** brought Schengen into EU law and expanded EP powers; **Nice (2001/03)** resized the institutions to **prepare for a much larger membership** — because the EU was becoming **both deeper and wider** while its institutions "had been designed for a smaller, less integrated system."
- **Constitutional Treaty → Lisbon.** A 2004 **Constitution** was **killed by referendums in France & the Netherlands (2005)** — founding members. Most of it was salvaged in the **Treaty of Lisbon (2009)**: a permanent **European Council President**, a **High Representative** for foreign affairs (+ diplomatic service), **pillars abolished**, more **QMV** (but the **veto kept** for foreign/defence policy & tax), a single EU legal

personality, and — for the first time — an explicit **right to leave** (Article 50). → *The 2005 rejection shows integration "depends on **domestic political agreement** and can encounter resistance."*

| From "permissive consensus" to politicization — and the era of crisis

Core: early integration was quietly **elite-driven**; from the 1990s it became **loudly contested** — and from the late 2000s the EU hit a cascade of overlapping crises.

- **The shift** (a key exam concept): the old "**permissive consensus**" — publics barely noticed, elites decided (recall neofunctionalism's assumption) — broke down after the **Danish "no" to Maastricht (1992)**. Integration became **politicized**, tied to hot issues: **economic distribution, national sovereignty, migration & borders, identity**. Enter **Euroscepticism**.
- **The "polycrisis"** (Juncker's word) / McCormick's **Seven Crises**, roughly in order:
 1. the **Constitutional Treaty** failure (2005);
 2. the **global financial crisis** (from 2007, imported from the US housing crash);
 3. the **euro / sovereign-debt crisis** (from 2009 — Greece's deficit at ~13% vs the 3% limit; bailouts by the EU/ECB/IMF conditional on **austerity**; riots in Athens; "Grexit" fears);
 4. the **rule-of-law crisis** (**Hungary & Poland** — judicial capture, Orbán's authoritarian turn);
 5. the **refugee crisis** (from the **Syrian war**; 2014–15 surge; west–east splits; the EU–**Turkey** deal);
 6. **Brexit** (below);
 7. the **Covid-19 pandemic** (2020) — the only crisis with no EU-internal cause, yet a severe test of united action.
- These crises "became **moments in which the scope, limits and distribution** of European cooperation were **contested**." (*Great material for the theories: each crisis can be read as spillover pressure or as an interstate distributional bargain.*)

| Brexit — integration in reverse

Core: in **June 2016** UK voters chose to **leave** (**52%–48%**, 72% turnout); the UK formally left in **January 2020**. Brexit proves European integration is **not one-directional** — the possibilities include **deepening, widening, contestation, and disintegration**.

- **What it revealed** (McCormick): Leave support was **highest among older, less-educated voters**; it rode **low public knowledge of the EU** ("verifiably false claims" in the campaign) and broader forces — declining faith in government, people "left out" of integration's gains, and a **rejection of globalization**. It cost two PMs (Cameron, May) and triggered a constitutional crisis; Scotland, NI and London voted Remain.
- **Two readings:** either a **warning** of the costs of abandoning the EU (Britain "weaker outside than in") and a chance for the remaining 27 to **deepen** (e.g. defence) — *or*, more darkly (Bellamy & Castiglione), a sign of "**fragmentation and political disintegration**."

★ Why does European integration happen? — two rival theories

Core: the lecture's *explanatory* half. There are **two families** of explanation, and they disagree fundamentally about **what drives integration and who is in control**.

	Neofunctionalism (Haas)	Liberal Intergovernmentalism (Moravcsik)
One-line claim	integration is the result of spillover	integration is the result of member-state governments pursuing the national interest
Who's in charge?	elites, interest groups, firms, supranational institutions	states — "masters of the treaty"
Is it automatic?	semi-automatic & expansive — one step forces the next	deliberate & controlled — states choose each step

*The sharpest contrast: neofunctionalism says integration develops an **autonomous logic that pulls sovereignty upward beyond what states intended**; LI says integration is **exactly what powerful states intended** — a controlled sequence of bargains. Everything below fills in these two pictures. (Readings: neofunctionalism ch. by Niemann, Lefkofridi & Schmitter; LI ch. by Moravcsik & Schimmelfennig — each theory presented by its own proponents.)*

Neofunctionalism — integration through spillover (Haas 1958)

Reading: Wiener et al., ch. on Neofunctionalism (pp. 44–49). Founder: **Ernst B. Haas**, *The Uniting of Europe* (1958), written to explain the **ECSC**; revised by **Leon Lindberg**, **Philippe Schmitter**, Scheingold. Intellectual root: **functionalism** (David Mitrany).

Résumé. Neofunctionalism is an "**approach**" (Haas's own word) that explains the **dynamics of integration once it has started** — deliberately *not* why it began or who joins. Its big idea: integration is **driven forward by its own consequences**. Cooperating in one sector creates problems, interests and institutions that generate **pressure to integrate further** — the process "**spills over**" from sector to sector, semi-automatically, carried by **elites and supranational bureaucrats** rather than mass publics. It is **transformative**: it changes actors' very **loyalties and expectations**, pulling them toward the "new centre."

Core: integration is **incremental, elite-driven, positive-sum, and self-expanding**. Actors "**stumble**" from one decision to the next — often "under the pressure of crises and impending deadlines" — and each step creates the conditions for the next.

- **Main actors:** national and supranational **elites**, interest associations, firms, political parties — and crucially the "**Eurocrats**" (Commission / the ECSC's High Authority) who can become **agents of further integration**. *Not* just governments.
- **Core assumptions** (the driving forces):
 - actors are **self-interested but can learn and change their preferences** as they experience the benefits of cooperation;
 - integration is **incremental** → produces **unintended consequences** that require more integration to fix;
 - regional institutions, once created, **acquire autonomy** and push for more integration (they "**seek more autonomy**");
 - integration is **positive-sum** — the "supranational style" means no unconditional vetoes; instead an "**upgrading of common interests**" (package deals that expand the common ground);
 - growing **economic interdependence** means functional problems can't be solved within national borders.

SPILLOVER — the master concept, in three types

Core: **spillover** = the tendency for integration in one area to **create pressures to integrate in others**. Haas's "**expansive logic of sector integration**": integrating one sector "begets its own impetus toward extension of

the entire economy." It comes in **three forms** — learn to name and distinguish them:

Type	Who/what drives it	Mechanism (how the pressure is created)
Functional spillover	the technical interdependence of sectors	integrating one sector creates practical problems solvable only by integrating the adjacent sector — integration expands almost mechanically outward
Political spillover	national elites & interest groups	actors affected by integration shift their expectations, lobbying and loyalties to the European level; repeated contact breeds " bureaucratic interpenetration " and socialization
Cultivated spillover	supranational institutions (Commission / High Authority)	the "Eurocrats" actively broker more integrative deals — " splitting the difference " and " upgrading common interests " — cultivating further integration

- **Common logic:** *existing* integration generates pressures — functional, political, and cultivated — that **push the process further**. (Deck discussion: **free movement of workers** is already integrated → what new problems does it create? An Austrian professional living, working, paying taxes and retiring in **Portugal** needs integrated **social security, tax, pension, healthcare and qualification-recognition** rules → integration spills into all of those.)
- **Where it went wrong (be able to say this).** Neofunctionalism looked **vindicated** into the mid-1960s (ECSC → EEC/Euratom; the customs union formed *ahead* of schedule; the CAP). Then the "**empty chair**" crisis (1965–66): French President **de Gaulle** paralysed the Community and the **Luxembourg Compromise** (1966) restored the **national veto** — directly contradicting the assumption of **automaticity**. Haas himself later called the theory "**obsolescent**" (1976). It **revived in the mid-1980s** with the single-market push (and is used again to explain the euro crisis — see below).

Liberal Intergovernmentalism — states bargain (Moravcsik 1998)

Reading: Wiener et al., ch. on Liberal Intergovernmentalism (pp. 64–70). Founder: **Andrew Moravcsik**, *The Choice for Europe* (1998); roots in **Stanley Hoffmann's** intergovernmentalism (1966). Today LI is the field's "**baseline**" theory — the standard everyone tests against.

Résumé. LI is the great **state-centric** rival. Its blunt claim: integration is "**a series of rational choices made by national leaders**." States remain "**masters of the treaty**"; the EU is best seen as "**an international regime for policy coordination**." But LI is **not realism** — it takes **domestic economic interests** seriously and treats institutions as useful. Its power is a clean **three-stage model** of how any integration decision is made.

Core: two assumptions — (1) states are the **critical, unitary actors** (bargaining as sovereign equals, no central authority above them); (2) they are **boundedly rational** (they calculate costs/benefits and pick the option that maximises utility). From these follows the three-stage sequence, **each stage explained by a separate theory:**

Stage	The question	The theory / mechanism
1 · National preferences	<i>what does each state want?</i>	a liberal theory: preferences are issue-specific , set by domestic economic & societal interests (producers vs taxpayers), <i>not</i> a single goal like "security"
2 · Interstate bargaining	<i>what deal gets struck, and who gains?</i>	an intergovernmental theory: hard bargaining over the distribution of gains; power comes from asymmetrical interdependence
3 · Institutional choice	<i>why build/empower institutions?</i>	a regime theory: institutions lock in credible commitments and cut transaction costs

- **Stage 1 — national preferences (the "liberal" bit).** What a government wants is **built from the bottom up** out of domestic interests — and it's **issue-specific** (agriculture ≠ environment ≠ defence). Empirically, Moravcsik found state preferences on integration reflected **concrete economic interests** (esp. the post-war shift to intra-industry trade) far more than Cold-War security or "European ideals."
- **Stage 2 — interstate bargaining & asymmetrical interdependence (the key mechanism).** Preferences rarely match, so states **bargain hard** over how to split the gains — with **credible veto threats, side-payments, and threats of exclusion**. Bargaining power comes from **asymmetrical interdependence**: *In plain terms* — the state that needs the deal **least** is the **most powerful**, because it can most credibly walk away (its "**outside option**" is better). Big, less-dependent states dominate; outcomes tend toward the **lowest common denominator**. (*Direct shot at neofunctionalism*: LI says supranational "ideational entrepreneurs" like Monnet or Delors are **not** a fundamental cause — Commission mediation is a mere convenience, "no more than... airplanes, email, texts, or telephones.")*
- **Stage 3 — why create institutions? credible commitments.** States **pool** sovereignty (e.g. **qualified-majority voting**) or **delegate** it (to the **Commission, ECB, ECJ**) not because they lose control but to make their **commitments credible** — to stop each other **defecting** from the deal later (a **prisoner's-dilemma** fix). Institutions cut transaction costs, share information, monitor compliance. **The twist**: for LI the EU's supranational bodies are **weak and endogenous** (tiny budget, no coercion, rules enforced by *national* officials); the *real* guarantee of commitment is **domestic** — empowering national executives, courts and pro-deal groups.
- **Critiques of LI (be able to say this):** it explains the **grand treaty bargains** (Rome, SEA, Maastricht) well but is weak on **day-to-day EU politics**; it treats **institutions too thinly** (as mere instruments), underplaying how they feed back and reshape interests; and the **unitary-state** assumption flattens messy domestic pluralism.

★ Worked case — the eurozone / sovereign-debt crisis, explained twice

Core: the deck's payoff: take **one event** — the crisis producing new European-level coordination — and show how **each theory explains the same facts differently**. This is the exam template (claim → mechanism → evidence → how the *other* theory would explain it).

	Neofunctionalist reading	Liberal-intergovernmentalist reading
What drove the response	a functional gap in EMU's design created spillover pressure	member states bargained over who pays
The mechanism	monetary policy was pooled at the supranational level while fiscal policy stayed national — this discrepancy generated integrative pressure to close the gap	states calculated costs/benefits and did hard bargaining over bailouts, rescue funds and the Fiscal Compact
Key actors	BusinessEurope lobbied for more integration; financial markets signalled the same; the Commission, Parliament and even the ECB pushed for more (the ECB "breached the impartiality rule" to demand a Banking Union)	a Northern vs Southern coalition, each answering to its own citizens; the Northern bloc had more bargaining power
The outcome	crisis + deadlines → incremental deepening (Banking Union), institutions seeking more autonomy	the North delayed support to force the South to accept the Fiscal Compact (more monitoring) → EMU deepened via budget control / European Semester

- **Why the case is powerful:** the **same deepening** (tighter EMU) is read by NF as **spillover** (the logic of EMU forced the next step) and by LI as a **distributional bargain** (the powerful creditor states extracted austerity in exchange for rescue). Neither is obviously "wrong" — which is the point of having **two theories**. (*Take-home: run the same four-step analysis on EU defence integration.*)

★ Neofunctionalism vs Liberal Intergovernmentalism — compared

Dimension	Neofunctionalism	Liberal Intergovernmentalism
Founder / key work	Haas, <i>The Uniting of Europe</i> (1958)	Moravcsik, <i>The Choice for Europe</i> (1998)
Key actors	elites, interest groups, firms, supranational institutions	states (unitary, boundedly rational) — "masters of the treaty"
What drives integration	spillover (functional + political + cultivated) — incremental, semi-automatic	rational state choices: domestic preferences → bargaining → institutions
Supranational institutions	autonomous engines that reshape national interests	endogenous instruments to make commitments credible
Logic of bargaining	positive-sum , "upgrading common interests"	distributive hard bargaining , lowest common denominator
Loyalties shift upward?	yes — toward a "new centre"	no — states keep preeminence & legitimacy
Explains well	the expansive early phase (ECSC → EEC), day-to-day "creep," arguably the euro crisis	the grand treaty bargains (Rome, SEA, Maastricht)
Explains badly	the empty-chair crisis / de Gaulle , stagnation, the return of the veto	everyday politics , autonomous supranational agency, institutional feedback

- **The takeaway for essays:** don't treat them as right/wrong but as **two lenses**. Neofunctionalism is strongest where integration seems to **outrun** what governments planned (spillover, unintended consequences, the Commission's creep); LI is strongest at the **big set-piece treaty moments** where you can see governments **bargaining hard over the terms**. A good answer names **which phenomenon** each explains best — and uses the eurozone case to show the same event through both.

★ Fun facts & memorable details (EU I: Evolution)

Sticky bits from the first EU lecture.

- **The EU began with *coal and steel* on purpose.** Placing the raw materials of war under a common authority (Schuman, 1950) was meant to make another Franco-German war "**materially impossible**" — peace engineered through economics.
- **Spillover means the EU "stumbles" forward.** Haas's actors don't march to a master plan — they "**stumble from one decision to another**," often "under the pressure of **crises and impending deadlines**." Integration by muddling through.
- **Haas fired his own theory.** After de Gaulle's empty chair broke the spell, the founder of neofunctionalism pronounced it "**obsolescent**" (1976) — only for it to stage a comeback in the 1980s.
- **Moravcsik's great put-down of the Commission:** supranational mediators are no more a *cause* of EU bargains than "**airplanes, email, texts, or telephones**" — useful logistics, not the driving force.
- **The EU is astonishingly *small* as a state-like thing:** an administration "**barely the size of a European city of a million people**," ~2% of European public spending, and **no coercive capacity** — most EU law is enforced by **national** officials. (LI's proof that states stay in charge.)
- **"Masters of the treaty"** — LI's memorable label for the member states: whatever Brussels does, the governments still hold the pen (they wrote the treaties and can rewrite them).
- **Brexit made a theoretical point real:** integration is **not one-directional**. The arrow can point **left**.

EU II: Institutions of the EU (AUW)

Required reading: Bulmer, Parker, Bache, George & Burns (2020), *Politics in the European Union*, OUP — **ch. 12, "The Institutional Architecture."** (△ *Built deck-first: the reading PDF was not in the upload, so the section-by-section rests on the lecture deck + standard institutional facts. Drop the Bulmer chapter into Module 2/ and I'll do an enrichment pass — the reading adds detail on inter-institutional cooperation/conflict and the multi-level governance framing.*)

Theme of the lecture. This lecture maps the **institutional and legal machinery** behind the EU's **multi-level governance**: *who does what* (propose, decide, implement, enforce), *how* a decision becomes binding EU law, and *why* the shape of the architecture matters — it varies by policy area and it is exactly where the two theories from EU I (liberal intergovernmentalism vs neofunctionalism) fight it out. Three questions structure it: **Where is EU authority?** • **How does the EU make & enforce decisions?** • **Why does the architecture matter?**

★ **The heart of the lecture:** EU authority is **pooled, delegated and shared** across levels (EU ↔ member state) and across **bodies that each represent a different interest**. The "typical" way a law is made: **Commission proposes → Parliament + Council co-decide** (the Ordinary Legislative Procedure,

usually by Qualified Majority) → member states implement → Commission + CJEU enforce. But this model **changes across policy areas** (some stay intergovernmental, e.g. foreign policy) and membership is **differentiated** (euro, Schengen).

Red thread: the split between **supranational** bodies (Commission · Parliament · CJEU) and **intergovernmental** bodies (European Council · Council) is the institutional form of the **neofunctionalism-vs-LI** debate.

Key concepts to apply: *pooled / delegated / shared authority · supranational vs intergovernmental bodies · the right of initiative · Ordinary Legislative Procedure (co-decision) · Qualified Majority Voting (55% / 65%) · conferral · subsidiarity · proportionality · exclusive / shared / supporting competence · regulations · directives · decisions · positive vs negative integration · mutual recognition (Cassis de Dijon) · differentiated integration.*

Where is EU authority?

Core: there is **no single sovereign** in the EU. Authority to **propose, decide, implement and enforce** is **distributed** — **pooled** (states decide together), **delegated** (handed to a common body), and **shared** — across **two levels** and several bodies.

- **Two levels:**
 - **EU level:** European Council · European Commission · Council of the EU · European Parliament · Court of Justice of the EU (CJEU).
 - **Member-state level:** national **governments · legislatures · administrations · courts.**
- *In plain terms:* the EU isn't a government sitting "above" the states; it's a **system** in which the same task (making and enforcing a rule) is split among European bodies *and* national ones. This is what "**multi-level governance**" means.

The five EU bodies — each represents a different interest

Core: the genius (and the tension) of the design: each institution is built to **represent a different constituency**, so EU decisions have to reconcile them. Learn this table cold — it's the backbone of the whole lecture.

Body	Who sits there	Whose interest it represents	Core role
European Council	heads of state/government (27) + its President + Commission President	national governments — the top political level	sets strategic direction (not a legislator)
Council of the EU ("the Council")	national ministers (by policy area)	member-state governments	co-legislates ; coordinates national policy
European Parliament (EP)	directly elected MEPs	EU citizens	co-legislates + oversight
European Commission	Commissioners + the EU civil service	the Union-wide general interest	proposes law; implements ; enforces
CJEU	judges	the EU legal order	interprets & adjudicates EU law
(<i>watchdog</i>) Court of Auditors	auditors	sound use of EU money	audits EU finances

- The **supranational / intergovernmental split** (keep it in view for the theory section): **Commission • EP • CJEU** are **supranational** (they serve the Union as a whole, above the states); **European Council • Council** are **intergovernmental** (they *are* the states). Every EU decision is a negotiation between these two logics.

The basic architecture — the flow of a decision

Core: the bodies fit together in a **rough sequence**: direction → proposal → decision → implementation → enforcement.

```

European Council → sets broad political direction
      ↓
European Commission → proposes legislation
      ↓
Council + European Parliament → adopt EU legislation
      ↓
Member-state administrations → implement legislation
      ↓
Commission + CJEU + national courts → monitor, interpret & enforce

```

European Council — governments set the direction

Core: the **summit of national leaders**. It is the EU's **political compass**, not its legislature — it decides *where the Union is going*, and unblocks the biggest fights.

- **Who:** the **heads of state or government of the 27**, plus the **European Council President** and the **Commission President**. (*Don't confuse it with the Council of the EU — ministers — or the Council of Europe, a separate non-EU human-rights body from EUI.*)
- **What it does:** defines **broad political priorities**; provides **strategic direction**; **resolves major political disagreements** that ministers can't; gives "**political impetus**" to integration.

- **Why it's the intergovernmental heart:** it is literally the **national governments** in the room. In an LI reading, this is where the states — the "masters of the treaty" — steer.

European Commission — the engine of EU policy

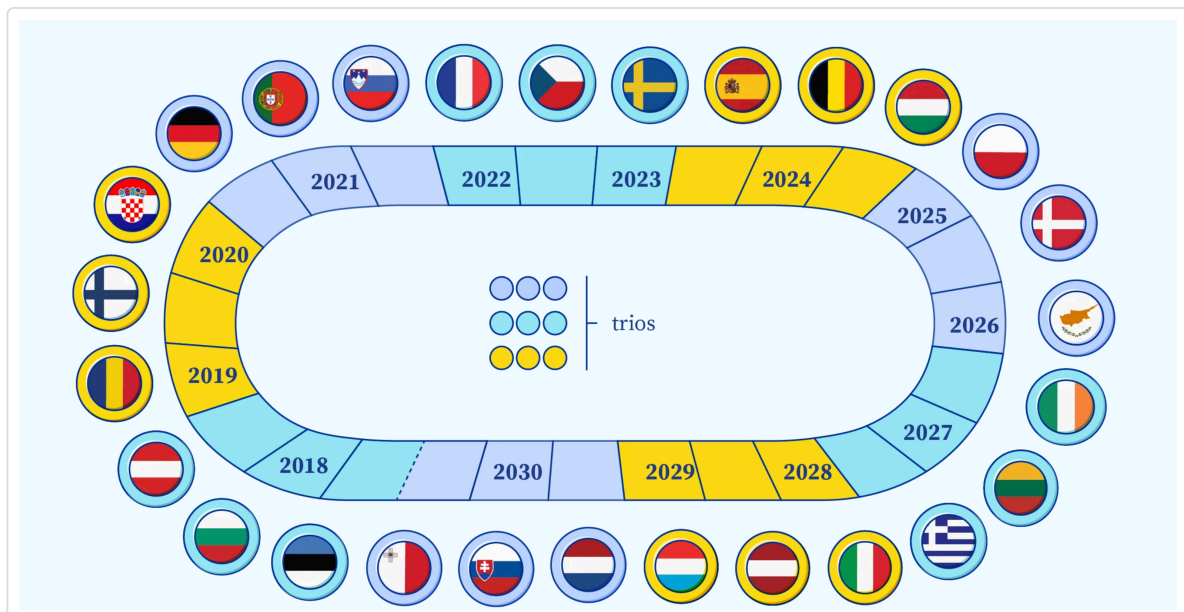
Core: the EU's **executive and its motor**. Crucially, it holds the **right of initiative** — it **proposes** almost all EU legislation — and then **implements** and **polices** it. It represents the **Union-wide interest**, not any one country.

- **Four jobs** (PROPOSE · EXECUTE · ENFORCE · REPRESENT):
 1. **Proposes** — **initiates most EU legislation** and develops policy (the **right of initiative** — a huge power: it sets the agenda).
 2. **Executes** — manages EU **programmes and funding**; implements policy.
 3. **Enforces** — monitors compliance and can launch **infringement proceedings** against a state that breaks EU law.
 4. **Represents** — speaks for the EU **internationally** where it has competence (e.g. trade).
- **Why it's the supranational engine:** its whole job is to think for the **Union as a whole**. In a neofunctionalist reading, the Commission is the "**cultivated spillover**" actor — the Eurocrat that pushes integration forward.

Council of the EU — member states as legislators

Core: the **national ministers**, acting as the EU's **other legislative chamber** (alongside the EP). It is **not one fixed group of people** — it changes membership by topic.

- **Who / configurations:** **national ministers** meet in different **configurations by policy area** — Agriculture, Environment, Finance (ECOFIN), Competitiveness, etc. The relevant minister shows up for the relevant dossier.
- **What it does:** represents **member-state governments**; **co-legislates** with the EP; coordinates national policies; decides by **agreed voting rules** (usually **QMV**).
- **The rotating presidency** — in "**trios**." The chair of the Council rotates among member states every **6 months**, organised into **trios** of three countries that plan an 18-month programme together.



How to read it. The presidency isn't a person or a permanent seat — it **passes around the member states**, three at a time. Each **trio** (one colour) coordinates an 18-month agenda so priorities carry across the three six-month chairs. It's a concrete emblem of the Council's **intergovernmental, member-state-driven** character.

- **The Council is more than the ministers** (a key exam point): most of the real work happens **below** the ministers, among **diplomats and officials**, *before* ministers ever meet:

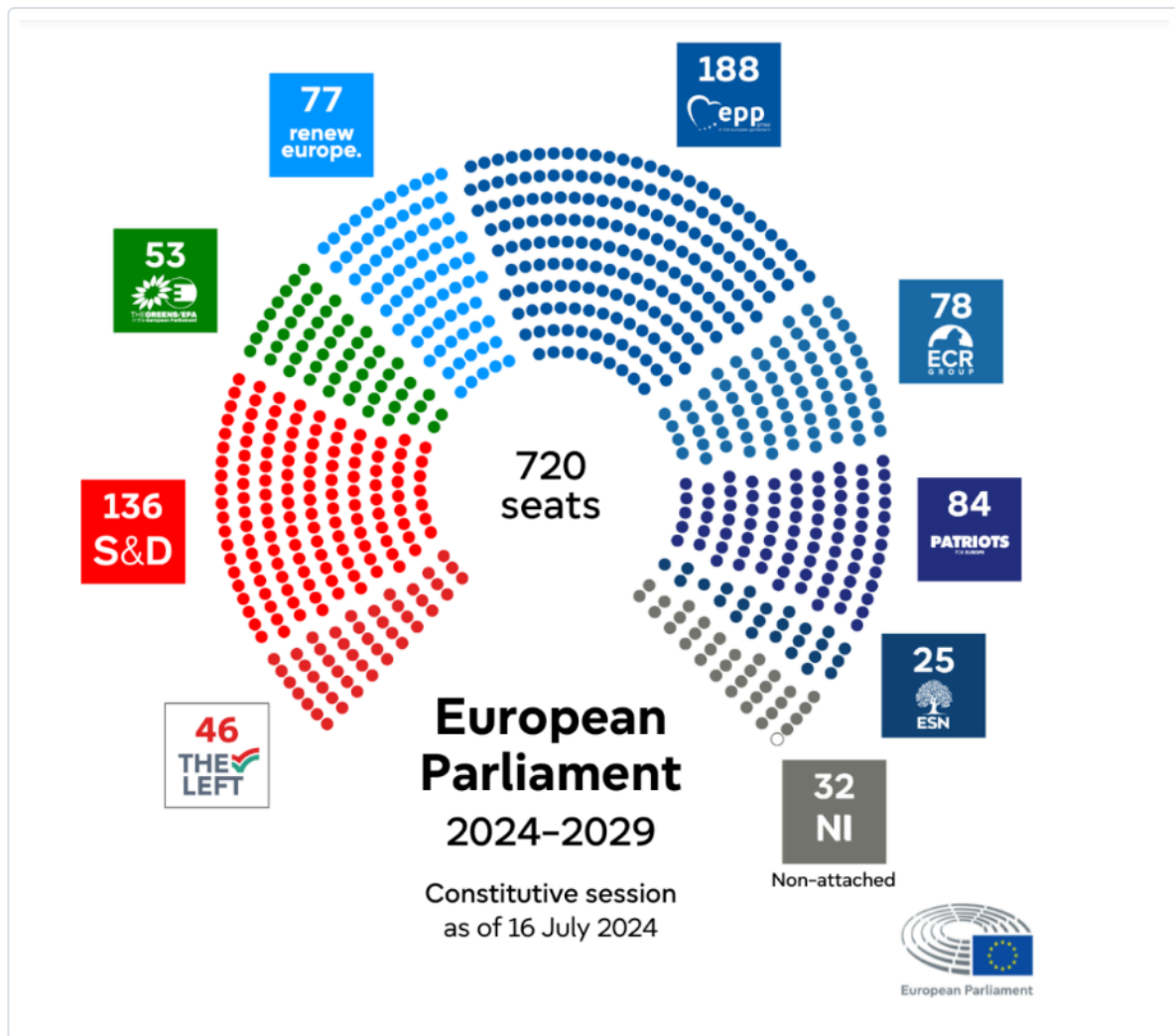
```
National ministers
    ↑ (formal adoption)
COREPER I & II   (committees of member states' permanent representatives / ambassadors)
    ↑
Working parties + national officials  (the technical bargaining)
    ↑
Council Secretariat
```

→ "**Much of the bargaining happens among diplomats before ministers meet.**" By the time ministers sign, most issues are already settled. (*This is exactly the "bureaucratic interpenetration" neofunctionalism talks about — national officials in constant contact.*)

European Parliament — citizens enter EU law-making

Core: the EU's **only directly elected** body — the citizens' chamber. Once a weak "talking shop," it has **gained real power through successive treaties** and now **co-legislates** as an equal with the Council.

- **Who:** **MEPs, directly elected every five years**, representing **EU citizens** (organised into cross-national **political groups**, not national delegations — a group needs **≥ 23 MEPs from ≥ 7 states**).
- **What it does:** **co-legislates** with the Council under the **Ordinary Legislative Procedure**; can **amend or block** legislation; **oversees** the Commission (it approves and can censure it).



How to read it. The hemicycle seats MEPs **left-to-right** by ideology, grouped into **transnational political families**, not by country. After the **2024** election the centre-right **EPP (188)** is the largest group, then the centre-left **S&D (136)**; the **centre** holds a **working majority** (EPP + S&D + Renew) but the **right** (Patriots, ECR, ESN) grew. → Illustrates that the EP is a genuine, party-political parliament — the "citizens' interest" the deck's table names.

| Court of Justice of the EU — authority through law

Core: the EU's supreme court. By interpreting the treaties and EU law, it ensures the law means the **same thing everywhere** — and in doing so it **shapes integration** itself.

- **What it does:** interprets the treaties and EU legislation; ensures **uniform application** across all states; resolves disputes; and draws the **boundary** between EU and national authority.
- **Why it matters for integration:** "courts can shape integration." By deciding what EU law requires, the CJEU can push integration forward without any new treaty — the neofunctionalist "integration through law." (Not to be confused with the *European Court of Human Rights*, which belongs to the Council of Europe — see [EU I.](#))

| EU authority rests where the EU has *competence*

Core: the EU has **no general power to act** — only the powers the treaties give it, and those come in **three strengths**.

Competence	Who may legislate	Examples
Exclusive	only the EU	customs union · the single currency · competition rules · common commercial (trade) policy · fisheries conservation · certain international agreements
Shared	EU and member states (states act where the EU hasn't)	internal market · environment · transport · consumer protection
Supporting	member states legislate; the EU only supports/coordinates	culture · education · tourism (<i>and areas kept largely national — health systems, taxation, defence</i>)

Constitutional limits — conferral, subsidiarity, proportionality

Core: three principles **fence in** EU power so it can't simply expand at will.

1. **Conferral** — the EU can act **only where the treaties give it competence**. No treaty basis → no EU action. (*The default is that power stays national.*)
2. **Subsidiarity** — in **non-exclusive** areas, the EU should act **only when the objective can't be adequately achieved by member states** acting alone (decisions taken as close to citizens as effective).
3. **Proportionality** — EU action must **not go beyond what is necessary** to achieve its aim (use the lightest tool that works).

How does the EU make & enforce decisions?

How an EU law actually gets made — the Ordinary Legislative Procedure

Core: the "typical" model, also called **co-decision**: the **Commission proposes**, and the **Parliament and Council must both agree** — as co-equal legislators — before it becomes law.

- **The steps:**
 1. **Commission** — **agenda-setting**: develops and **proposes** the legislation (right of initiative).
 2. **European Parliament + Council of the EU** — examine and **amend** the proposal (each can propose changes).
 3. **Negotiation / readings** — the two co-legislators reconcile their versions (often in "trilogue" with the Commission).
 4. **Agreement** — **both** the EP and the Council approve the **same text**.
 5. **Adopted → implemented & enforced**.
- **The key feature: Parliament and Council co-decide as equals** — the citizens' chamber and the states' chamber must **both** say yes. Either can **amend or block**. → *This co-equal status is a major **deepening** of supranational democracy won over successive treaties (recall EU I: Maastricht's codecision, extended since).*

Qualified Majority Voting (QMV) — how the Council decides

Core: in the Council, most decisions pass by **QMV, not unanimity** — a **double majority** of states and population. The radical implication: a **national government can be outvoted** and still be bound.

- **The double threshold** — a proposal passes with:

- **55% of member states** (i.e. at least 15 of 27), **AND**
- states representing **65% of the total EU population**.
- **Why the two locks:** the **55% of states** protects the **many smaller** countries (one state, one vote); the **65% of population** protects the **few large** ones (Germany, France...). A measure needs **both** kinds of majority. (*A blocking minority therefore needs at least 4 states — so no 3 big states can veto alone.*)
- **Unanimity still rules the sensitive areas** — foreign & security policy, taxation, defence, enlargement — where **every state keeps a veto**.
- **Why it matters (the deck's exercise):** under **QMV**, a **Danish farmer's** government can be **outvoted** by a coalition of others — influence depends on building **coalitions**, and small states punch above their weight per capita. Under **unanimity**, *every* government (however small) holds a **veto**, so the **French farmer's** government could block anything it dislikes. → **QMV = supranational** (states can lose); **unanimity = intergovernmental** (states stay in control).

After adoption — who implements? (adoption ≠ implementation)

Core: the EU **makes** the rules but rarely **applies** them itself. **Implementation is mostly national** — a defining feature of the EU's "**small state**" design (recall EU I: most EU law is enforced by national officials).



Not all EU law works the same way — regulations, directives, decisions

Core: the EU has **three main legal instruments**, and they create **different relationships** between EU and national authority. Know the differences — a classic exam distinction.

Instrument	Binding force	National transposition?
Regulation	directly applicable — becomes law in every state as written , automatically	No — no national law needed
Directive	binding as to the result/objective , but leaves the means to states	Yes — states must transpose it into national law (choosing <i>how</i>)
Decision	binding in full on specific addressees (a state, company or individual)	No — applies directly to whom it names

- *In plain terms:* a **regulation** is a Union-wide law imposed identically everywhere (strongly supranational); a **directive** sets a goal but lets each state legislate its own route (a softer, more flexible tool); a **decision** is a targeted order. **Different instrument = different degree of central control**.

Integration through legislation *and* through courts (positive vs negative)

Core: the EU integrates in **two ways** — by **building** common rules (positive) and by **striking down** national barriers (negative, often via the CJEU).

- **Positive integration** — EU institutions **create common rules**: legislation, **harmonization**, common standards. (*Building a shared framework.*)
- **Negative integration** — EU law **removes national barriers**: the **CJEU** interprets the treaties so that incompatible national rules **fall away**. (*Clearing obstacles to the four freedoms.*)
- **Landmark case** — **Cassis de Dijon (1979)**. Germany blocked a French blackcurrant liqueur for being below its minimum alcohol content. The CJEU ruled the barrier illegal and established the **principle of mutual recognition**: a good **lawfully sold in one member state** may in principle be **sold throughout** the EU, even without harmonized rules. → *Illustrates: negative integration through courts* — the CJEU removing a national barrier to **free movement of goods**, deepening the single market without any new legislation. (*A textbook neofunctionalist "integration through law."*)

Who enforces EU rules?

Core: enforcement, like implementation, is **shared** between EU and national actors.

Enforcer	Role
European Commission	monitors member-state compliance; brings infringement proceedings
National authorities	enforce EU rules domestically
National courts	apply EU law in individual cases (and can refer questions to the CJEU)
CJEU	authoritative interpretation ; settles legal disputes
European Court of Auditors	audits EU finances

Why does the architecture matter?

Core: the "typical" model (Commission → EP + Council → law) is **not universal**. The architecture **shifts by policy area**, and membership itself is **differentiated** — so "the EU" is really several different decision-systems at once.

- **It varies by policy area**. The standard supranational model dominates the **single market** and most regulation. But some areas stay **intergovernmental** — above all the **Common Foreign & Security Policy (CFSP)**:
 - driven by the **European Council + Council** (the member states);
 - **unanimity** generally required;
 - **more limited roles** for Commission, Parliament and CJEU. → *Where the EU is more supranational, integration can run ahead of states; where it's intergovernmental, states stay in charge. Same Union, different rules.*

Differentiated integration — common *and* varied

Core: not every member state participates in every policy the same way. The EU can be **both common and differentiated** — a patchwork, not a uniform bloc.

- **Euro** — **not all** EU members use the single currency (Denmark opted out; others haven't joined).
- **Schengen** — **differentiated** participation in the passport-free travel area (some EU states out; some non-EU states — Norway, Switzerland — in).
- **Enhanced cooperation** — a group of states can move ahead in an area without the others. → *This flexibility is how a Union of 27 very different states keeps deepening without forcing everyone to move in lockstep — recall the deepening/widening tension from EU I.*

★ Integration theories & the institutional architecture

Core: the payoff — the lecture ties the machinery straight back to EU I's two theories. The **supranational vs intergovernmental** split among the institutions is the LI-vs-neofunctionalism debate made concrete.

	Liberal Intergovernmentalism	Neofunctionalism / Supranationalism
Key actors	member-state governments	supranational bodies & non-state actors
Key mechanism	interstate bargaining	spillover
Key EU bodies	European Council + Council	Commission + EP + CJEU
View of integration	stays under state control	can develop beyond state control

- **How to argue with it** (the deck's exercise — apply each theory to a feature):
 - **QMV in the Council** → *LI*: states **agreed** the rules and still bargain (and kept unanimity for the sensitive stuff); *NF*: accepting you can be **outvoted** is states **losing control** to a supranational majority.
 - **Commission's right of initiative** → *LI*: a convenient agenda-setter serving state-agreed goals; *NF*: the engine of **cultivated spillover**, shaping outcomes.
 - **CJEU + Cassis de Dijon** → *NF*: **integration through law**, courts removing barriers autonomously; *LI*: states tolerate it because it serves their **collective** interest in a working market.
 - **CFSP + unanimity** → *LI*: proof states keep the **veto** where sovereignty is dearest; *NF*: the **limit** of spillover — an area still "**encapsulated**."
- **The takeaway:** you can read the **same institution** two ways. The architecture is contested terrain precisely because **whether the supranational or the intergovernmental bodies dominate a policy area** decides whether integration is **state-controlled or self-propelling**.

★ Fun facts & memorable details (EU II: Institutions)

Sticky bits from the institutions lecture.

- **Three "Councils," endlessly confused** — the **European Council** (leaders, sets direction), the **Council of the EU** (ministers, legislates), and the **Council of Europe** (a *separate* non-EU human-rights body, from EU I). Mixing them up is the classic exam slip.
- **The Commission has the "right of initiative"** — almost **no EU law can start without it**. Whoever sets the agenda has quiet power; that's why neofunctionalists call the Commission the **engine**.
- **A government can be outvoted and still bound** — under **QMV**, lose the vote and the law still applies to you. That single fact is the sharpest evidence that the EU is **more than** an ordinary international organisation.

- **The real deals are cut by diplomats, not ministers** — by the time ministers meet, **COREPER** ambassadors and working parties have usually pre-cooked the agreement. The photographed handshake is often theatre.
 - **The presidency is a relay baton, not a throne** — it **rotates every six months** in **trios**; no country "runs" the EU.
 - *Cassis de Dijon* — a **blackcurrant liqueur** that quietly built the single market: from a squabble over French crème de cassis came **mutual recognition**, one of the most important integration principles, made by **judges**, not legislators.
 - **A regulation vs a directive** — a regulation is the same law everywhere the day it passes; a directive just sets the **goal** and lets 27 parliaments each find their own way there. Same Union, very different grip.
-